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JULY 5, 2026LATE CITY
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₹15 SRINAGAR)

The Sunday EXPRESS

**EYE**

Mango on my Map

It's not a fruit, it's an aroma, it's sticky elbows, summer and chaos and, when everything is forgotten, a memory that brings you home

SCREENDeepali Sahay on her song *Tere paas main* from *Main Vaapas Aaunga* that is leaving listeners misty-eyed

DAILY FROM: AHMEDABAD, CHANDIGARH, DELHI, JAIPUR, KOLKATA, LUCKNOW, MUMBAI, NAGPUR, PATNA, PUNE, VADODARA

'NEW EV POLICY EMPOWERS MIDDLE CLASS'

'Delhi transforming... has chosen a new direction for cleaner, more modern future'

'Subsidies not capped... total incentive around Rs 60,000-70,000 per vehicle'Gayathri Mani
New Delhi, July 4

The Capital's new Electric Vehicle (EV) Policy is not merely an incentive scheme, but a comprehensive roadmap to transform its transport ecosystem, reduce pollution and make electric mobility affordable, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said Saturday.

In an interview with *The Indian Express*, Gupta described the policy, which came into effect July 1, as "common-man centric" and one designed primarily for Delhi's middle class. The policy, she said, departs significantly from previous approaches by removing subsidy caps and focusing on the segments that contribute the most

**REKHA GUPTA**
DELHI CHIEF MINISTER
PAGE 4

to air pollution.

"We have given all kinds of possible incentives: Subsidy, scrapping incentive, road tax exemption and registration exemption," Gupta said.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Hafiz Saeed kin and aides among 23 added to terror list under UAPA, total count 80

Listing by Centre will help fight terror networks at national, international levelsMahender Singh Manral
New Delhi, July 4

THE CENTRE Saturday designated as terrorists 23 operatives of Pakistan-based terror organisations including Jaish-e-Mohammed (JeM) and Lashkar-e-Taiba (LeT), citing their involvement in terror recruitment, infiltration, training, supply of arms through drones, and planning of attacks in Jammu and Kashmir.

This raises the total count of designated terrorists to 80. Fol-

lowing the amendment to the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967 (UAPA) by the Centre in 2019, 57 individuals had been designated as terrorists in 2024 under Section 35 of the Act and listed in its Fourth Schedule.

Among the 23 are the son-in-law of LeT founder Hafiz Muhammad Saeed and his close associates, three involved in the 2016 terror attack on an Army camp in Nagrota, and two involved in the 2018 terror attack on the Sunjwan Military Station.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Barmer mosque razings spark legal battle, unite residents across faith

Officials cite national security; residents allege no due process as per SC guidelinesParul Kulshrestha
Kerkori (Barmer, Rajasthan), July 4

IN ONE corner of Barmer's Kerkori village, Hishamuddin Sindi surveys the wreckage before him: concrete slabs, bricks, construction debris piled together. All that remains is a tall, white minaret. "We

built it with such hardship but now it's gone. This is the only mosque within a 10-km radius. Where are we supposed to go now?" says Hishamuddin, the mosque's maulvi.

Fellow resident Harla Ram Meghwal still can't make sense of what is happening. "We offered food to the Muslims after they stopped cooking to protest

EXPRESS special

Biggest cities offer better salaries, more regular jobs for women, but stark gender disparity in income favours men

Women's overall contribution to workforce, however, continues to languish — just one of every four women employed in big cities compared to almost 3 of every 4 menZeeshan Shaikh
Mumbai, July 4

INDIA'S BIGGEST cities seem to offer better opportunities for women to get salaried or regular jobs than urban India as a whole.

According to the latest report on 'Labour Market Dynamics in Million-plus Cities' published by the National Statistics Office, women participation in such

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2**• JOBS AND SALARIES IN BIG CITIES****% employed in regular jobs**

	MN-PLUS CITIES	URBAN INDIA
Men	56.4	46.5
Women	65.1	50.9
Overall	58.5	47.6

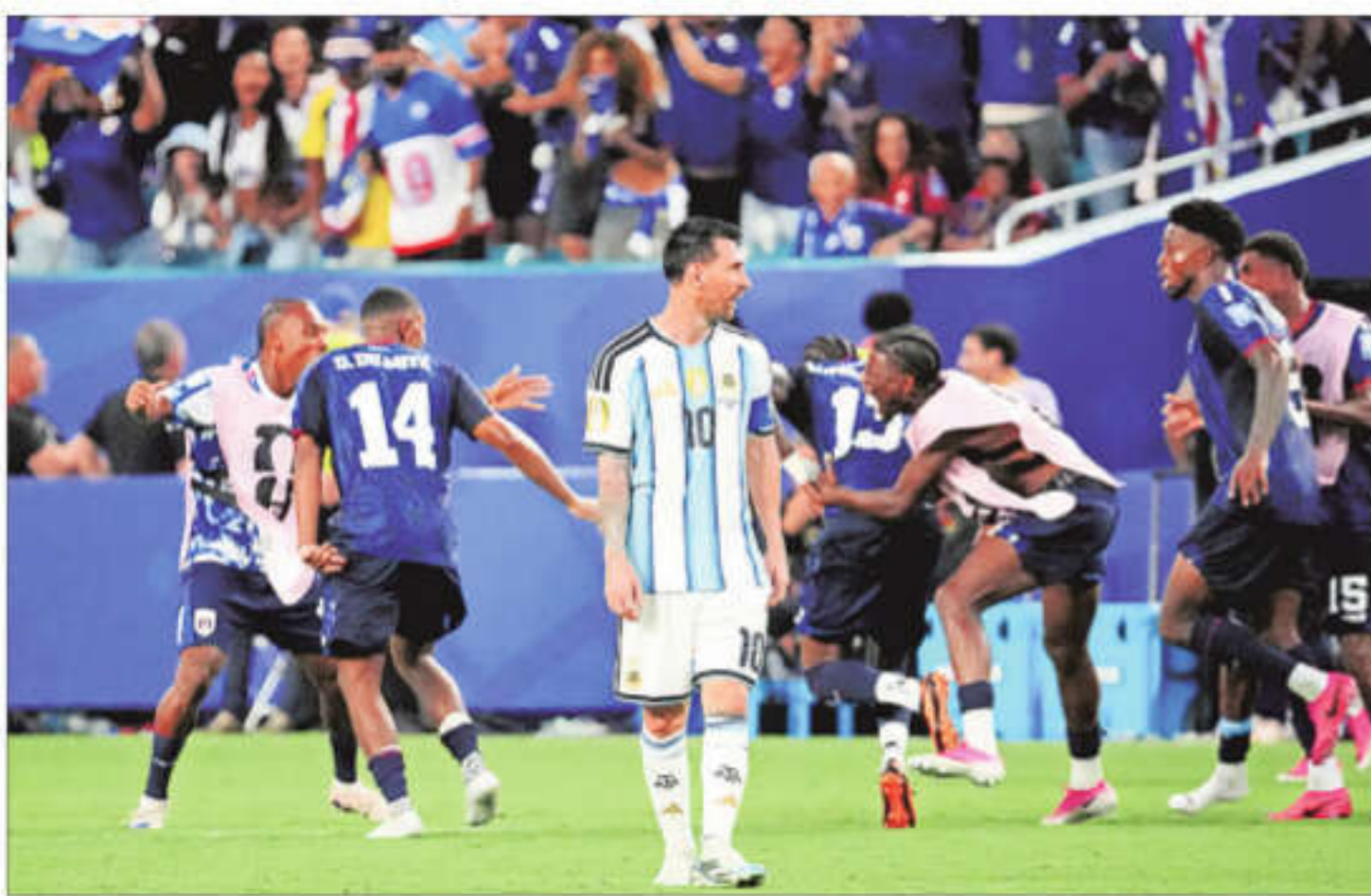
Average monthly salary

	MN-PLUS CITIES	URBAN INDIA
Men	Rs 30,707	Rs 27,984
Women	Rs 23,707	Rs 21,664
Overall	Rs 28,808	Rs 26,258

SOURCE: PERIODIC LABOUR FORCE SURVEY (PLFS) 2025

How metro cities pay

	MEN	WOMEN
Mumbai	Rs 36,453	Rs 35,788
Delhi	Rs 35,708	Rs 31,644
Bengaluru	Rs 37,430	Rs 28,325
Chennai	Rs 31,655	Rs 22,919
Kolkata	Rs 21,534	Rs 13,784



Lionel Messi reacts as Cape Verde players celebrate their second goal against Argentina. AP

Cape Verde lose to Argentina, but steal the show in a match for ages

Sandip G
New York, July 4

IN THE beatifically lit Hard Rock Stadium in Miami, a fairy tale met a tearful end. Cape

Verde's journey from an utter unknown to nearly pulling off the greatest shock in World Cup history ended at the hands, legs, and experience of the world champions, Argentina, in extra time, 3-2. The story their brave men wrote will haunt them: men who defeated the odds and left everything on the field. But Cape Verde leave this World Cup as its most heart-warming narrative. They

leave as heroes. Some leave as household names.

The toll was visible in its final seconds. Messi sank to his knees and prayed, staring at the sky. His teammates lay sprawled on the grass; Cape Verde's players staggered like ghosts. The world would spend days replaying an unseemly classic, wishing it had never ended.

Until the last second of the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Happening today

• **JOINT AWAMI ACTION** Committee, a collective of activist groups leading the protests in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir, has called for a shutdown in response to sweeping crackdown by Pakistani authorities.

• **SHIV SENA (UBT) CHIEF** Uddhav Thackeray is set to launch a 'Ram Raksha' agitation in Maharashtra over the alleged theft of donations at the Ram temple in Ayodhya.

TRACK THESE AND MORE ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM**POLITICS** **PAGE 7****MAMATA SLAMS REBELS AS KEY AIDE QUILTS AMID TMC MELTDOWN****SAYS FEARMONGERS DID NOT SUCCEED**

PM: Navigated energy crisis with India jalwa and hard work



PM Narendra Modi at an integrated refinery-cum-petrochemical complex in Rajasthan's Barmer, Saturday. PTI

'India has friendly ties, sourced fuel from over 40 countries during West Asia war'Hamza Khan
Jaipur, July 4

UNDERLINING THAT his government took "every single step... sensitively, whether at the policy level or the diplomatic level" at the height of the West Asia crisis, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said Saturday that India successfully navigated one of the worst global energy crises by sourcing fuel from more than 40 countries, and credited it to friendly relations, diplomatic power, hard

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2**E. EXPLAINED****Shift in strategy**

India's crude import strategy has shifted ever since the outbreak of hostilities in West Asia hit oil flows and increased freight risks. While Russian crude is still the backbone of India's import slate, refiners have diversified towards North American and Venezuelan barrels to offset the drop in supplies from the Gulf.

POLITICS **PAGES 7, 6****PM WISHES TRUMP AS U.S. TURNS 250****JAISHANKAR LEAVES FOR WEST ASIA, U.S., EUROPE TOUR TODAY**

Adani power infra: Gujarat govt notifies new compensation policy for farmers

Ritu Sharma
Ahmedabad, July 4

THE GUJARAT government on Saturday announced new guidelines for compensation of land in Right of Way (RoW) corridors and towers for transmission lines to "balance the financial burden on the power transmission companies and the possible increase in tariff to the end consumer".

Citing various queries and representations regarding compensation of land in Right of Way (RoW) corridors and tower-based areas during laying of transmission lines, the resolution issued by the Department of Energy and Petroleum will supersede provisions of all other resolutions issued earlier by the state relating to compensation for damage to land/crops/ fruit trees and other

trees, during the erection of transmission lines and towers.

The *Indian Express* reported Friday how farmers at Jetpar village of Morbi district who were facing loss of land were protesting against Adani Energy Solutions Ltd (ASEL) whose Special Purpose Vehicle, Halvad Transmission Ltd is installing high tension towers for transmission cables to evacuate power from the renewable energy park at Khavda in Kutch. They would wind up the agitation only after the state issues a fresh resolution, they had said.

On Friday, Agriculture Minister and Gujarat government spokesperson Jitu Vaghani agreed to key demands of the farmers including doubling the market price for calculating compensation, and the setting up of a Market Rate Committee

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2**• 24-YEAR-OLD MARINE ENGINEER FROM KERALA, ON HER FIRST SHIP DUTY, CAN'T FORGET THE SIGHT OF MISSILES STREAKING OVERHEAD**

'Saw missiles for first time': For *Paanch Saab*, baptism by fire at sea near Hormuz

Sunanda Mehta
Pune, July 4

IN THE early hours of a tense morning outside the Strait of Hormuz, near the Fujairah anchorage, a young marine engineer from Kerala looked at the sky and saw missiles streak past, one after another. It lasted a few seconds but it was a sight, she says, she will never forget.

Hifa Salim (24) was just months into her dream job, having joined her very first ship in Houston in October 2025, when war broke out in the Persian Gulf, scrapping the ship's

planned cargo run to Kuwait in early March.

The vessel was instead directed to drift outside the Strait of Hormuz, near the Fujairah anchorage, and wait. Salim later learned that arriving in the area just 15 hours earlier would have trapped the vessel inside the strait when the situation really deteriorated.

It was on one of those drifting mornings, stepping onto the deck for fresh air before her engine room rounds, that she heard a sound from the sky and looked up to see the flashes.

"This was the first time I saw

missiles in real life. My hands started shivering," she says. Terrified, she ran below to the mess room and considered asking to sign off. But once there, she found her crewmates eating breakfast, laughing, entirely at ease and something in her perspective shifted.

"If my seniors could carry their own fear and still show up for work, so could I," says Salim.

She heard the main engine starting — a small kick ahead for position adjustment. "I heard the starting sound. 'Tak Tak Tak.' I hear that sound every time. But that morning it felt different. It felt like the heartbeat of the ship. And that time I real-



Hifa Salim (24) was just months into her dream job, having joined her very first ship, when war broke out in the Persian Gulf

ised the ship is alive. We are not alone," wrote Salim later in an essay published in the magazine of Synergy Marine Group that manages her ship.

She went down to have a cup of tea with the Second Engineer, the officer she reported to. "He took one look at me and could read that something is not right and when I said that I want to stay on board and be part of the team instead of quitting, he smiled and said in Malayalam, 'S saab ippo strong aayi, Vaa namukoru fuel valve overhaul cheyyam, appo ellam sherya vunn' which translated to 'S saab had become strong now. Come, let's overhaul one fuel valve,

then everything will be alright.' In the middle of uncertainty, those simple words gave me comfort, strength and the confidence to carry on with my work."

As a fifth engineer everyone on board called her "*Paanch Saab*", the traditional title for the ship's youngest engineer. "I liked the name. It made me feel like I belonged, even though I didn't have a watch yet," says Salim who also made the decision to not tell her family at home the full extent of what was happening — she didn't want them to panic. It was only after the ship had safely cleared the area that she learned her parents had been doing the very same thing

for her: staying composed on their calls, masking their own fear so she wouldn't carry the weight of theirs.

"We were all trying to protect one another in our own way," she reflects.

Hailing from Edakkazhiyur, a small town in Thrissur district, her close-knit family had always taught her to dream big while staying grounded, she says. She had once dreamed of the Indian Navy, but the engineering side of the Merchant Navy pulled her in, partly because almost no one at home could tell her what the profession even involved.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

Salaries and jobs

• WHERE WOMEN BEAT MEN

TOP SIX CITIES	WOMEN	GAP	MEN
Prayagraj	Rs 42,254	31%	Rs 32,214
Srinagar	Rs 33,869	24%	Rs 27,323
Lucknow	Rs 31,744	17%	Rs 27,098
Patna	Rs 31,013	11%	Rs 27,902
Meerut	Rs 20,057	5%	Rs 18,946
Varanasi	Rs 20,821	2%	Rs 20,331

stable jobs is stronger in cities with one million-plus population compared with urban India as a whole. Women also surpass men in such jobs by a notable margin, i.e., 65.1% of all employed women in million plus cities have a regular or salaried job compared with 56.4% all employed men.

Gender disparities in income, however, prevail in big cities as much or more than they do in urban India.

The report shows that women participation in regular or salaried jobs at 65.1% is also much stronger in 46 cities which have more than a million people as per Census 2011 compared with 50.9% in urban India.

While this is true, it is also a fact that women's worker population ratio (WPR) continues to languish. While men's WPR in million-plus cities is 72.6%, that for women is 25.5%. This is not very different from that of urban India, as a whole (73% for men, and 25.9% for women). WPR is the percentage of persons employed among the persons in the population.

There is a clear distinction in the employment trends of million-plus cities compared with urban India. Overall, regular or salaried jobs are markedly higher at 58.5% in these cities compared with 47.6% in urban India. Self-employed and casual jobs, put together, are higher at 52.4% in urban India compared with 41.4% jobs in million-plus cities. Jobs are divided in three categories: salaried or regular, self-employed, and casual.

Intems of income in regular jobs, while both men and women earn at least 10% more in million-plus cities compared with urban India, the income gap widens in the million-plus cities. Across urban India, men in regular salaried jobs earn an average Rs 27,984 a month against Rs 21,664 for women, a gap of Rs 6,320. In the country's 46 largest cities, the gap widens to Rs 7,000, with men earning an average Rs 30,707 a month compared to Rs 23,707 for women. Women salaries as a percentage of men's salaries is 77.2% both in million-plus cities and in urban India.

In a handful of cities, though, women have achieved near parity with men in regular salaried jobs. Prayagraj tops the list, where women earn 131.2% of male salaries (Rs 42,254 against Rs 32,214), followed by Srinagar at 124% (Rs 33,869 vs Rs 27,323), Lucknow at 117.1% (Rs 31,744 vs Rs 27,098), Patna at 111.1% (Rs 31,013 vs Rs 27,902), Meerut at 105.9% (Rs 20,057 vs Rs 18,946) and Varanasi at 102.4% (Rs 20,821 vs Rs 20,331).

The findings are part of the

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PoK

he was handed over to the police for legal proceedings. The police registered a case against him for illegal intrusion and sent him to jail in Baramulla. Three days ago, they filed a chargesheet. The court admitted the police chargesheet and closed the case, following which formalities for his repatriation were completed.

On Saturday, Indian officials informed their Pakistani

National Statistics Office's latest Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) 2025, which for the first time presents labour market estimates for the 46 million-plus cities in India. The survey is based on interviews with around 3.95 lakh respondents across urban India, including nearly 60,000 in the 46 million-plus cities.

Among the country's major metropolitan centres, Greater Mumbai stands out. The city ranks eighth overall on gender pay parity, with women earning 98.2 per cent of men's salaries. Women in regular salaried employment earn an average Rs 35,788 a month, just Rs 665 less than men, who earn Rs 36,453.

The picture is less encouraging in the other metros. In Delhi, women earn 88.6% of men's salaries (Rs 31,644 against Rs 35,708). Bengaluru follows with women earning Rs 28,325 compared to men's Rs 37,430, a gap of 24.3%. In Chennai, women earn Rs 22,919 against men's Rs 31,655, or 27.6% less. Kolkata records the widest gender pay gap among the five metros, with women earning Rs 13,784 a month compared to Rs 21,534 for men, leaving them 36% behind their male counterparts.

The survey also highlights the strong earnings premium enjoyed by self-employed workers in India's largest cities, though here too the gender gap persists. Self-employed men earn an average Rs 33,888 a month in million-plus cities, compared with Rs 16,167 for women. Navi Mumbai emerged as the country's most lucrative destination for entrepreneurs, with self-employed men earning Rs 62,234 a month and women Rs 84,913. Greater Mumbai ranked second for both categories, with self-employed men earning Rs 58,007 and women Rs 32,664.

The divide is sharper in the informal economy. Across the 46 million-plus cities, male casual labourers earn an average Rs 643 a day compared to Rs 434 for women. Vasai-Virar offers the highest daily wage for men at Rs 962, while Srinagar tops the list for women at Rs 800. At the other end of the spectrum, female casual labourers earn just Rs 53 a day in Faridabad.

The survey also points to a persistent gender divide in workforce participation. Across urban India, 65 per cent of women aged 30-59 are classified as NEET (Not in Employment, Education or Training), compared with just 4.4 per cent of men. In the country's million-plus cities, the figure rises to 67 per cent for women, while remaining almost unchanged at 4.3 per cent for men.

counterparts about the deportation. Zeeshan was then taken to Kaman Post. "We took him to Kaman Post and handed him over to Pakistani soldiers. There-patriation took place at 12.30pm," a police officer said.

Iram and her family were allowed to meet him briefly before his deportation. "We were allowed to meet him for two to three minutes before departure. He didn't say anything," Iram, said. "He just wept the whole time we were there."

PM on energy crisis

work and resolve.

Speaking in Rajasthan's Balthora after dedicating the country's first greenfield integrated refinery-cum-petrochemical complex to the nation at Pachpadra, Modi said, "Due to the war in West Asia, there was panic across the world. Every country was in distress. This war gave birth to the biggest energy crisis of the 21st century. Major nations are still grappling with fuel shortage today. But the willpower and efforts of the new India of the 21st century have prevailed over these challenges."

"During the war, India's friendship with other countries proved very useful. When this crisis began, India was importing fuel and energy from 25-26 countries. *Lekin sankat ke samay Bharat ki diplomacy kajalwa dikh gaya; doosre deshon ke saath humare achche sambandh is sankat ki ghadi mein bahut kaam aaye*. But during this crisis, the power of India's diplomacy was demonstrated; our good relations

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Cape Verde steal show

120th minute, Cape Verde stretched the champions, and Messi himself, to the outer limits of physical and mental fortitude. They did not flinch when Messi broke their resistance in the 29th minute, controlling the ball on the rise with the outside of his boot to beat goalkeeper Vozinha. They weathered the storm, came out for the second half on the front foot, and equalised in the 59th minute through Deroy Duarte's sumptuous nutmeg of Emiliano Martínez, born from a buildup that had already nutmegged an Argentine defender. For the first time all night, Argentine faces in the crowd carried a flicker of foreboding. This was no lapse or deflection. It was the product of total domination.

Incensed, Argentina attacked in waves. Cape Verde stone-walled every one of them. Vozinha stood like the Rock of Gibraltar, turning away a venomous Messi free kick from just two or three metres out, struck from his favoured spot on the right, while his defenders threw their bodies at anything that smelled of danger. Ar-

gentina's desperation curdled into uncharacteristic mistakes. Coach Lionel Scaloni's face burned red with agony.

When extra time began, the score locked at 1-1, this was no longer champions and minnows, but a fight between equals. The smallest nation ever to reach a World Cup knockout round refused to yield.

The dynasty of Messi, Maradona and Kempes stood on the precipice of its darkest hour. Three minutes in, Lisandro Martínez, a defender nicknamed "the Butcher" for the way he plays, not the way he finishes, came to his country's rescue with a goal built like a striker's, hammered into the roof of the net. Surely now Cape Verde's resolve would break.

But their opponents weren't finished. Manager Bubišta signalled for calm, and his players found it, even as the wilting Argentines could not live with their energy. Messi was barely able to walk. Lautaro Martínez and Facundo Medina both went off with cramps. Bubišta's substitutes arrived fresher, and one produced

Delhi CM

"Unlike other states, we have not put any capping. We want as many people as possible to avail the benefits of this EV policy so that the city's air improves."

Framing the policy as part of a broader transformation of the Capital, Gupta said, "Delhi is transforming. It has chosen a new direction – one focused on building a cleaner, more modern, and better future. The EV policy is also a part of this transformation and we believe it will usher in a new era of cleaner mobility."

Gupta said the policy deliberately prioritises electric two-wheelers and autorickshaws because the government believes they offer the quickest gains in reducing vehicular emissions.

"People wanted to switch to e-two-wheelers, but they could not do so because of the cost gap," she said, estimating that the combined incentives amount to nearly Rs 60,000-70,000 per vehicle.

While the draft policy had proposed incentives for strong hybrid vehicles, the final version excludes them. Defending the decision, Gupta said the government's immediate focus is on technologies that deliver the greatest environmental benefits. "This is an EV policy, not a petrol policy," Gupta said, adding that hybrids could be considered in future phases if cleaner technologies become more viable.

Learning from the shortcomings of the previous EV policy, Gupta said, the new policy has redesigned the subsidy dis-bursal mechanism. "Instead of routing benefits through dealerships, buyers will apply directly through a dedicated portal, with subsidy payments transferred into their bank accounts through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) within 60 days of vehicle registration," she said.

Acknowledging public concerns over inadequate charging facilities, Gupta said the government plans to expand Delhi's charging network from around 9,000 charging points to nearly 32,000 over the coming years.

Gujarat

(MRC). The final market price will be determined by the MRC based on the 'reference market rate' as well as a 'lottery system', according to the new guidelines. The method for determining the Reference Market Rate (incorporated for the first time since the state adopted the setting of the MRC) states that if the difference in the market rates determined by two selected valuers is less than 20 per cent of the lower value, the average value of both the valuations will be considered as the reference market rate.

In the second case, if the difference between the two is more than 20 per cent, the reference market rate can be fixed at 10 per cent more than the lower valuation. "Only if this is not acceptable, the sealed report of the third valuer shall be opened and the reference market rate shall be finalised by taking the average of the two lowest valuations," the guidelines says.

The MRC will be formed at each district level to resolve the

The country didn't emerge from this unexpected challenge just like that; it was also due to the success of our visionary policies that have been going on for a decade," he said.

Attacking the previous Ashok Gehlot government in Rajasthan, Modi said: "Today, we are inaugurating the Rajasthan Refinery here. We signed an MoU for this in 2017. However, the Congress government ruled Rajasthan from 2018 to 2023. Due to the Congress's non-cooperation, work here virtually stalled. But as soon as the double-engine (BJP) government came to power, work progressed rapidly," he said.

"And you know my working style, whatever we lay the foundation stone for, we also inaugurate it. Similarly, India has steadily expanded its refinery capacity. The United States hasn't built a single new refinery in the last 50 years, and Europe's refinery capacity has steadily declined, while India today has the world's fourth-largest refinery capacity. And we are not going to stop there. This capacity is set to grow even further in the coming years," he said, adding

a stunning equaliser in the 103rd minute: left-back Sidney Lopes Cabral drifted past Nicolás Tagliafico and curled the ball into the far top corner from the edge of the area.

Cabral is 23, born in Rotterdam, and now plays for Trabzonspor after a rapid rise through Sweden's Helsingborg, Germany's lower leagues with Rot-Weiss Erfurt, and a breakout season at Portugal's Estrela da Amadora, before a move to Benfica and a €10 million switch to Trabzonspor weeks before this World Cup. It is a long way from the fifth tier, where he earned €850 a month and endured racist abuse both on and off the pitch. He climbed into the stands to find his girlfriend. It should have been the most famous goal in his country's history. For now, it's remembered as the moment just before the one that would leave Cape Verde numb.

A shootout loomed until Argentina won a corner in the 111th minute. Messi's swerving delivery appeared to cannon in off Christian Romero's head. Replays showed otherwise: the ball had caught Romero, then clipped Diney Borges's arm on the way in. Argentina's third. When the big screen showed the

replay, Borges sank to the turf and buried his face. Argentine fans celebrated wildly, then caught themselves; by now, they knew what their opponents were capable of coming back from.

Sure enough, Cape Verde regrouped for one final push. They very nearly got there: only the left glove of Emiliano Martínez, pink-patched and thrown full stretch, kept out a stinging Cabral free kick. Argentina were fraying, running now on will-power and the fear of an equaliser that could end their title defence, and perhaps the World Cup career of arguably the greatest footballer there has ever been. Martínez had to rush off his line to smother a looping ball before Cabral's boot could reach it. That was as close as Cape Verde came. It was as close as Argentina came to a shock for the ages.

The fairy tale ends here. But the memory won't. The day before America's 250th birthday will be remembered as the day the smallest nation ever to reach a World Cup knockout stage came within a heartbeat of dethroning the champions, burning an empire, and nearly writing the final chapter of Messi's career at the top of the game.

issues of compensation of affected land and to fix the market rate. For valuation of the land, it will appoint land valuers who are empanelled by the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Board of India. Three valuers (one by the landowners' representative, one by TSP and one by the District Collector) will be appointed on day of the committee meeting.

The appointed evaluators will submit their independent reports in a sealed cover directly to the District Collector within 21 days of their appointment by the MRC. After receiving all three reports, two will be opened by the District Collector by selecting them through a 'lottery system'.

The District Collector can allow immediate commencement of physical works of transmission lines without any hindrance on condition of payment of compensation based on the market price as determined by the MRC.

The provisions of the GR published with the 'in-principle approval and approval received' from the Finance Department, Revenue Department and Agriculture and Cooperation Department through letter on July 4,

that it was due to such efforts that "India has emerged victorious from the biggest energy crisis of the century."

The country, he said, "took correct decisions at every stage: accurately assessed the crisis in a timely manner; devised an effective strategy; utilised the resources in a balanced way; and positively utilised Bharat's diplomatic power. Only then was Bharat able to emerge from the crisis."

"When certain forces were busy spreading rumours and apprehensions in the public sphere, the scale at which work was being carried out and the way the situation was being managed – that hard work, those efforts, and the patience involved were remarkable. Every single step was taken sensitively, whether at the policy level or the diplomatic level. And sooner or later, history will record that all of this was unprecedented," he said.

On the occasion, Modi also laid the foundation stone and inaugurated various development projects worth around Rs 1.06 lakh crore in Balotra, with the projects spanning multiple sectors including petrochemicals, urban transport, railways, roads, renewable energy, and power transmission.

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2026 are equally applicable to all new transmission lines of 66 kV and above to be laid in the Gujarat and to all transmission lines of 66 kV and above in progress.

● **Tower Base Compensation:** 200% of market value as determined by the MRC for loss of land in the tower base area (the area between the four bases of the tower). To calculate area, an extension of 1 meter on each side in addition to the actual area of the four bases of the tower will be taken into account.

● **Right of Way Corridor Compensation:** For land due to RoW Corridor (width and length of transmission line), the compensation will take MRC-determined market value of the land for the area over which the land passes. In rural areas, it will be 30% of land value, 40% for municipalities, nagar panchayats, 45% for all other urban planning areas, and 60% for Municipal Corporations and Metropolitan Areas.

● **For crop loss compensation:** Rates fixed by APMC will be applicable and the valuation will be certified by concerned sarpanch/ talati/mamlatdar or the concerned revenue officer.

Mosque demolitions

government is getting out of this. These are our brothers."

This mosque is one of 12 that a writ petition in the Rajasthan High Court claims were demolished between June 18 and 20 across eight border villages in Barmer and four in Bikaner.

The demolitions are all within a 15-km radius of the international border and have triggered widespread protests.

Over the past week, hundreds of residents, both Hindu and Muslim, have banded together under 'Sarv Dharm Shanti Sabha,' held marches, submitted memos to the administration.

Officially, the notices cite land use violations, claiming the mosques stood on Gochar, or pastoral, land. On May 27, Union Home Minister Amit Shah had directed authorities to strictly enforce a zero-tolerance policy against illegal structures within 15 km of the international border and demolish them.

Residents, however, claim the notices appeared suddenly and the demolitions were carried out without due process. They allege no other structures have been demolished.

"They should have at least given us a warning. We would have paid the fine as well," says Abdul Sindhi, a resident of Siyai village. Says Safi Jamil, Barmer president of the All India Majlis-e-Ittehadul Muslimeen (AIMIM): "They are trying to create a rift between Hindus and Muslims but this seems to be failing. Many Hindus are supporting us and participated in the rally."

Paradiya sarpanch Sorta Ram Meghwal, who joined the Sarv Dharm Shanti Sabha rally, says there are many structures, including temples, on Gochar land.

"We're not supporting encroachments, but if the government has decided to demolish one set of structures, it should do the same for others too. When you are a minority, you cannot raise your voice against injustice, but it shakes the democratic foundations of this country. Hindus and Muslims have lived harmoniously in Barmer all these years, such incidents make people bitter towards each other. They should follow the raj dharma, not rajneeti. Otherwise, we will take to the streets and fill jails," he says.

Barmer Collector Chinmay Gopal; Superintendent Chuna Ram Jat; and Rajasthan Director General of Police (Law & Order) Sanjay Kumar Agarwal declined to comment. The Border Security Force declined to respond.

For residents, the notices came as a shock but have also become a unifying force.

"When the administration left, every Hindu in my village was at my house expressing grief over the mosque. No Muslim cooked food for four days after the demolition and Hindus used to send food for us," Hishamuddin says.

On November 13, 2024, the Supreme Court held that demolitions without due process violate the rule of law and said affected parties must receive prior notice and at least 15 days to respond. Residents claim that although the notices — under Section 91 of the Rajasthan Land Revenue Act, 1956 — were dated earlier in the month, they received them only a day before the demolitions.

At Kerkori, residents claim they received the June 11 notice only on June 17. Issued under Section 91 of the 1956 law, it alleged encroachment on Gochar

land and directed the mosque's mauvi, Hishamuddin Sindhi, to vacate the land or appear before the court on June 18.

"The patwari brought the notice around 7:30 pm," says Hishamuddin Sindhi. "I was still at the masjid. We've been worshipping at this mosque for the last 30 years."

The villagers then held a meeting and headed to the local tehsil office the next day. By then, residents say, the bulldozers resided in.

"Seven big trucks and 60-pollce jeeps came to the village. The demolition drive lasted two hours," says village resident Rafiq Sindhi.

Residents say the mosque was rebuilt as a pucca structure two years ago with village donations. "We kept a locked box inside the mosque to collect donations. By contributing small amounts over five years, we were able to build a modest pucca mosque, now demolished," says Sulieman Sindhi, another resident.

In Malana, 3 km from the international border, there's a wall of silence around the demolition, though a pile of rubble marks where the village mosque once stood. A resident says the notice was served on June 17 and the structure was flattened the next day. In Siyai, 15 km away, local resident Faizu Khan walks through the wreckage. Behind him stands a turquoise-painted minaret with a gold finial. On June 20, a day after the village received the demolition notice, the 40-year-old Siyai mosque was razed.

The demolitions form the basis of a writ petition by Peer Mohammad Shah Jilani Dargah Samiti in the Rajasthan High Court. Court documents show that at the July 3 hearing, the petitioners said the notices were served in a "cyclostyled and mechanical manner, reflecting a predetermined approach, particularly under Section 22 of the 1954 Act", and that national security could not override the principles of natural justice.

The state government claimed the matter involved national security. It also said permission from the Collector is mandatory for establishing religious structures, and that "some petitioners had failed to obtain such permission before constructing premises within the 50-kilometre border belt".

The case will now be heard on July 7. The Opposition has sought to corner the ruling BJP, accusing it of trying to stir the communal pot ahead of the panchayat polls.

"Tharwasis (the people of Thar) will remain united," says Ummeda Ram Beniwal, Congress MP from Barmer's Baytu Lok Sabha constituency, while Sheo MLA Ravindra Singh Bhati says: "National security is important but not at the cost of social harmony".

When contacted, BJP state president Madan Rathore says he's "unaware of any mosque demolition cases in Rajasthan". He adds: "If anything of that sort has happened, it must have been due to illegal encroachment on government land. We don't harass anyone on the basis of religion or caste."

Says Nand Kishore, sarpanch of Ranasar village in Barmer: "This area has never seen communal tensions. If the government wants to remove structures on pastoral land, it should do so for everyone. One community should not be targeted. I know a lot of BJP workers and their members are not happy with these incidents."

was designated as a global terrorist by the US in August 2012.

Union Home Minister Amit Shah, in a post on X, said "Pursuing PM Shri Narendra Modi Ji's vision of zero tolerance against terror, the MHA today declared 23 dreaded terror functionaries affiliated with banned organisations as terrorists under the provisions of the UAPA. The designated terrorists are involved in anti-India activities, carrying out terror attacks, inciting terror, trafficking arms, infiltrating through the border, facilitating terrorist organisations, raising funds and recruiting terrorists. Out of the 23 terrorists announced today, 17 are Pakistani nationals and 6 are Indian nationals. However, all of them at present operate terrorist activities from Pakistan and Pakistan-occupied Jammu and Kashmir."

According to the MHA, formally designating these individuals as terrorists will not only help dismantle the terror ecosystem by curbing their financial networks, movements, re-

cruitment capabilities, and terror-linked activities, but will also send a strong message of deterrence against and terrorists acts.

It will also enhance the capacity of security and law enforcement agencies to initiate coordinated legal, investigative, and preventive actions at national and international levels.

Among those designated as terrorists is Masood Ilyas Kashmiri, also known as Mufti Masood Ilyas. The notification describes him as a 41-year-old national, currently residing in Rawalkot in Pakistan-occupied Jammu and Kashmir. He is a senior JeM functionary involved in recruiting youths, imparting training, and facilitating infiltration into India. The Centre has also linked him to the April 22, 2022 attack on security forces at Sunjwan in Jammu.

"Mohammad Mussadiq, also known as Doctor alias Hamza, a 38-year-old resident of Shakargarh in Narowal district of Pakistan, has also been designated. He is one of the main handlers of

JeM infiltration of Pakistani terrorists into J-K and was involved in the Sunjwan attack. He supplied arms and ammunition through drones across the border and is also involved in handling a team of JeM cyber players who use various social media platforms to recruit youths," the notification stated.

Fifty-two-year-old Mufti Muhammad Asghar Khan, also known as Abu Saad, a resident of Abbaspur in PoK, has also been listed. "He is a launching commander of JeM terrorists in J-K and one of the masterminds of the November 29, 2016, attack on the Indian Army camp at Nagrota in Jammu," the notification said.

The Centre has also designated as terrorist 56-year-old Hafiz Abdul Shakoor, who works as a launching commander for JeM in J-K and was involved in the 2016 Nagrota attack. Abdullah Jehadi, 47, also involved in the attack on the Indian Army camp at Nagrota, too has been listed.



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MEMBER OF LAST-ELECTED GOVT BODY OF CLUB MOVES COURT AGAINST CENTRE’S NOTICE

Pre-conceived design to take over Gymkhana property: Civil suit in HC

Damini Nath
New Delhi, July 4

CHALLENGING THE Union government’s June 29 eviction notice to the Delhi Gymkhana Club, a civil suit filed by a club member in the Delhi High Court has said that the notice relies on a clause of the imperial-era lease that is “unworkable” and that behind the move lies a “pre-conceived design” to take over the property.

The suit filed by Urmila Gupta, a permanent voting member and a part of the last-elected government body of the Club – moved by advocate Gaurav M Liberhan on Friday – argued that the Land & Development Office’s (L&DO) eviction notice to the Club and its May 22 letter ending the perpetual lease of the land is illegal. The civil suit is listed for hearing on Monday.

Since 2022, the Club has been managed by government-appointed directors on orders of the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT). This was after the Ministry of Corporate Affairs moved the NCLT alleging irregularities in the manage-



The Gymkhana Club. FILE

ment of the Club.

On May 22, the L&DO wrote to the Club terminating the lease that was signed on February 28, 1928, saying it needed the 27.03 acre plot on Safdarjung Road for “strengthening and securing defence infrastructure and other vital public security purposes”.

“The land is essential to fulfil urgent institutional needs, governance infrastructure, and

public-interest projects, integrated with the resumption of adjoining government lands,” it said, referring to its recent taking over of the Jaipur Polo Ground and clearing of slums in the area near the Prime Minister’s residence.

Under Clause 4 of the lease, the government could take back the land if it was needed for a public purpose.

Then on June 29, the L&DO

issued an eviction notice under the Public Premises (Eviction of Unauthorised Occupants) Act, 1971 asking the Club’s representative to appear before it on July 7 for a hearing.

The civil suit pointed to a contradiction in the May 22 letter. While Clause 4 of the lease, as cited in the L&DO letter, said the government can re-enter – that is take possession of – and then determine, which means end the lease and change the allotment, the letter said the government is determining and then re-entering the property.

It added that this goes against Clause 4 of the lease and that this was done without issuing a show-cause notice to the Club.

“...the impugned order/letter is ex-facie illegal, and contrary to legal principles based upon a pre-conceived design to appropriate the property of the Gymkhana Club,” the suit said.

It added that Clause 4 of the lease, which was allotted by the Secretary of State for India in Council in 1928, itself was contrary to law.

“...alternatively Clause 4 as existing is unworkable, grant extensive power and is however contrary to law being inconsistent with the grant of the suit property to the Gymkhana Club, therefore, Clause 4 is liable to be declared void and unenforceable being contrary to law and unconscionable,” the suit added.

The land was given to the Club – an incorporated company – on payment of Rs 5,460. As per the lease, it was to be used for “a club and purposes for which the same are customarily used, including the holding of banquets, concerts and dances and the lodging and boarding of the members residing in the premises...” the civil suit further said.

The L&DO has argued that it needs the land back for public purposes. In its eviction notice, it has said that the premises “constitute valuable public premises vested in the Union of India and the Government is under an obligation to regulate, protect and utilise such public property in accordance with public interest and public purpose”.

DELHI COURT HEARS FARMHOUSE FIRING CASE

‘Don’t need *Singham* or *Pushpa* in state governed by law’: BJP MLA gets 4-year jail

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, July 4

A DELHI court on Saturday sentenced Bihar BJP MLA Raju Kumar Singh to four years in prison in a case of celebratory firing inside his farmhouse in South Delhi’s Fatehpur Beri on New Year’s Eve in 2018. The firing had led to the death of a 45-year-old woman.

“We need neither a *Singham* nor a *Pushpa* in a state governed by the rule of law. The brazen act of firing by Raju Kumar Singh was, however, an inspiration to both such aspirations,” said Special Judge Vishal Gogne of Rouse Avenue Court in his order. “...the court finds it quite foreseeable that such acts of firing by a MLA embolden others to emulate such conduct in similar or even larger measure. The rank and file of those who seek macho gratification with the imagery of guns being fired would include not only the lawless criminals but also uniform clad protectors of the law,” he added.

Judge Gogne also said that



BJP MLA Raju Singh. ANI

Singh will pay Rs 25 lakh as compensation to the victim’s family. Singh was convicted under Section 304 (II) (culpable homicide not amounting to murder) of the IPC and under Section 30 of the Arms Act (punishment for contravention of licence or rule) on June 6.

During a New Year’s Eve gathering at his farmhouse at Ambedkar Colony’s Rose Farm, Singh had fired gunshots in the air, which hit a woman named Archana Gupta. She died during treatment at a hospital.

“Such display and use of weapons by a MLA conveys to criminals that a gun is a weapon

of choice, flaunting and assertion. Considering that certain states in India are known to harbor illicit production facilities for local firearms, the sight of a MLA acting like a strongman by untrammelled use of firearms, even on social occasions, encourages an ecosystem of illicit firearms,” Judge Gogne said in the order. “...many an aspiring gang leader or strong man has stepped into politics in our nation on the strength of the gun, earning thereby the notorious sobriquet of Bahubali. In his zeal to be seen as gun wielding politician, the conduct of the convict not only betrays the public trust of his constituents but also encourages a general subscription to his conduct by criminal elements,” he added.

The prosecution had examined 33 witnesses, among whom seven were eyewitnesses. Primarily, three eyewitnesses supported the charge against Singh – Vikas Gupta, the husband of the deceased and the complainant in the case, his cousin Puneet and Puneet’s wife Sapna.

Man hits wife with battery, kills her over infidelity suspicion, later dies by suicide

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 4

A 28-YEAR-OLD man allegedly killed his wife by striking her on the head with a battery after suspecting her of talking to someone on the phone and then died by suicide by consuming aluminium phosphide tablets, in Outer Delhi’s Ranhola, police said on Saturday.

The incident came to light on the evening of July 2 after Ranhola police station received a PCR call regarding an alleged attempt to murder a woman at Tilangpur Kotla village.

According to police, when officers reached the ground floor of a rented accommodation, they found Nisha, aged around 23-24 years, with a severe head injury.

She was rushed to Sanjay Gandhi Memorial Hospital, Mangolpuri, where doctors declared her brought dead, said officers.

Police said Nisha had got married to Vinay about four to five years ago.

The couple, along with their daughter – aged around three – had been living as tenants in the locality for the last six to seven months. Vinay worked in a private company in Uttam Nagar, they added.

“Preliminary investigation suggests that Vinay allegedly assaulted Nisha with an Exide battery after suspecting her of speaking to someone over the

phone.

After the assault, he allegedly consumed aluminium phosphide (commonly known as Sulphas) tablets,” said an officer.

“Vinay then took the couple’s daughter to his mother’s rented accommodation in Kotla Vihar, about 150 m away. He informed his sister, Priya, that he had killed his wife and had also consumed poison,” the officer added.

When Priya reached the couple’s rented room, she found Nisha lying in a pool of blood.

She alerted the neighbours, who informed the police. Vinay, meanwhile, was taken to Sanjay Gandhi Memorial Hospital, where he was also declared brought dead.

Police said postmortem examinations have been conducted, and the bodies have been handed over to their families for the last rites.

An FIR has been filed at Ranhola police station under Section 103(I) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, which deals with murder.

‘No option but to follow SC order’: Court denies bail to Umar Khalid, Sharjeel Imam

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 4

A DELHI court on Saturday rejected the bail applications of Umar Khalid and Sharjeel Imam in the larger-conspiracy terror case linked to the 2020 Northeast Delhi riots, underlining that it had “no option but to follow” the Supreme Court order dated January 5.

On January 5, the apex court had refused bail to Khalid and Imam in the larger-conspiracy case, while granting the relief to co-accused Gulfisha Fatima, Meeran Haider, Shifa Ur Reh-

man, Mohammad Saleem Khan and Shadab Ahmad. A bench of Justices Aravind Kumar and N V Anjaria had then observed that there was a prima-facie case against Khalid and Imam under the stringent Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA) and held that all accused could not be treated equally in view of the “hierarchy of participation”.

Only on the completion of the examination of the protected witnesses, the apex court had said, or upon expiry of one year from the date of said order, whichever is earlier, Imam and Khalid would be at liberty to

renew their prayer for grant of bail.

As the matter came up before him on Saturday, Additional Sessions Judge Sameer Bajpai of Karkardooma Court said that the bail pleas of the accused were not maintainable in court and he could neither entertain the pleas nor grant them relief. “This court has no option but to follow the judgment dated January 5, 2026, as passed by the Supreme Court, whereby the petitions of both the applicants were dismissed. Following the said order of the Supreme Court, this court cannot enter-

tain the applications and grant bail to the applicants. In fact, the applications are not maintainable and they are hereby dismissed,” the Judge said.

“Since then, there are no substantial changes of circumstances as pleaded by the applicants and there arises no question to re-consider the bail of the applicants,” the Judge underlined. Khalid and Imam were booked under the stringent UAPA for allegedly being part of a larger conspiracy linked to the February 2020 riots in North-east Delhi, which left 53 people dead and over 700 injured.

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ADMISSION NOTICE 2026 4-YEAR INTEGRATED TEACHER EDUCATION PROGRAMME (ITEP)
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Central University of Kashmir announces admission to 4-year Integrated Teacher Education Programme (ITEP) for the academic session 2026-2027. Candidates who have appeared in NCET-2026 conducted by National Testing Agency (NTA) and are interested in seeking admission to 4-year integrated teacher education programme (B.A. B.Ed. & B.Sc. B.Ed.) offered by the Central University of Kashmir, are hereby informed to register for admission. The registration process shall start from 3rd July, 2026 (5:00 PM). For detailed information regarding registration process & eligibility, the candidates are advised to visit University website: www.cukashmir.ac.in. S/d Director (U/C) Date: 3/7/2026. Directorate of Admissions

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ADMISSION ANNOUNCEMENT

Executive Diploma Programme (Law) 2026-27

Last Date for Submission of Applications: 31.07.2026

The NATIONAL LAW UNIVERSITY, DELHI invites applications for admission to the Executive Diploma Programme (Law) for the Academic Year 2026-27 commencing from 1st September 2026. The Executive Diploma Programme (Law) is a Diploma Programme conducted through a mixed mode of distance education and contact learning. The programme will be for a period of one academic year, spread over two semesters. The academic year will run from September to August. Contact classes will be held at NLU Delhi. Eligibility, total seats and other details of the programme are as under:

Eligibility: A person who has completed their graduation/post graduation in any discipline, with a minimum of 50% marks and has been in service, or has had professional experience for at least three years will be eligible to enroll for the programme. The students currently enrolled in other programme at NLU Delhi shall not be eligible to apply for the Executive Diploma Programme (Law).

Total Seats: All the applicants, who are found eligible, will be admitted to the programme.

Duration of the Programme: One year

Fee: The tuition fees for the programme for Indian Nationals shall be Rs. 1,00,000 [One Lakh only]. For foreign nationals, the amount shall be USD 10800 [One Thousand Eighty only].

Interested candidates should apply online only. For further details relating to application form and eligibility criteria visit <http://www.nludelhi.ac.in>

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CORRIGENDUM

With reference to the advertisement published in this newspaper on 28.05.2026 titled "Request for Proposal (RFP) for Selection of Master Developer for development of AI City-cum-Business Park at Vrindavan Yojna IT City, Lucknow", bearing Reference No. 798/YR-4/61 and dated 27.05.2026.

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‘EV policy for common people... maybe in next phase, will include hybrid vehicles too’



The much-awaited EV policy is here. Have you set any targets that you want to meet next year?

This new EV policy is very different, special and common man-centric. We have given all kinds of possible incentives to the people. We have given subsidy, scrapping incentive, road tax, registration exemption – everything. So, the target you talk about, we have uncapped it. We have not put any capping (on incentives and subsidies); unlike other states, wherever EV policy was implemented, it came with capping.

We want as many people as possible to avail the benefits, so that the city improves, the air improves. The more they avail the benefits, the more successful we will be and the faster we will eliminate pollution.

Draft policy proposed 50% road tax and registration waiver for strong hybrids but it was dropped in the final policy. Why?

The way a hybrid engine works is that, at the time you accelerate, even slightly, it automatically switches to petrol and the electric feature doesn't really work.

The second thing is pocket. Currently, we have invested Rs 15,000 crore in the big segment – two-wheelers and autorickshaws, one of the biggest contributors of pollution. So, for the big component, we gave a big incentive. So, we need to take this policy in a phase-wise manner. This EV policy is for the next three to four years. Maybe in the next phase, we will include hybrid vehicles too.

If a new technology for hybrids comes or if it supports clean fuel, will you consider it?

Today, we are focused on the most feasible technology we have, and that is EV. So, we adopted it immediately. In the future, if a better option comes, we can equally take it up.

How different is your EV policy in comparison to the previous policy? In the previous policy, people struggled to get subsidy, which they had to apply for at the dealership only with their help while buying the vehicle. Under this policy, people have to apply for subsidy themselves?

The previous government did launch a policy but it had several gaps and leakages, due to which neither the benefits reached the intended beneficiaries nor they had an intent to give incentives. Even pending subsidy amounts from the earlier regime have been cleared by our government to ensure that public trust in both the govern-

ment and EV adoption remains strong. We have disbursed Rs 45 crore in subsidy payments.

Our government has now created a dedicated portal and within 60 days of receiving the Registration Certificate (RC), the buyers will receive the subsidy amount in their account through Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT). Applicants can apply themselves now and payments will be made directly to manufacturers by the government... The dealers are mandated to inform buyers whether the vehicles they are buying are eligible for subsidy or not.

You have set strict mandates and timelines for adoption of EV two- and three-wheelers. But one big concern is inadequate charging infrastructure.

The success of this policy depends on the success of the charging infrastructure. It is also one of our key priorities. Not only the government, but all government agencies, departments and OEMs (original equipment manufacturers) will work together on this. We have made OEMs, whose products will be sold in the market, responsible for the development of the charging infrastructure. The Delhi Transco Limited has been made the nodal agency, so that it can ensure availability of adequate power and charging network while overseeing strengthening of sub-stations.

Another important step we have taken is the provision of a single-window clearance system for those investing in and developing charging infrastructure. They should not face any unnecessary hurdles and the government will provide them with full support.

In fact, this will open up a new segment for employment, entrepreneurship and investment. A new industry will emerge in Delhi and many will build businesses around the charging infrastructure.

Have you set any year-wise target to achieve this?

Currently, we have around 9,000 charging points. On average, we will expand this every year, adding about 10,000 charging points annually until we reach the target of 32,000.

We have already created charging infrastructure at bus depots and terminals. Gradually, as our requirements grow, we will expand the network.

Two-wheeler owners largely belong to the middle-income group. As per studies, 60% of them rely on this mode for long-distance travel and work. Do you think e-bikes have that capacity to match petrol bikes?

E-bikes have better capacity than petrol bikes (for long distance travel). People wanted to switch to electric two-wheelers but they could not do so because of the cost gap. Keeping this in mind, the government has provided the highest incen-

Days after unveiling the Delhi Electric Vehicle Policy 2026, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta talks to Gayathri Mani on how the new measures would reduce air pollution, create jobs and transform Delhi while also benefitting the common man.



PHOTOS BY PRAVEEN KHANNA

tives for two wheelers. There is purchase subsidy of Rs 30,000, scrapping incentive of Rs 10,000, along with exemptions on road tax and registration charges. Taken together, I believe the total incentive comes to around Rs 60,000-70,000 per vehicle.

So, people are happy to shift to EVs... and when people will get charging facilities in every location across the city, they would be able to cover even longer routes. We held multiple meetings with stakeholders, and based on those discussions, we decided to give the highest priority to the largest segment.

If you speak to people who are already using EVs, they will tell you that it almost feels as if the vehicle is running free of cost. The fuel savings are so substantial that it feels like there is hardly any operating expense... So, people are happy.

There is a huge dependence on China for EV batteries. How will you address this? Also, we are seeing that Chinese apps can control and shut down e-rickshaws, which is a safety threat.

We have taken a few steps in this regard. First, we have ensured EVs covered under the policy must be registered in Delhi. Secondly, we have given preference to Indian companies and Indian-made products to reduce dependency on China. A few days ago, when this issue (of e-rickshaws shutting down) surfaced, the government acted immediately.

Going forward, the government will ensure that batteries of better quality are used and such things do not happen – through apps or hacking.



There is no question of ifs and buts in our policy. Please have trust and confidence in the government. Within just one year, a comprehensive EV policy has been implemented with 360-degree efforts... We will make it 100% successful; the government is working on it wholeheartedly.



The policy is designed for the common people and the middle class because they depend on their vehicles the most for daily travel. A wealthy person may own four cars and one among them may be an EV. But a middle-class family usually has just one car or one scooter – their dream as well as their medium of daily utility.



Previous govt's policy had many gaps... neither the benefits reached the beneficiaries nor they had intent to give incentives.... We have disbursed Rs 45 crore in pending subsidy payments



We have designed this policy as an end-to-end solution. While we are providing subsidies, we are also planning e-waste plants for battery disposal... Overall, it is a fool-proof policy... It combines regulatory mandates with incentives to encourage people to adopt EVs. Ultimately, keeping this city clean is a shared responsibility, and we all need to work together to achieve that.

Registrations of petrol two-wheelers will stop in the next two years. At the same time, a large number of two-wheelers and autos registered around 2011-2013 will complete their 15-year lifespan. Do you have a plan for phasing out these vehicles?

Yes, the scrapping and subsidy benefits are meant exactly for this purpose. We have provided scrapping incentives for every category of vehicle – e-rickshaws, autorickshaws, even *jugaad*-type vehicles, N1 category vehicles and cars... The idea behind the scrapping incentive is to phase out older petrol vehicles and encourage people to

get their overaged vehicles scrapped and replace it with EV.

For four-wheelers priced below Rs 30 lakh, we are giving an incentive of Rs 1 lakh for cars, which is big. When people get such incentives, it motivates them to replace their old vehicles immediately.

The policy is primarily designed for the common people and the middle class because they depend on their vehicles the most for daily travel. A wealthy person may own four cars and one among them may be an EV. But a middle-class family usually has just one car or one scooter – which is their dream as well as their medium of daily utility. So, this policy is specifically targeted for the middle class.

Delhi has thousands of small mechanic shops and workshops that service petrol and diesel vehicles. People in this sector will now be significantly affected. Is the government planning any training or skill development programme to help them learn EV repair skills?

Earlier, people used to operate pedal rickshaws. Then e-rickshaws came and people naturally upgraded... Today, an e-rickshaw driver earns around Rs 20,000 a month. Society adapts and moves to the next stage on its own.

Similarly, EVs will create many new job and business opportunities. As I said earlier, charging infrastructure itself is going to become a major sector. It will require people to operate it, maintain it and manage it. Likewise, EVs will also need trained mechanics.

The industry naturally responds to these emerging requirements. Training programmes are already underway. The government is strengthening its skill centres so that people can also learn about EV technology. The government is already working in that direction.

It is said that EV batteries, especially of cars, have a life of 5-6 years. After that they require replacement and retrofitting is expensive. Do you have any plan to subsidise the same or any talks with OEMs?

OEMs will equally participate and share responsibilities across all aspects – from battery replacement to retrofitting – and will also help find pocket-friendly solutions to customers. The entire ecosystem will be made more cost-effective and consumer-friendly.

With the rollout, things will gradually settle down and improve over time, because this is an open market. Any industry that wants to survive, will find its own solutions, create new opportunities and offer better services to consumers...

People have been complaining about

use of ethanol-blended petrol that is affecting the mileage and engine capacity of their cars. Have you received any complaints in this regard?

No... as of now, we have not received any such complaints.

The EV policy indicates mandates for four-wheelers. Can Delhi expect strict mandates for petrol and diesel cars in future?

We have already set mandates for N2 BS-VI vehicles and N1 trucks, starting from January 1, 2027. These vehicles are called *chhota haathi*, and mostly ply in the city. So, the government has placed strong emphasis on this segment.

We have also provided good scrappage incentives for different categories of vehicles, including cars... This policy will be in place for four years but in the future, as and when more requirements arise, they (four-wheelers) will be included within this framework.

If charging infrastructure or subsidy disbursement faces delay, will the timelines for phasing out new petrol two-wheelers be revised?

There is no question of ifs and buts in our policy... Have trust and confidence in the government. Within just one year, a comprehensive EV policy has been implemented with 360-degree efforts... We will make it 100% successful; the government is working on it wholeheartedly.

What is your larger roadmap to address pollution in Delhi?

We presented a Rs 1 lakh crore budget and earmarked Rs 22,000 crore as 'Green Budget' to curb pollution – road infrastructure, dust mitigation, vehicular emission, sanitation and waste management. The government allocated dedicated funds to the MCD to purchase litter picker machines and mechanical road sweeping machines. Resources have been provided to eliminate Delhi's garbage mountains and to revive water bodies.

Reducing pollution in Delhi requires action on multiple fronts, and we are making efforts in every direction.

For the first time, capital expenditure has crossed 30% of Delhi's budget. Earlier, it rarely exceeded Rs 5,000-7,000 crore, as a large share of the Budget was spent on free schemes... Today, we are investing significantly in long-term projects to curb pollution, improve infrastructure, develop new roads, flyovers and make the city clean and beautiful.

Delhi is transforming... has chosen a new direction, one focused on building a cleaner, more modern and better future. The EV policy is also a part of this transformation, and we believe it will usher in a new era of cleaner mobility, making Delhi a cleaner and better city for everyone.

Thunderstorms, light rain likely over next few days

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 4

TWO DAYS after the Southwest Monsoon reached Delhi, parts of the city received moderate spells of rain on Saturday. The IMD issued several yellow alerts through the day before upgrading the warning to an orange alert by evening amid intensifying thunderstorm activity.

Rainfall remained uneven across the city. While the city's base observatories recorded only trace rainfall in the 24 hours ending 8.30 am, showers picked up later in the day.

Between 11.30 am and 2.30 pm, Pusa recorded 23.5 mm of rainfall, the highest in Delhi, followed by Janakpuri (9.5 mm), Ridge (3.8 mm) and Mayapuri (1 mm). During the next three hours ending 5.30 pm, Pitampura received 0.5 mm of rain.

The IMD has forecast generally cloudy skies over the next few days, with spells of light rain, thunderstorms and lightning likely. Gusty winds of up to 50 kmph are expected on Sunday

• Skywatch



Forecast: July 5, 2026
Generally cloudy sky; spell of very light to light rainfall
MAX: 33-35
1.6°C below normal
MIN: 27-29
0.9°C below normal

• AQI Tracker



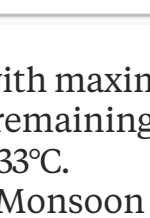
ITO
Moderate
AQI: 107



Bawana
Poor
AQI: 228



Anand Vihar
Moderate
AQI: 163



Rohini
Moderate
AQI: 133

and Monday, with maximum temperatures remaining between 30°C and 33°C.

Southwest Monsoon had



Vehicles waded through a waterlogged road at Mandawali in Delhi after heavy rainfall on Saturday. ANI

reached Delhi on Thursday, five days later than its normal onset date of June 27.

The Capital's Air Quality

Index (AQI) was recorded in the 'Moderate' category on Saturday and the 24-hour average AQI stood at 123 at 4 pm, as com-

pared to the average AQI of 105 (Moderate), recorded at the same time Friday, as per Central Pollution Control Board data.

DJB work set to hit water supply in East & South Delhi for 2 days

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 4

MULTIPLE PARTS in East and South Delhi are set to see a disruption in water supply on Monday (July 6) and Tuesday (July 7) due to maintenance work at Sonia Vihar Water Treatment Plant (WTP), the Delhi Jal Board (DJB) said on Saturday. Apart from the maintenance work, the DJB underlined, construction of a boundary wall along the Taimoor Nagar drain is being carried out in compliance with a Delhi High Court ruling in May amid concerns over waterlogging.

Sonia Vihar Water Treatment Plant, with a 635 million liters per day (MLD) capacity, is one of Delhi's largest water treatment facilities. It treats raw water drawn from the Upper Ganga Canal at Muradnagar and plays a key role in meeting the Capital's daily water demand. It supplies drinking

water to large parts of South, Central and East Delhi.

In a statement, the DJB said it will undertake maintenance works at the water treatment plant for the interconnection of a newly laid water pipeline near the Taimoor Nagar drain.

Major maintenance works on the 1,900-mm South Delhi main of the WTP will affect water supply for eight hours on Monday, starting 10 am. As a result, water supply in the affected areas may either remain unavailable or be available at low pressure until the evening, the statement read.

Areas likely to be impacted include CWG Village, Patparganj, Okhla, Zakir Nagar, Batla House, Siddharth Enclave, Khan Market, Aliganj, Jor Bagh, Lodhi Colony, Nizamuddin, Ambedkar Nagar, South Extension, Lajpat Nagar, Sarai Kale Khan, K and L Pockets of Sarita Vihar, Greater Kailash (South), Chhatrapur, Srinivasपुरi, Amar

Colony, Malviya Nagar and adjoining localities.

Water supply will also remain affected from 10 am on Tuesday until 4 pm to facilitate the interconnection of a newly laid 1,500-mm mild steel water pipeline near Khizrabad Village along the Taimoor Nagar drain, according to the statement.

The shutdown may impact supply from underground reservoirs, including Sarai Kale Khan, Apollo, Sarita Vihar and Greater Kailash (South), as well as areas supplied through the Malviya Nagar Water Services and the Greater Kailash Master Balancing Reservoir.

Localities expected to witness disruption include Ashram, Jangpura-B, Badarpur, East of Kailash, Saket, Geetanjali Enclave, Malviya Nagar, Chirag Delhi, Panchsheel Park, Greater Kailash-II and III, CR Park, Hauz Khas, Gulmohar Park, Green Park, Mehrauli, Vasant Kunj and adjoining areas.



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05th July 2026 (Today)
before scheme ends*

Allocation Date
07th July 2026 (Tuesday)

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Sl. No.	Plot Size (Sq. Yd.)	Plot Size (Sq. Mtr.)	Rate per Sq. Yd.	Registration Amount	10% Within 5 Days	20% Within 30 Days (Bank Loan Available)	70% As Per Construction Linked Plan (Bank Loan Available)	Total Cost
1	131.72	110.13	₹ 80,000	₹ 21,000	₹ 10,32,760	₹ 21,07,520	₹ 73,76,320	₹ 1,05,37,600
2	140.47	117.45	₹ 80,000	₹ 21,000	₹ 11,02,760	₹ 22,47,520	₹ 78,66,320	₹ 1,12,37,600
3	160.22	133.96	₹ 80,000	₹ 21,000	₹ 12,60,760	₹ 25,63,520	₹ 89,72,320	₹ 1,28,17,600

Govt. Charges / PLC & Other charges as applicable

Registration of builder buyer agreement is mandatory after making a total payment of 10%

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- Pataudi Palace - 3 min
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- Multiple Schools within 5 Min
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- IMT Dharuhera - 10 Min
- Proposed Hospital - 1 Min

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UDAN next phase with Rs 29,000 cr outlay; PM opens Jodhpur terminal

Hamza Khan
Jaipur, July 4

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi launched the next phase of UDAN (Ude Desh ka Aam Nagrik) and inaugurated Jodhpur Airport's New Terminal Building (NTB) in Jodhpur Saturday.

On the occasion, Union Minister of Civil Aviation Ram Mohan Naidu Kinjarapu said that the launch of the Modified UDAN Scheme "marks the beginning of a new chapter in India's aviation journey". "Since 2016, UDAN has transformed the Prime Minister's vision of 'Hawai Chappal se Hawai Jahaz' into a national movement by making air travel affordable, accessible and aspirational for every Indian," he said.

Launched in October 2016, the UDAN Scheme has operationalised 669 routes and 95 airports, heliports and water aerodromes, covering over 1.66 crore passengers. This March, the Union Cabinet had approved the Modified UDAN Scheme with an outlay of approximately Rs 29,000 crore over the next ten years to accelerate aviation-led development.

The Modified UDAN Scheme focuses on expanding regional aviation infrastructure through the development of 100 aerodromes from existing unserved airstrips with an investment of Rs 12,159 crore. It also provides Rs 2,577 crore towards Operations and Maintenance support for regional airports, development of 200 modern helipads with an investment of Rs 3,661 crore, and continued Viability Gap Fund-Free Whatsapp Channel https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F



PM Narendra Modi, Civil Aviation Minister K Ram Mohan Naidu and Rajasthan CM Bhajan Lal Sharma during the inauguration of the new terminal building of Jodhpur Airport on Saturday. PTI

Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mjlMzg1

ing of Rs 10,043 crore to sustain regional airline operations. The scheme also promotes the induction of indigenous aircraft and helicopters, including HAL Dhruv and Dornier platforms, for operations in underserved and remote regions.

Modi also inaugurated the New Terminal Building at Jodhpur Airport developed by the Airports Authority of India at a cost of Rs 480 crore. Spread across 23,342 square metres, the terminal is designed to handle 1,500 passengers during peak hours and 20 lakh passengers annually. It features 20 check-in counters, advanced security screening systems, modern baggage handling facilities and six aerobridges, ensuring a seamless passenger experience.

The newly developed apron can accommodate 11 A-321 aircraft and one ATR-72 aircraft, while the city-side infrastructure provides parking for approximately 320 cars, the government said.

EXPRESS special

Temple donation 'theft', UGC rules row: Ahead of UP polls, BJP's focus on prompt action, correction

Lalmani Verma
Lucknow, July 4

CONCERNED OVER the political implications of the alleged theft of donations at Ayodhya's Ram Temple ahead of the 2027 UP Assembly polls, the BJP's central leadership on Saturday asked its members in the state to deal with the issue "carefully" and tell people about the action taken by the BJP-led state government in the matter so far, promising them prompt action against the culprits.

At a meeting with BJP MPs and MLAs, party president Nitin Nabin spoke on the Ram Temple donation theft and the UGC regulations row that erupted earlier this year, said sources. Nabin said the alleged embezzlement of donations has hurt the entire

Hindu society and the BJP organisation. "He called the theft a 'mistake' done by some 'wrong people' and assured that the mistake will be corrected and the government will take every action to punish the guilty and bring more transparency (in counting of donations)."

The sources said Nabin accused the Opposition parties of "conspiring" to politicise the temple donation theft issue and gave the example of the recent Ayodhya visit by AAP convener Arvind Kejriwal.

On the UGC regulations row, following which some upper caste leaders from UP districts resigned from the BJP, Nabin said the party members should not panic or react abruptly to any such issue. "Nabin-ji said the intention behind the new UGC

regulations was not wrong and whatever has happened, the government will correct that too," said a BJP leader.

Sources said BJP's national general secretary (organisation) B L Santhosh spoke on the temple donation row in the presence of Nabin in a closed-door meeting with newly appointed state office-bearers, morcha presidents, regional and district presidents at the BJP state headquarters in Lucknow. Sources said Santhosh also expressed concern over the UGC regulations controversy. UP Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath was also present at the meeting.

"Santhosh-ji, in his address, asked us to be careful on both Ram Temple and UGC regulations issues. He asked the party leaders to tell the people that the

issue of 'theft of donations' was unfortunate, but the UP government promptly constituted an SIT to probe the matter. An FIR has been lodged and arrests have been made," said a party leader who attended the meeting.

"About UGC row, Santhosh said some wrong use of words in the notification of the new regulations created a negative message. We have to tell this to the people," said another leader.

The UGC equity regulations 2026, notified in January this year, were meant to address discrimination, including caste bias, in higher education institutions. The new regulations, however, sparked protests and calls for withdrawal from sections of students, who claimed they could create divisions over caste and lead to "harassment" of

those in the general category.

The Supreme Court later stayed the UGC (Promotion of Equity in Higher Education Institutions) Regulations, 2026, observing that they raise important questions which, if left unexamined, could have "very sweeping consequences".

At the meeting with BJP office-bearers, Nabin said the SP and the Congress were "indulging in negative politics to divert the attention of the people because they do not have any issue against the BJP government". "We don't have to fall into the Opposition trap. We have to work for the growth of UP," he said.

He asked the party to complete the constitution of regional and district committees by this month-end and prepare for the 2027 elections.

Pirated movies, OTT content: Govt notice to Telegram, seeks report in 15 days

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, July 4

THE I&B Ministry on Saturday issued a notice to Telegram over the alleged widespread dissemination of pirated films, OTT content, and other audiovisual material through its platform, while directing the messaging app to take corrective action and submit an action-taken report within 15 days.

It is learnt that the I&B ministry has also asked Telegram to strengthen its systems for the detection, reporting, disabling of access to and removal of pirated films and infringing audio-visual content.

The Ministry has directed Telegram to act against repeat infringers, including channels, groups, bots, accounts, administrators, and associated entities, while seeking details of its grievance redressal mechanism for producers, OTT platforms, and law-enforcement agencies.

Telegram has been asked to detail measures adopted to prevent, detect, and remove pirated content from the platform in its report. According to officials, the communication signals a shift from previous piecemeal takedown to platform accountability. The government had earlier acted against over 3,000 Telegram channels for pirated content.

Reminding Telegram that, as an intermediary, it is required to observe due diligence under the IT Act and the IT Rules, the I&B Ministry has stated that Telegram should not be waiting for the government to identify each piracy channel and also emphasised that a purely reactive, channel-by-channel takedown approach may not be sufficient to demonstrate due diligence as required under the IT Act, 2000, and the IT Rules, 2021.

Jaishankar begins trip to four West Asia nations today; will visit US July 13

Part of official tour of six nations, he is scheduled to travel to Brussels July 14-15

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, July 4

EXTERNAL AFFAIRS Minister S Jaishankar is scheduled to depart Sunday on a six-nation tour, visiting four Gulf countries impacted by the West Asia war — Qatar, Bahrain, Kuwait and Oman — apart from the US and Belgium. The tour is scheduled from July 5 to 15, the Ministry said Saturday.

All these Gulf countries have hosted American military personnel, bases and military facilities for decades, and have been attacked by Iran as a retaliatory response against the US and Israeli military offensive that began in February.

Meanwhile, Qatar and Oman have also emerged as key mediators, along with Pakistan, in bringing about Iran ceasefire.

In this geopolitical context, Jaishankar's visit is timed to get a sense of the ceasefire and its aftermath. Announcing the visit, the MEA said Saturday that Jaishankar will be on an "official visit to Qatar, Bahrain, Kuwait and Oman from July 5 to 10". During the visit, the MEA said, he will be meeting his counterparts and the leadership.

"The visit will focus on enhancing our bilateral relations with the four countries and also provide an opportunity to exchange views on regional developments and issues of mutual interest," the MEA said.

Jaishankar's visit follows the visit of the Indian delegation — consisting of Bihar Governor Lt Gen (retd) Syed Ata Hasnain and MoS, External Affairs Pabitra Margerita — at



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar's visit will focus on enhancing bilateral ties with Qatar, Bahrain, Kuwait and Oman, said MEA. ANI FILE

Ayatollah Khamenei's funeral. In this backdrop, Jaishankar's visit will focus on getting a sense of the status quo so far as the US-Iran peace framework is concerned. India also has robust energy ties with all these countries, and has a flourishing diaspora working and living there.

Jaishankar is scheduled to head to the US to launch India's official campaign for UNSC tenure 2028-29, in New York on July 13. The tenure also coincides with Lok Sabha elections scheduled to be held in 2029. India has been a non-permanent member of the UNSC for eight terms, with the most recent being the 2021-22 term.

In the last leg of his tour, Jaishankar is expected to visit Brussels for the 3rd India-EU Trade and Technology Council Meeting and interact with his EU and Belgian counterparts on July 14-15. This is one of the key meetings after the two sides concluded the negotiations for the India-EU FTA earlier this year.

'Channi a crown on Cong head': Warring denies rift within party

Man Aman Singh Chhina
Chandigarh, July 4



Punjab Congress president Amrinder Singh Raja Warring

Congress's head" and an "honourable leader".

"If people gather at my house, Channi's house or Randhawa's house or at any leader's house, it does not mean that

there is any fight or factionalism," Warring said. "Channi is the senior leader and brother in the party. Partap Singh Bajwa is also our senior leader, Sukhinder Randhawa is our senior leader and we have many more like them. We have one aim that we have to bring Congress back to power in 2027. We will leave behind all our differences and emerge on a single platform."

On party's CM face, he said he had been in the race but would "stand by whoever Rahul Gandhi appoints CM. The mandate to appoint CM is with Rahul Gandhi and Mallikarjun Kharge and not with me."

● WHILE DIGVIJAYA'S 'REBUTTAL' OF MP CONGRESS CHIEF'S ALLEGATION AGAINST THE TRUST REIGNITES PARTY INFIGHTING, PATWARI HOLDS HIS GROUND, RAISING TRANSPARENCY ISSUES AND TARGETING BJP-RSS

At the centre of Digvijaya-Jitu Patwari flashpoint, what is Veer Bharat Nyas

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, July 4

THE CONGRESS in Madhya Pradesh has accused the BJP-led government of handing over land worth Rs 500 crore in Ujjain to a trust, Veer Bharat Nyas, for Re 1, to allegedly benefit its trustee Shriram Tiwari, who is CM Mohan Yadav's cultural advisor. Official records reviewed by *The Indian Express* show that Veer Bharat Nyas is a government trust under the state Culture Department, which began in 2013 with a working corpus of Rs 1,995 and no immovable property.

A review of state Cabinet minutes, Culture Department orders and the trust's own public communications shows that Veer Bharat Nyas is headquartered at Ravindra Bhawan in Bhopal, with a second facility on Ujjain's Kothi Mahal campus. The trust was constituted by the MP Culture Department in February 2013, after Cabinet's approval in 2012, and functions as an autonomous body under that department with the CM as its ex-officio Chairman.

Shriram Tiwari, who also heads the state-run Maharaja Vikramaditya Research Peeth in Ujjain, has been associated with

the trust since 2012, when he was named an ex-officio trustee by virtue of then heading the Directorate of Swaraj Sansthan under the Culture Department, a post he still holds. He was given additional charge as the trust's trustee secretary in March 2024.

Among its ongoing activities, the trust runs heritage-themed quiz competitions alongside cultural and research programmes tied to the Vikramaditya Peeth. It is this trust, and Tiwari's dual role within it as the CM's cultural advisor, that MP Congress chief Jitu Patwari raked up at a June 24 press conference in Delhi, where he alleged that government land in Ujjain worth around Rs 500 crore had been allotted to the trust for a token sum of Re 1.

Ex-CM Digvijaya Singh later seemed to contradict Patwari, claiming his own documents "establish that the concerned land hasn't been given to any private trust". Singh's "rebuttal" triggered a war of words within the state Congress, reigniting factionalism.

Trust and museum

On July 5, 2011, the state General Administration Department issued an order, convening a ministerial committee

to examine a proposed cultural project called "Veer Bharat". The committee met on February 6, 2012, with then BJP ministers Babulal Gaur, Laxmikant Sharma, Archana Chitnis, Umashankar Gupta and Ranjana Baghel in attendance, along with senior officials from the Housing and Environment and Culture departments.

As per minutes of that meeting, the principal secretary of the Housing and Environment Department briefed the committee on a study tour, telling members that "a team of officials had visited Akshardham and Virasat-e-Khalsa at Anandpur Sahib, Punjab, and inspected the work carried out there". The committee was informed that "the first phase of the Virasat-e-Khalsa project had recently been completed by Punjab government at a cost of Rs 400 crore over a period of 10 years..."

The committee arrived at several conclusions that would shape the project. It recorded that "Veer Bharat Parisar is a large project with an estimated cost of around Rs 500 crore, for which a full-time establishment and dedicated leadership will be required", and recommended that "a separate trust should be constituted under



Cong leaders Jitu Patwari (left) and Digvijaya Singh. @JITUPATWARI/X

the chairmanship of the Chief Minister, with the Culture Department functioning as its administrative department". It noted that "funds for the trust will primarily have to be provided from the government budget."

On land, the committee's assessment was that the project "would require a minimum of 100 acres", and that "in addition to the government land proposed by the Collector, Bhopal, suitable private land may also need to be acquired". It stated a preference that "it would be appropriate for the land to be located within the limits of the Bhopal Municipal Corporation", while leaving the final decision to the trust once formed.

On the character of the pro-

ject itself, the committee stated that "Veer Bharat should not be developed merely as a museum", recommending that "emphasis should be laid, as far as possible, on entertainment and interactive displays", and that components suited to PPP be identified. The minutes concluded with a decision to place these recommendations before the Council of Ministers.

The Cabinet, led by then CM Shivraj Singh Chouhan, approved the proposal on August 28, 2012. On February 14, 2013, the Department of Culture issued an order approving the creation of Veer Bharat Nyas as an autonomous trust under the department. According to that order, the trust was "conceived to plan, construct and operate

a proposed cultural complex dedicated to showcasing Indian history, culture and the country's glorious heritage." The order authorised the Directorate of Swaraj Sansthan director to complete the modalities of registering the trust, using a trust deed vetted and revised by the state Law Department.

Government records show that for more than a decade after its constitution, the trust functioned without a dedicated trustee secretary. On March 6, 2024 under the Mohan Yadav-led government, the Culture Department issued an order giving Shriram Tiwari, then director of the Maharaja Vikramaditya Research Peeth, additional charge as the trustee secretary of Veer Bharat Nyas. The order specified Tiwari would continue to hold his existing post while simultaneously discharging the new responsibility.

Land allotment

The land allotment to the trust in Ujjain followed later that year. An order issued by Ujjain Collector on September 11, 2024 cites a communication issued by the General Administration Department on February 23, 2024, which directed that the foundation stone of a proposed "Veer

Bharat Parisar", described in the communication as "a temple dedicated to India's immortal personalities and illustrious heroes", be laid in Ujjain. That communication directed that government land on which the Kothi Mahal building and campus stand in Ujjain be allotted to the Culture Department for establishing a museum there.

The Collector's order records that Veer Bharat Nyas submitted an application seeking "allotment of Survey No. 63, measuring 1,486 hectares, for establishment of a museum under Veer Bharat Nyas".

The same order references an earlier, separate proposal for the same site. It notes that the Tourism Department had at one point proposed converting Kothi Mahal into a heritage hotel, but that the Town and Country Planning Department had objected, citing the Ujjain Development Plan, 2021, under which "a hotel is not an acceptable/permissible category of land use on land earmarked for public and semi-public purposes". The Collector's order states that on this basis, "allotment of the land for a heritage hotel does not appear appropriate".

Holding that there were "no objections" to Veer Bharat's

proposed project and citing approvals from the General Administration and Culture departments and the Divisional Commissioner, the Collector ordered that "the Kothi Mahal building and campus constructed on Survey No. 63... are hereby allotted/transferred to the Madhya Pradesh Culture Department for establishment of the Veer Bharat Museum".

Congress stance

Amid the Congress row following Digvijaya's remarks, Patwari maintained his position, saying that "It doesn't matter if this is a private or public trust. My concern is why is it that BJP and RSS members are part of such trusts. There are also transparency issues, as the trust doesn't reveal its functioning or other aspects in RTI applications".

Sriram Tiwari declined to comment on the row. A senior Veer Bharat Nyas official said the trust was funded by government. "Shriram Tiwari has headed the trust and in his capacity had helped publish over 70 books when he was associated with it in 2012. The trust is run under Culture Department and has organised Mahabharat plays and other cultural programmes attended by CM," he said.

Modi greets Trump, people of US on 250th anniversary of independence

Express News Service
New Delhi, July 4

PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi on Saturday greeted US President Donald Trump and the people of the United States on the 250th anniversary of America's independence and said the two countries' shared belief in democracy and the rule of law, and the limitless potential of their people make the friendship a "force for global good".

Modi said that India and the United States share more than a strategic partnership.

"On behalf of 1.4 billion Indians, I extend my warmest congratulations to President Trump and the people of the United States on the historic 250th anniversary of your Independence," the Prime Minister said on X. He said the shared belief of India and the US in democracy and the rule of law, and the limitless potential of "our people make our friendship a force for global good".

Trust decision on Champat Rai, Anil Mishra resignations tomorrow

Maulshree Seth
Ayodhya, July 4

IN A crucial meeting on Monday in the wake of alleged Ram temple donation theft, the Shri Ram Janmbhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust will take a call on the resignations of its general secretary Champat Rai and member Anil Mishra besides deciding as who will be in charge of the temple's day-to-day affairs until the SIT submits its report.

The meeting will be presided over by Trust president

Cong seeks SC-monitored probe into Ram temple 'theft'

Panaji: Congress on Saturday demanded that PM Narendra Modi order a Supreme Court-monitored probe into the alleged theft of donations and offerings at the Ram temple in Ayodhya.

Speaking at a press conference, party general secretary KC Venugopal said he had written to the PM seeking an independent probe as serious questions had been raised over the handling of donations at the temple.

"I wrote a letter to the PM that there should be an impartial inquiry monitored by the Supreme Court to find out the real culprits of the temple theft," Venugopal said.

He referred to claims by a former Union home secretary that 1 kg of gold donated to the temple deity was not properly accounted for. "This is not an allegation by a common man. It has been made by a retired Union Home Secretary. What is happening in Ayodhya Ram temple is very painful for all of us," he said, questioning the PM's silence on the issue. PTI

'I ignore all traitors': Mamata slams rebels as key aide quits

Ravik Bhattacharya & Atri Mitra
Kolkata, July 4

THE EMBATTLED TMC chairperson and former West Bengal CM, Mamata Banerjee, Saturday called party rebels "traitors", asserting that she will continue to lead the TMC and that she prefers party workers over such leaders.

"I don't care. I ignore them all who are gone. To me workers are important than leaders. They are traitors. I ask such traitors if you have guts, go join BJP. Do you think I am dead? TMC workers are dead? Those who left had a lot of baggage and properties to save. We have TMC family to save," said Mamata on Facebook Live.

This came hours after her close aide and former minister, Chandrima Bhattacharya, resigned from all TMC posts, barely a month after she was appointed the Bengal unit chief after the party's split in the wake of its Assembly poll rout.

Soon after her resignation, Bhattacharya went to the state Assembly premises where she joined a meeting with TMC rebels including LoP Ritabrata Banerjee, Firhad Hakim and San-



TMC leader Mamata Banerjee in a video message via social media, Saturday. ANI

dipan Saha, in what signalled her possible switch.

According to party sources, Bhattacharya was at Trinamool Bhawan in Kolkata Friday evening, and left minutes after rebel MLAs barged in to take possession of the office. They changed the locks at the office and hung a banner there declaring Arup Roy as TMC chairman instead of Mamata. Sources said Mamata was upset with Bhattacharya over her "lack of resistance".

Hitting back at the TMC rebels, Mamata said: "They are trying to get the party symbol. They will never get it. Remember, you contested polls

on a symbol which was signed by me. You contested on behalf of a party founded by me. Even if EC, which works for BJP, gives them the symbol, we will fight. People are with us."

Referring to Bhattacharya's exit, Mamata said, "She told me a few days back she will resign. Before that her son (Sourav Basu, an ex-councillor) joined hands with them (rebel group). I don't care," adding "It has just been two months (since the TMC's poll defeat). So little patience you have. You were MLAs and ministers for 15 years. You are rebels now. Why were you not rebels before the polls?"

Mamata also announced that she will henceforth oversee the Bengal party unit herself. "We will include Kunal Ghosh and Madan Mitra as two state general secretaries. I am the party chairperson, I will also look after the state," she said.

Regarding the TMC rebels' bid to "capture" the party headquarters, she said: "We paid the rent for the building, which was Rs 1 lakh per month. Some people are saying they signed on the agreement — but that person was asked by the party to sign it. We have it on rent till October 2027. But they (rebels)

Shah to visit Kolkata for Syama Prasad's 125th birth anniversary

Kolkata: Union Home Minister Amit Shah will visit Kolkata Monday to attend programmes marking the 125th birth anniversary of Bharatiya Jana Sangh founder Syama Prasad Mookerjee, in one of the most significant political events in West Bengal since the formation of the new BJP government.

He is also likely to lay the foundation stone for a proposed 125-ft statue of Mookerjee in Jirat in Hooghly. PTI

**Ghaziabad Development Authority**
VIKAS PATH, GHAZIABAD
(ISO 9001 : 2015 & ISO 14001 : 2015 certified organization)

पत्रांक 43 / 4 / ई0ई0 / जोन-1 / 2026 दिनांक- 04 / 07 / 2026

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL
Ghaziabad Development Authority, Ghaziabad (GDA) intends to develop International Cricket Stadium.
Therefore, GDA invites experienced and reputed consultancy firms to submit proposal (Technical and Financial) for Selection of Project Management Consultant (PMC) for Comprehensive Design, EPC Bid Process Management, Construction Supervision and Project Management Consultancy Services for Development of an International Cricket Stadium at Morti (Raj Nagar Extension), Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh.
Details of RFP can be viewed from the website through <https://gdaghaziabad.in> and can be downloaded from UP E-Tender Portal from **date 06.07.2026**
Proposal Submission Start Date: 06.07.2026
Last date for submitting response: 27.07.2026
Bid Opening Date: 29.07.2026
Tender Fees: Rs. 13,098.00
Earnest Money Deposit (EMD): INR 10,00,000/- (through RTGS) (to be paid using the link <https://gdaghz.procure247.com/TenderPay/xlogin>.)
Pre-Bid meeting: -16.07.2026
Time & Venue: -12:00 pm, Conference Hall, Ghaziabad Development Authority Vikas Path, Ghaziabad.
Further enquiry can be made from Executive Engineer (EE Zone-1) on mobile no 7290046139 during office hours (10:00 AM To 5:00 PM).

Chief Engineer
ई-मेल : helpinegda@gmail.com, G@Gda Ghaziabad ☎ : gdagzb
हेल्पलाइन नं: 0120-4418384 कार्डसप : 9990988004 वेबसाइट : www.gdaghaziabad.in
एक सुन्दर शहर हमारा संकल्प


सत्यमेव जयते
Government of India

This Monsoon, Let's come together for

Catch the Rain campaign

take pledge for water conservation

As we cannot live without water.



Tasks, we have to perform

Adopt Rain Water Harvesting system in every home, society and workplace.

Install Recharge Pit and Shaft at appropriate places and repair the unused borewells for enabling ground water recharge.

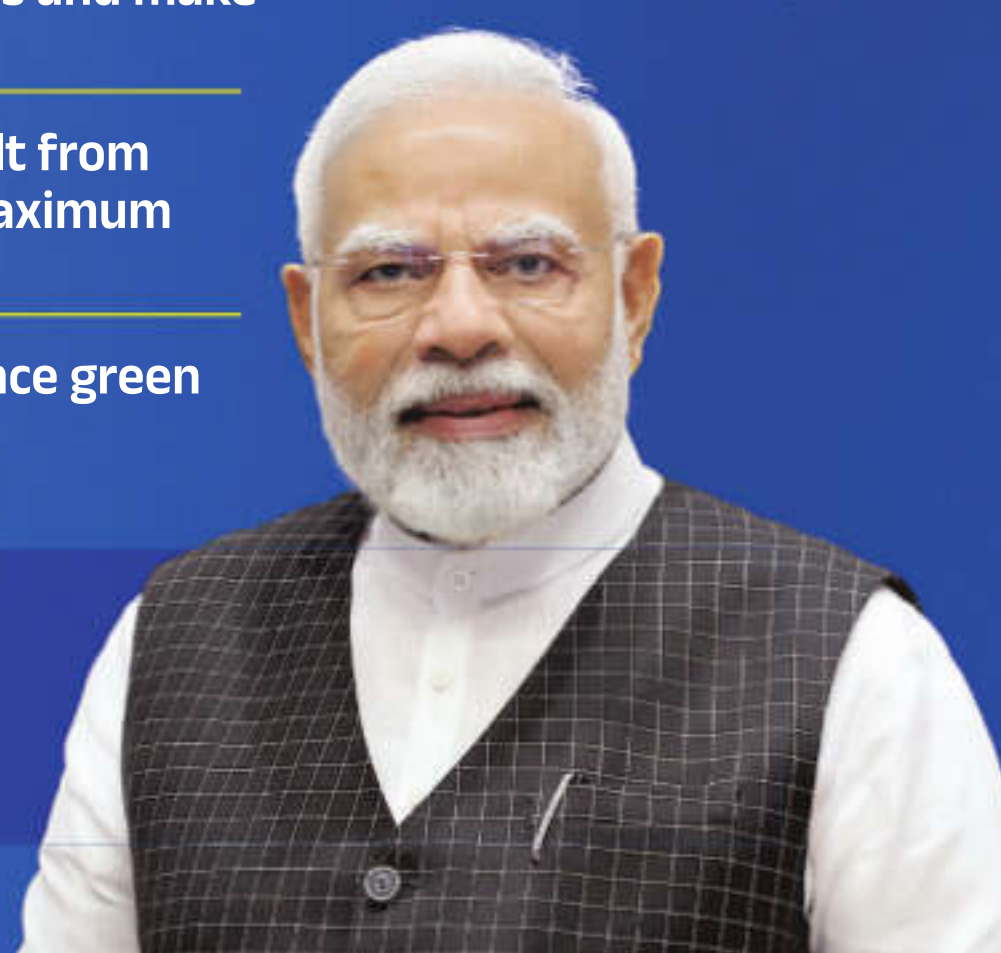
Restore Baolis, Wells and traditional Water Bodies and make them usable.

Enhance water retention capacity by removing silt from ponds and water reservoirs in your vicinity for maximum Monsoon water conservation.

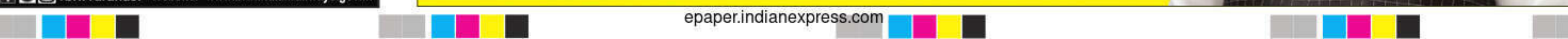
Please ensure maximum tree plantation to enhance green coverage in water retention areas.

" Catch the Rain-Through this mission, we have to collectively save every drop of rainwater. My special appeal to save every single drop of rainwater collectively."

- Prime Minister Narendra Modi



CBC 45101/13/0010/2627



**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Letter No. DRM/C/AGRA/PARKING/E-AUCTION/2026 Date:- 03.07.2026

E-Auction Notice

On behalf of the President of India, The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager-North Central Railway- Agra invites E-Auction as per categories given as under:-

Category: Parking e-Auction Catalogue No.: PARKING-AGRA-AF

Asset Details: Agra Fort, Railway Station, Agra Fort (AF) Station Daresi Side- Circulating Area- Mixed (Two Wheelers and Four Wheelers) Parking.

E-Auction Start Date and Time: Date:- 20.07.2026 Time:- 12.00

E-Auction End Date and Time: Date:- 20.07.2026 Time:- 12.30

Note:- Prospective bidders are requested to visit e-Auction Leasing Module on IREPS website (www.ireps.gov.in). The Lot-wise details are available therein under the above mentioned Catalogue Number. 1529/26 FA

North central railways  @CPRONCR  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

BANARAS LOCOMOTIVE WORKS, VARANASI-221004

Bid No. E-13/2026-2027 E-TENDERS Date: 03.07.2026

E-Tenders are invited for & on behalf of the President of India for the supply of following items. Only e-offer will be accepted for which vendors must have Class III Digital Signature and registrations on IREPS. The details of tenders are in the following sequence - S.No., Tender No., (Due Date), PL No., Description and Quantity. 01. 10261340 16/07/2026, Con Rod Bearing Lower Part No. 16150181, 4098 Nos. 02. 10261328 14/07/2026, Kit Main Bearing Lower Part No. 16060830, 243 Nos. 03. 10261307 13/07/2026, Detector ASM Part No. 16360023, 474 Nos. 04. 10261452, 09/07/2026, Development Tender for BOLT SPR LK WSHR ASM, PL No: 16240972, 320 Nos. 05. 09250000C, 16/07/2026, CABLE TIE 762 X 7.6 PA, as per Specification No. CLW SPECIFICATION NO. CLW/ES/3/0131/F To PL No. 29618733, 235235 Nos. 06. 08261201, Open Tender, (22.07.2026), Horizontal Damper Secondary Yaw, (PL No. 17452855), 1916 Nos. 07. 04265034, 23.07.2026, Bogie frame arrangement (Part No. 17023889), 10 Nos. 08. 02261176, (29/07/2026), Bolt Cylinder Crab Forging, PL No. 17230123, 2800 Nos. 09. 01261465, (11/08/2026), OIL PAN MACHINING ASSEMBLY, PL No. 16020534, 15 Nos. The details of above tenders are available on Website <https://www.blw.indianrailways.gov.in> and <https://www.ireps.gov.in> **CORRIGENDUM NOTICE:-** 10. Bid No.: E-12 Tender No.: 09265004, Supply, Retrofitment and Commissioning of BRUSHLESS DC CAB MOUNTED COMPACT HVAC COOLING CAPACITY (75 TR) OR DIESEL ELECTRIC LOCOMOTIVE to PL No. 18050116 Revision: 2 Description of Correction:- Existing Due Date: 01/07/2026 Revised Due Date: 07/07/2026 Note:- All other terms & conditions will remain unchanged for above tender.

PRO/BLWS-14 Principal Chief Material Manager

 [/blwvaranasi](https://blwvaranasi) Website:- www.blw.indianrailways.gov.in

AFTER DELAYED MONSOON, DELUGE

Low pressure system over Bay of Bengal brings promise of rain

Mumbai floods: Roads shut, train, Metro services hit, red alert issued



The city received over 200 mm rain in 10 hours on Saturday. EXPRESS

rain in Digha and 143 mm rain in Koparkhairne. According to IMD records, the Santacruz station recorded 164 mm rainfall between 8.30 am and 5.30 pm on Saturday.

Traffic takes a hit

Throwing life out of gear in the suburbs, Mogra nalla — a key drain flowing through Andheri east and west before finally emptying into the Arabian sea through the Versova creek — started overflowing around noon on Saturday. Alongside, drains associated with the Mogra drainage network also started to overflow. As the drain

breached the normal levels, its water spilled onto the streets along Andheri subway as well as the adjoining carriageways like SV road in Andheri and Link road among others.

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As the drain breached the normal levels, its water spilled

onto the streets along Andheri subway as well as the adjoining carriageways like SV road in Andheri and Link road among others. With continuous showers battering the region, the floodwater on the streets did not recede leaving the entire belt waterlogged for several hours. In what added to the civic woes were the 4.26-metre high tides at 2.50 pm.

Railway affected

The unabated spells took a toll on railway and metro services during the day. According to officials, railway services were impeded along the Central and Western lines. Along the western line, rainwater flooded the railway track sections between Virar and Nalasopara delaying rail services by nearly 15-20 minutes.

Meanwhile, the central railway's main line services between Kalyan and CSMT were delayed by 20-25 minutes while trains along the Harbour line ran with a delay of 10-15 minutes.

The IMD has forecast no signs of slowdown in rain across the Mumbai Metropolitan region until Monday morning. Mumbai and its neighbouring districts will remain under a red alert through Sunday, after which rain is likely to subside.

• BRIEFLY



At the site of building collapse, Chandigarh, Saturday. KAMLESHWAR SINGH

CHANDIGARH

5 rescued, efforts underway to save 2 trapped as building collapses

POLICE SAID Saturday five people were rescued from a two-storey building that collapsed in Chandigarh's Industrial Area Phase 2. "Efforts are underway to rescue two people who are trapped under the debris," Sub-Divisional Police Officer (South) Gurjit Kaur told PTI over the phone. Officials said police, National Disaster Response Force, fire tenders and rescue teams rushed to the spot. The administration pressed heavy earth-moving machines into service and the area has been cordoned off. According to some locals, a portion of the building — used as a scrap godown — collapsed with a loud noise on Saturday. PTI

2 teens drown in check dam

TWO TEENAGERS drowned in a check dam in Jharkhand's Seraikela-Kharswan district on Saturday, a police officer said. The incident happened when the boys, aged 14 and 15 years, had gone to the dam in RIT police station area for a bath in the afternoon, he said. While the body of one of the boys was fished out, search is underway to locate the other. The deceased was identified as Luv Kumar. PTI

Forest officer held for graft

THE ANTI-CORRUPTION Bureau on Saturday arrested a Range Forest Officer and a driver of the forest patrol team in Rajasthan's Jhalawar district for allegedly accepting a bribe of Rs 15,000 from a timber trader, officials said. Vikram Singh, an RFO with the forest patrol team under the Office of the Deputy Conservator of Forests, Jhalawar, and driver Firoz Khan were caught red-handed while allegedly accepting the bribe. PTI

'Missing' question papers force MP university to cancel PG exam

Anand Mohan J Bhopal, July 4

THE RAJIV Gandhi Proudयोगी Vishwavidyalaya (RGPV) cancelled a Computer examination for second-year post-graduate students of its School of Biotechnology on Friday, after question papers were allegedly reported missing from the examination centre.

The exam was called off shortly before it was due to begin at 11 am, and has been put off until further notice.

University authorities have alleged that nine sealed packets containing the question papers were stolen during the intervening night of Thursday.

"Someone broke in through a window and stole the sealed envelopes before the exam began. The administration discovered the theft in the morning," said a police officer.

An FIR has been registered with the Gandhinagar Police Station and a probe is underway. "Yesterday morning, I was intimidated about missing papers from the examination centre. I rushed to the spot. I noticed a broken window and some scattered items. I instructed a few faculty members to lodge an FIR," said Vice-Chancellor Alok Sharma.

Following the incident, Vice-Chancellor Sharma issued separate show-cause no-

tices to School of Biotechnology director Archana Tiwari and the post-graduate examination controller, directing them to submit written explanations in three days.

"As Controller of Examinations, it is expected of you to ensure the confidentiality and security of question papers. Due to this incident, serious doubts have been raised about the management of university examinations. Therefore, you are directed to mandatorily submit your written clarification within three days of receiving this letter," stated one of the notices.

Sharma alleged the theft was part of a larger attempt to tarnish the university's reputation.

Draft emission cut targets issued for iron, steel sector

Nikhil Ghanekar New Delhi, July 4

THE CENTRE has once again issued a draft notification to set greenhouse gas emission intensity (GEI) targets for the intensive iron and steel sector and to align them under India's carbon credit trading system (CCTS).

The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC) issued the draft on June 26 and made it public on July 2. It has set emission reduction targets for 255 industrial units, including the sector's giants such as JSW Steel, Tata, SAIL (Steel Authority of India), and ArcelorMittal Nippon Steel, among others.

Draft targets for the iron and steel sector were already issued on June 23, 2025, along with aluminium (second aluminium), petroleum refinery, petrochemical and textile sectors. While final targets for other sectors were notified in January 2026, the Environment Ministry has issued a revised draft for iron and steel sector with marginal changes to targets, but without any explanation for the draft.

The draft notification lists 2023-24 as the year for baseline product output and baseline emission intensity, and 2026-27 as the compliance-year target for individual steel plants, sponge iron units and ferro-alloy manufacturers. A 60-day window has

E. EXPLAINED

Global commitment on climate action

INDIA'S GLOBAL commitments on climate action include reducing emissions intensity of its GDP — emissions behind economic output — making heavy industry manufacturing cleaner and more efficient. The government has incentivised emissions reduction through a carbon credit scheme. As part of this initiative, it has set sectoral targets for more polluting industries. If industries achieve those targets, they can earn credits, or buy them from others.

been given to submit objections and suggestions on the draft.

The draft defined targets in terms of tonnes of carbon dioxide equivalent (tCO₂e), which is used to measure the impact of all greenhouse gases and not just CO₂, based on their warming potential. The draft has set GEI targets only for 2026-27, while 2025-26 column has been left blank.

GEI is the amount of greenhouse gases (GHG) emitted per unit of product output, such as the quantum of gases released while producing cement. The

CCTS was launched in 2023 to create a framework that incentivises emission reduction through a market-based mechanism and to help achieve India's climate action goals.

The Centre has already finalised emission reduction targets for eight sectors — aluminium, cement, chlor-alkali, pulp and paper, secondary aluminium, petroleum refinery, petrochemical and textile.

In March, India revised its nationally determined contributions commitments on climate action under the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change and the Paris Agreement. This included a revision of target to reduce emissions intensity of Gross Domestic Product, which was set at 47% by 2035, compared to 2005 levels.

India has committed to reduce the emissions intensity of its gross domestic product — the amount of energy used per unit of GDP — to 47% by 2030 compared to 2005 levels as part of its domestic commitments under the agreement. The targets set in previous rounds covered 490 high-emission industrial units.

The CCTS, notified in 2023, created an overarching framework for the Indian carbon market. The objective was to slash or avoid GHG emissions from sectors whose processes emit more pollutants and whose operations are hard to decarbonise.

• ESSEL INFRAPROJECTS INSOLVENCY PROCEEDINGS IN CORPORATE GUARANTOR CASE

AI-hallucinated judgments: Why Supreme Court set aside a tribunal order

National Company Law Tribunal relied upon six AI-generated citations in ruling

Amaal Sheikh New Delhi, July 4

SIX AI-HALLUCINATED judgments formed the basis for the Supreme Court's striking down of an order passed by the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) on Thursday.

Three of the cited judgments did not exist, while the remaining three either did not contain the propositions attributed to them or did not correspond to the context they were cited for.

For instance, the NCLT order cited a 2019 judgment ICICI Bank Ltd v Urban Infrastructure

Real Estate Ltd., which did not exist. Along with it, the 2021 case V S Dempo & Co Ltd v Reliance Communications Ltd and the 2022 case Sarbjit Singh v Union Bank of India were also found to be non-existent.

Two of the judgments, Everest Kento Cylinders Ltd v Union of India (2015) and Canara Bank v N G Subbaraya Setty (2018), were genuine, but the passages quoted from them are not found in the judgments themselves.

The sixth judgment, State Bank of India v M/s Shree Ram Urban Infrastructure Ltd, 2020 SCC OnLine SC 341, corre-

sponded to a different case, namely M Subramaniam v S Janaki, and the quoted passage does not appear there either.

The bench of Justices PS Narasimha and Alok Aradhe observed on July 2 that while the use of AI judgments could be "gratifying, even inspiring," AI may eventually "infiltrate our intellectual work ethic and before long, render us dependent on its vast capabilities."

They said that "for those in the province of adjudication and determination of disputes, this by-product of AI, i.e., the production of fake, non-existent, and hallucinated material and its utilisation as precedents in law, is like the release of methyl isocyanate in the province of law and justice: invisible, insidious, and

catastrophic by the time anyone notices. It not only contaminates but takes away the very lifeblood of judicial determination."

Holding that a decision built on fabricated case law "is no decision at all," the court said such orders must be set aside even if "an iota of fake or hallucinated material enters the decision-making process."

The AI judgments

Six citations were relied upon by the NCLT while rejecting objections raised by Essel Infra-projects Ltd against insolvency proceedings initiated against it as a corporate guarantor.

One of Essel's arguments was that a renewal-cum-reduction letter issued by Jammu and Kashmir Bank in 2017 renewed

the loan on revised terms without mentioning the corporate guarantee, indicating that the guarantee had been relinquished. Rejecting this argument, the NCLT observed that "the said letter itself... states that all existing terms and conditions remain unchanged" and that the guarantee "remains valid and binding despite not being explicitly referenced in the renewal letter." For this reasoning, it relied on State Bank of India v. M/s Shree Ram Urban Infrastructure Ltd., quoting it as "the guarantor is bound by terms of guarantee as long as underlying debt is valid and enforceable."

Essel had also argued the bank's subsequent decision to obtain a fresh guarantee from another group undermined its

Free Whatsapp Channel <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGjOKH6oBd0F>

own position that original guarantee remained operative.

The NCLT relied on Everest Kento Cylinders Ltd v Union of India, quoting it as holding that a corporate guarantee "does not invalidate the original guarantee when additional security is sought" and that "the primary obligation secured by the guarantee remains enforceable."

Relying on this proposition, the NCLT held that "seeking additional guarantee does not invalidate the original Corporate Guarantee provided by the Corporate Debtor."

Essel's principal defence was that its liabilities, including the corporate guarantee, had shifted pursuant to a Bombay High Court-approved demerger and amalgamation in 2014. Reject-

ing this, NCLT relied on ICICI Bank Ltd v Urban Infrastructure Real Estate Ltd, quoting it as "a general corporate guarantee remains enforceable even if there is a restructuring of corporate structure, provided the underlying debt is not discharged."

The tribunal consequently held that the guarantee "will remain unaffected by the demerger & amalgamation." No such judgment exists.

Essel further argued that the bank could not proceed against it while insolvency proceedings were already underway against the principal borrower and Pan India Infraprojects Pvt Ltd, the entity to which the mortgaged property had eventually passed under the restructuring exercise. NCLT relied on Canara Bank

v N G Subbaraya Setty, quoting it as saying that "the rights of secured creditors over mortgaged or secured properties are not extinguished merely due to the transfer of such properties to another entity via amalgamation or restructuring."

Two other citations were relied upon to answer procedural objections. None of the six citations had been placed before the tribunal by either side. Jammu and Kashmir Bank, the financial creditor in the case, told the Supreme Court in an affidavit that its counsel had not cited any of the judgments and that the material appeared to have been sourced by the tribunal itself through its "own research."

FULL REPORT ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

BENGALURU 2026

GLOBAL GROWTH DIALOGUE

At the Uttar Pradesh Global Growth Dialogue 2026 in Bengaluru, leading national and global companies reaffirmed confidence in the state's growth trajectory. With transformative investments, robust infrastructure, investor-friendly policies and a skilled workforce, Uttar Pradesh is shaping the future of India's economic and industrial development.



Uttar Pradesh Secures ₹50,000+ Crore Investment Commitments at Bengaluru Global Growth Dialogue 2026



INVESTMENT MOMENTUM

₹50,000+ Crore Investments

15+ MoUs Signed

500 GCCs by 2031

40 Million Sq. Ft. Grade-A Office Space

Future-Ready Talent Ecosystem

- Uttar Pradesh attracted investment proposals exceeding ₹50,000 crore during the Uttar Pradesh Global Growth Dialogue 2026 held in Bengaluru.
- More than 15 leading national and international companies signed MoUs in the presence of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath.
- Investment commitments span key sectors including Global Capability Centres (GCCs), industrial infrastructure, electronics manufacturing, logistics, technology and innovation.
- Major commitments in industrial and business parks include:
 - Prestige Group
 - Horizon (Blackstone)
 - Embassy Group
 - Raheja Mindspace REIT
 - Sattva Developers
- Shriram Properties partnered with the state to develop modern industrial and business parks, further strengthening Uttar Pradesh's industrial ecosystem.
- Leading global companies including LG, Aon, MetLife and Table Space partnered with Uttar Pradesh to support GCC growth and knowledge-driven industries.
- Invest UP and TeamLease entered a strategic partnership to strengthen workforce readiness and create a robust GCC talent pipeline.
- Uttar Pradesh aims to develop 40 million sq. ft. of Grade-A office space and attract 500 GCCs by 2031.
- Nearly 2 lakh STEM graduates pass out annually, creating a strong talent base for AI, Machine Learning, Cybersecurity, Cloud Computing and emerging technologies.
- Focused roundtables on urban infrastructure, technology, GCCs and foreign investment highlighted Uttar Pradesh's growing opportunities for global investors.
- Transparent governance, investor-friendly policies, ease of doing business and world-class infrastructure continue to drive investor confidence.

Uttar Pradesh's Three-S (SSS) Growth Model

Safety, Stability & Speed

CM Yogi Adityanath Presents Uttar Pradesh as India's Fastest-Growing Investment Destination

- Uttar Pradesh has emerged as India's Three-S Model of development-Safety, Stability and Speed.
- Strong law and order, transparent governance and policy continuity have transformed the state into a trusted investment hub.
- The state now ranks among India's top three economies, with both its economy and per capita income witnessing significant growth over the last nine years.
- A 75,000-acre industrial land bank and 36 sector-specific policies provide a strong platform for industrial expansion.
- Home to nearly 60% of India's expressway network, Uttar Pradesh offers one of the country's most advanced connectivity ecosystems.
- Five international airports, 12 domestic airports, Dedicated Freight Corridors, National Waterways, Rapid Rail and metro networks ensure seamless multimodal connectivity.
- 27 industrial and logistics nodes are being developed along expressways, while BIDA is emerging as one of India's largest industrial cities.
- With nearly 2 lakh STEM graduates annually and a strong skilling ecosystem, Uttar Pradesh offers a future-ready workforce for global industries.
- More than 18,000 large industrial units have been established over the last nine years, taking the total number of large factories beyond 33,000.



Uttar Pradesh Emerges as India's Next Investment & Innovation Hub

Industry Leaders Endorse Uttar Pradesh's High-Growth Potential

- Business leaders across GCCs, technology, real estate, startups and HR sectors identified Uttar Pradesh as one of India's most promising investment destinations.
- World-class infrastructure, strong governance and policy stability are driving rapid economic transformation across the state.
- The Noida-Jewar-Lucknow growth corridor is emerging as a major engine of industrial and commercial development.
- GCC and AI leaders encouraged multinational corporations to consider

There has never been a better time to invest in Uttar Pradesh. Its exceptional talent pool, world-class infrastructure and immense growth potential are creating the foundation for the industries of the future.

- Uttar Pradesh for their next phase of expansion.
- Aon announced plans to expand operations in Noida, creating an estimated 600-1,000 employment opportunities.
- A large talent pool, expanding urban centres and a growing digital economy continue to attract leading domestic and global enterprises.
- Noida, Greater Noida and Lucknow are rapidly evolving into centres of technology, innovation and entrepreneurship.
- Investors highlighted strong opportunities across agriculture, food systems, sustainability, energy transition and emerging industries.

CM Yogi Engages Global Technology Leaders to Drive AI-Led Transformation

Strategic Discussions with Google, NVIDIA, Blackstone, Accel and Other Innovation Leaders



- Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath held discussions with Google Cloud CTO Tarun Pant and senior leadership on leveraging AI, cloud technologies

and digital innovation for inclusive growth.

- Discussions focused on strengthening digital governance, enhancing citizen services and accelerating economic development through technology.
- Technology-driven solutions were explored to support agriculture, MSMEs, startups, youth empowerment and public service delivery.
- Google expressed strong interest in collaborating with Uttar Pradesh to advance its innovation and technology agenda.
- Strategic meetings were also held with leaders from NVIDIA, Blackstone, Accel, WestBridge Capital, InMobi, SarvamAI and Yulu.
- Industry leaders appreciated Uttar Pradesh's infrastructure, policy stability, governance framework and ease of doing business.
- The Bengaluru outreach further reinforced Uttar Pradesh's position as a leading destination for AI, technology, innovation and startup-led growth.

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, SIDHARTH KUKREJA S/o Dharmendra Kukreja, 17/59-B, GF, Tilak Nagar, Delhi-18 have changed my name to SIDDHARTH KUKREJA. 0071045894-1

I,MANISH GUPTA S/O RAJ KISHOR GUPTA R/O-3009-11, BAHADUR GARH ROAD, BHAGWAN GANJ, SADAR BAZAR, DELHI-06, have changed the name of my minor son SHAURYA GUPTA and he shall hereafter be known as SHAURYA GARG. 0040864124-2

I,hitherto known as Rajesh Kumar Gadiya,S/o-Om Prakash Gadiya,R/o-A-119, 3rd-Floor,Near-Deepali Chowk, Pitampura, Saraswati-Vihar,North-West Delhi, Delhi-110034, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Rajesh Gadiya. 0040864274-2

I, RENU ALIAS RENU KAMRAALIAS RENU ARORA D/o CHHABIL DAS W/O PARVEEN KUMAR R/o 34/26 1ST FLOOR, NEARANAND NURSING HOME, PATEL NAGAR WEST, CENTRAL DELHI, DELHI-110008 have changed my name to RENU ARORA for all purposes. 0071045805-1

I, MITTAL GAURAV KUMAR, S/O- JAYANTI PRASAD MITTAL, R/O- 117, NITI-KHAND-1 INDIRAPURAM SAHIBABAD, GHAZIABAD, UTTAR PRADESH-201010, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO GAURAV KUMAR MITTAL. 0040864281-9

I,Dharmender,S/o Satish Kumar,R/o-221 Pocket-2, Paschim Puri, Paschim Vihar Delhi-110063, have changed my name to Dharmendra Permanently 0040864200-1

I,RAJEEV KUMAR,S/o SOHAN LAL DUDEJA,R/o WZ-22 PHASE-1 OM VIHAR, UTTAM NAGAR,NEW DELHI-110059,have changed my name to RAJIV DUDEJA. 0040864272-3

I,Mohd Ashafak S/o Mo Mosin R/o 08, Buddh Vihar, Noida, G.B. Nagar,have changed my name to Mo. Ashfaak. 0040864281-2

I Ekta Anand alias Dolly Anand D/o Gurcharan Lal Bhatia and W/o Chetan Anand R/o A4/75, 4th Floor, Near By, Balaji Hospital, Paschim Vihar, Jawala Heri, West Delhi-110063, have changed my name to Dolly Anand 0071045865-1

I Vipin kala S/o Sh. Brijmohan kala R/o 2E/93B,Kamna Sec-2, Vaisali Ghaaziabad UP-201010. Have a correction in name spelling of my minor daughter from Garima kala to Gareema Kala for all purposes.Both name belongs to one and same person. 0071045899-1

I,Mohammad Yasin,S/o Mohammad Ibrahim R/o-778, Gali No.30/1,Jafrabad, Delhi-110053,have changed my name,from Mohammad Yasin to Mohd Yaseen,for all purposes 0040864274-4

I, Asif S/o Abdul Rashid, R/o C-116, 2nd Floor, Gali No-9, Wazirabad Village, North Delhi, Delhi 110084, have changed my name to Mohd Asif. 0071045791-1

I,Sarabjit Kour,W/o Gurjit Singh Saathi,R/o J-120,SF Rajouri Garden,Delhi-110027,have changed my name to Sarabjeet Kaur permanently. 0040864281-11

I,Mohammed Zaryab Rasool,R/o-221, Gali.No. 6,Near-Firdous Masjid,J-Extension,Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-110092,inform that Zaryab Rasool and Mohammed Zaryab Rasool, both names are same person. 0040864272-5

I,Sanjeew Kumar,S/o Surender Kumar R/o B-640,Avantika, Sector-1,Rohini,Delhi-110085,have changed my name to Sanjeev Kapoor for all Purposes. 0040864281-4

I, Keith Ravindra Egbert S/O Ivan Naurattan Egbert R/O Flat No. 901, Tower-7, Unitech Horizone Birondi Chakrasenpur Sector Pl-2, Greater Noida, G.B Nagar U.P-201310 have declared that the both names KEITH RAVINDRA EGBERT AND RAVI EGBERT are one and the same person 0071045875-1

I,No-14845010N,Unit 528 ASC BN, Fakkeeraya Boodhimalah, R/O-164 Nekar Street Kunkur, District-Dharwad Karnataka-581212.In my service records name of my spouse has been wrongly mentioned as Parvati F.B instead of Parvathi Boodhimalah vide affidavit dated 29-06-06 before public notary Kupwara. 0020516089-1

I,A.GIRIJA DEVI,MOTHER OF,REGHUNATH S,RESIDENT OF,GIRIJA NIVAS, PAVIZHAKUNNU, MANALIPADAM, VILLAGE:VANDAZHY II, PO:MUDAPPALLUR, TEHSIL:ALATHUR, DISTT: PALAKKAD, KERALA 678605, HAVE CHANGED MY NAME FROM A.GIRIJA DEVI TO GIRIJA DEVI A,VIDE-AFFIDAVIT DATED 04-JUL-2026. 0040864274-7

I, Firdos Rahi W/o Mohammad Tanvir Rahi R/o-C-451, Sector Alpha Greater Noida, U.P. I have changed my name from Firdos Rahi to Firdos Tanveer for all future purposes. 0071045813-1

I Lal Bahadur Rana S/o Rai Singh R/o WZ-42-80, Square Plot, Tilak Nagar, West Delhi-110018, have changed my name to Lal Bahadur for all purpose. 0071045884-1

I,RAJEEV KUMAR SALUJA,S/O BALBIR KUMAR SALUJA,R/O 29/184-A FIRST FLOOR VIKRAM VIHAR,LAJPAT NAGAR-4,DELHI-110024,have changed my name to RAJEEV SALUJA 0040864272-7

I,RAHUL S/O DHARAM PAL SINGH, R/O/7, SANGAM APARTMENT, POKKET-24, SECTOR-24,ROHINI, DELHI-110085,have changed my name to RAHUL CHAUDHARY. 0040864281-6

I, Mimansha Kovind, D/o Dr. Saraj Kovind, R/o Plot No. BC-11, Sec-C1, Trans Delhi, Tronica City, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh - 201103, hereby declare that my father's name Dr. Saraj Kovind (as recorded in my Class 10 Certificate) and Suraj Kovind (as recorded in my Passport) refer to one and the same person. Likewise, my mother's name Dr. Mamta Kovind (as recorded in my Class 10 Certificate) and Mamta Rani (as recorded in my Passport) also refer to one and the same person. 0040864283-1

I, Sushila Sharma, W/o Anand Sawroop, R/o A-1, GH-14, MIG Flats, Pashim Vihar, Delhi-110087, do hereby declare that in my passport no. P2815082 my husband's name wrongly written as Anand Swaroop whereas his correct name is AnandSawroop. Anand Swaroop and Anand Sawroop is the name of one & same person. 0040864198-1

I,ANISKA daughter of Ashok Nautiyal,Address-B-23, PANDAV NAGAR, EAST DELHI, DELHI-110092,have Changed my name from Aniska to Anisha Nautiyal,vide-affidavit date-04.Jul.26 0040864274-9

I, RAM PAL SINGH PANWARALIAS RAMPAL SINGH S/o SHORAM SINGH R/O-A-107 GALI NO.4, JOHRIPUR EXTENSION, GOKAL PUR, NORTH EAST, DELHI, DELHI-110094 have changed my name to RAMPAL SINGH for all purposes. 0071045853-1

I, Rajni D/o Naresh, WZ-353, BEECHIAL, Palam Village, New Delhi-110045, Confirm that My Father & Mother know by the Name of Naresh and Naresh Kumar, Geeta and Sanyogita. Both Names are belongs to Same Person. 0071045889-1

I,INDER PRAKASH GARG S/O BHAJAN LAL GARG R/O 60/14RAMJAS ROAD KAROL BAGH DELHI-110005,HAVE CHANGE MY NAME TO INDER GARG 0040864281-1

I, Surinder Kaur Goomer W/o-Prabhjot Singh Goomer R/o-B-1/114,First Floor, Janakpuri,New Delhi-58 have changed my name to Surinder Kaur for all purposes. 0040864124-1

I,Dilip Singh, Son of, Shri. Kishan Singh, residing at, Flat.No.2202,Eldeco Utopia,Tower Olympia-2,Sector-93A, Noida,Gautam-Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201305,have changed my name,from'Dilip Singh'to'Dilip Singh Rathore'for all,purposes. 0040864274-1

Rajender Kumar@Rajender Mahajan@Rajender Kumar Mahajan all names belongs to same person i.e. myself RAJENDER MAHAJAN,S/o-Madan Lal Mahajan R/O-A-211,Meera-Bagh Paschim-Vihar,Delhi-87 0040864281-8

I,ARIF ELAHI, S/O NAVAID NOWSHAH, R/O-A-60, New Friends Colony, New Delhi-110025, declare that my name in CBSE/Class X/Class XII records appears as ARIEF ELAHI NAWSHAH,ARIF ELAHI and ARIEF ELAHI NAWSHAH are one and the same person for passport and lawful purposes. 0040864137-1

I,PARUL,W/O ABHISHEK RAJPUT,R/O 14/443-A GALI NO.1 NR.VODAFONE STORE SIKKA-COLONY SONIPAT HARYANA-131001.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO PARUL DAWAR. 0040864272-2

I, KM. MINA KUMARI ALIAS MEENAKSHI PANWAR D/o KALURAM W/O RAMPAL SINGH R/O-A-107 GALI NO.4, JOHRI PUR EXT. KARAWAL NAGAR, SABA PUR DELHI, NORTH EAST, DELHI-110094 have changed my name to MEENAKSHI PANWAR for all purposes. 0071045862-1

I,hitherto known as Ritka Virmani alias Vani Arora D/o-Ved Prakash Virmani and W/o-Onkar Arora, R/o-19/3, 3rd Floor, Moti Nagar, Ramesh Nagar, Rajouri Garden, Delhi-15, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Vani Arora. 0040864124-3

I,Govind,S/o-Jai Prakash,R/o-H.No.J-700,Prasadi-Marg-3,1/2-Pusta,Kartar Nagar, P.O. Bhajanpura, North-East Delhi-110053, have changed the name of my minor daughter Avni alies Tanvi Aged-6Years and she shall hereafter be known as Tanvi. 0040864274-3

I,PREM BALLABH, S/o Gouri Datt Bhatt, R/o: E-64, Gali No-7, Bhagwati Garden Extension, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059 Have Changed My Name to PREM BALLABH BHATT. 0071045814-1

I,MITTAL RITU GAURAV KUMAR,W/O-GAURAV KUMAR MITTAL R/O-117,NITI KHAND-1 INDIRAPURAM SAHIBABAD GHAZIABAD,UTTAR PRADESH-201010 HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO RITU MITTAL. 0040864281-10

I,Geeta,W/o Dharmendra,R/o-221,Pocket-2 Paschim Puri,Paschim Vihar,Delhi-110063 have changed my name to Geeta Gauri,Permanently 0040864200-2

I,RAJEEV KUMAR DUDEJA,S/o SOHAN LAL DUDEJA,R/o WZ-22 PHASE-1 OM-VIHAR,UTTAM NAGAR,NEW DELHI-110059,have changed my name to RAJIV DUDEJA. 0040864272-4

I,Deepak,S/o-Ram Lautan Singh, R/o-Plot no. 112, Khari Gujran Enclave Part-1, Khari, Ballabgarh, Faridabad (Haryana)-121004, have changed my name to Deepak Singh Rana, for all Purposes. 0040864281-3

I,Priyanka Kumari, W/O-Nishant Kumar,R/O-C-701, Tower,C-Society,Bestech Altura, Sector-79, Gurgaon, Haryana-122051, have changed the name of my minor daughter Shanaya to Shanaya Jaiswal. 0040864274-5

I, SWETA SHARMA W/O SHASHI VATS R/O GG-11/20-A VIKAS PURI ,TILAK NAGAR S.O WEST DELHI 110018, have changed my name SHWETA SHARMA for all future purpose 0071045800-1

I,Gurjit Singh S/o Mahinder Singh Saathi R/o J-120,SF Rajouri Garden, Delhi-110027 have changed my name to Gurjit Singh Saathi permanently. 0040864281-12

I, Iihar S/o Nishar Ahmed R/o Mohhla Kot, Muradnagar, Ghaaziabad, have changed my name to Izhar. 0071045896-1

I,Aditi Aggarwal,W/o Mr.Rishabh Goel,R/o House.No. 1745B, Sector-46,Gurugram, Haryana-122001, have changed my name from Aditi Aggarwal To Aditi Goel, for all, future purposes. 0040864272-6

I,SAYAM S/O JAIPAL R/O 80A/12,13 SIKKA COLONY SONIPAT HARYANA-131001.HAVE CHANGED MY NAME TO SAYAM NANGALIA. 0040864281-5

I, Kamlesh Chhabra W/o Vinod Chhabra R/o-C3/66B, Lawrence Road, Keshav Puram, Delhi have changed my name to Kamlesh Kumari for all purposes. 0071045879-1

I, hitherto known as SUNITA, daughter of, LATE SH C.R. KHLIWANI, resident of, H.N.50, Kohat Enclave, PitamPura, New Delhi-110034, after-marriage, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as ARTI MOTWANI, wife of, SH.BHAGWAN DAS, residing at, 495/496, Double-Story New-Rajinder-Nagar, New Delhi-110060. 0040864281-14

I, LENKA RAMAKRUSHNA, FATHER OF LENKA MANMADHA KUMAR, ADDRESS- PENASAM(VILLAGE),GANTYADA(MANDALAM), VIZIANAGARAM(DIST),ANDHRA-PRADESH(STATE),PIN-535215,HAVE CHANGED MY NAME, FROM LENKA RAMAKRUSHNA TO LENKA RAMAKRISHNA VIA AFFIDAVIT,DATE-04-JULY-2026. 0040864274-8

I, BINA VERMA alias BEENA VERMA W/O PREM SUKH VERMA R/O 69/5366, REGHARPURA KAROL BAGH NEW DELHI S HATHI WALA CHOWK KAROL BAGH CENTRAL DELHI 110005 have changed my name BINA DEVI for all future purpose 0071045798-1

I Saroj Rana W/o Lal Bahadur R/o WZ-42,80 Yards, Tilak Nagar, Tilak Nagar, West Delhi-110018, have changed my name to Saroj Bala for all purpose. 0071045887-1

I, W Ronibala Devi, W/o Mayanglambam Surjit Singh, No. 15138719X, Rank: Havildar, Record Office: RO, ARTY NASHIK, a permanent resident of Urup Makha Leikai P.O. Lilong, P.S. Iriblung, District-Imphal East, Manipur, do hereby declare that my correct name is Waikhom Ronibala Devi, and hence will be used it in all future purposes. 0040864202-1

I,Shaheena Bano,W/o No-9108117W,SEP Mushtaq Ahmed, R/O VPO-Lowang, Teh-Bani, Dist-Kathua, J&K-184206,have changed my DOB from 05-12-1988 to 05-12-1992,for all,future purposes vide Public Notary Delhi affidavit dt-30-06-2026. 0040864272-10

I,PUSHPA YADAV W/o-Ramesh Kumar R/O-GH-6/104-Old, Paschim Vihar New Delhi-110087, have changed my Name to PUSHPA DEVI, for all purposes 0040864281-7

I,YASMIN,w/o-AYAZ AHMED r/o,A-69/S-2,3rd Floor,Shalimar Garden, Ghaaziabad, Uttar Pradesh,UP-201005,has changed my name to SHIGUFTA YASMEEN permanently, for all, future purpose. 0040864272-1

Wanted

BRAHMIN

A well educated God Brahmin girl /Lecturer /Assistant Professor required for a handsome well educated LbL,LLM,well established boy,doing his own business.Aug 1991 born.GGN based.Contact no.9810600233 email rsvenus99@gmail.com 0040862974-2

OTHERS

Hindu Dhiman boy, Dec 93, B.tech/ MBA, working at Gurgaon. Tricity family preferred. Contact: 70550-10075 0020516015-1

Groom wanted

Bansal, 28/5'2", fair, beautiful , MBA, high pki, parents doctors , prefers Delhi based professional. No dowry. Profile 9311331215 00502922419-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to all that my clients (1) Mr. Shrawan Kumar S/o Bihari Lal & (2) Babita Rajput W/o Shrawan Kumar new Flat No. 951, GH-13, Paschim Vihar, New Delhi, have disowned/debarred their son Kunal Kumar & daughter-in-law Tanuja Sagar both residing at above said address from their all assets, moveable & immovable properties located at anywhere & also severed all relations with them. Any persons dealing with them, shall be at his/her own risk/loss. Jagdish Chandra Trikhia (Adv.), M-4, Civil Side, Tis Hazuri Court, Delhi-54. 0040864202-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

My client, Mr. Praveen Arora S/o Late Sh. Bhajanlal Arora R/o 1/2877, Gali No.-1, Second Floor, Left Side, Bihari Colony, Shahdara, Delhi 110032, and permanent address at H. No. 365, Gali No. 7, Near Bhusheshwar Mandir, West Kanti Nagar, Gurgaon, Delhi-110031 has severed all relationships with his son, Mr. Piyush Arora and daughter in law, Mrs. Khushboo due to their misbehaviour & disobedience and disowned/debarred them from all movable or immovable properties owned by my client. My client shall not be responsible for any of their acts, deeds or liabilities. Sumit Arora (Advocate) 0040864272-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, the undersigned on behalf of my client Murari Lal So Prabhat and Smt. Kamla Devi R/o 391, Gurm Ram Das Nagar, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-92 information of General Public that my above-named clients have disowned and debarred his Son namely Madhur Kumar and his wife namely Ms. Meenu due to the misconduct with my client from all her movable and immovable Property with immediate effect. That now my clients are not concerned for any relationship with Madhur Kumar and his wife namely Ms. Meenu. If anyone deals with him in any manner for any transaction or in any other relating whatsoever shall be doing at his/her own risk and responsibility. Those clients are not responsible for any act and deeds done by Madhur Kumar his wife namely Ms. Meenu. Sd/- Sanjeev Kumar (Advocate) Encl. No. DI/799788 Off. C-21 1st Floor, Guru Nanakpura Laxmi Nagar Delhi-32 0040864272-1

LOST & FOUND

LOST original title documents, including the complete chain of Sale Deeds and other related ownership documents, pertaining to: Property No. 9/46, Geeta Colony, Delhi-110031, standing in the name of Mr. Raj Kumar Guliyani, S/o Late Shri Hari Chand Gulyani; and Shop No. 436, Jheel Khuranja, Delhi - 110051, standing jointly in the names of Mr. Raj Kumar Guliyani and Mrs. Neelam Guliyani as co-owners. NCR/complaint regarding the loss of the said documents has already been filed vide NCR/DD No. 70019136/2026 dated 18.06.2026 at PS Geeta Colony/ePolice station. Finder please contact on 9810070765. 0071045867-1

Lost Property-Paper of 11-A,Radhey-Puri, Delhi-51, Vide DOC No.7435, Volume 2813, Book No.1, Pages 235 to 237 Dated-27-11-1953 SR, Delhi. Shuddi Khanna, D/o Surjeet Manchanda, #9211299411. 0040864274-10

LOST original title documents, including the complete chain of Sale Deeds and other related ownership documents, pertaining to: Property No. 9/47, Geeta Colony, Delhi-110031, standing in the name of Mrs. Neelam Guliyani w/o Mr. Raj Kumar Gulyani.; and Shop No. 436, Jheel Khuranja, Delhi - 110051, standing jointly in the names of Mr. Raj Kumar Gulyani and Mrs. Neelam Guliyani as co-owners. NCR/complaint regarding the loss of the said documents has already been filed vide NCR/DD No. 70019136/2026 dated 18.06.2026 at PS Geeta Colony/ePolice station. Finder please contact on 9810070765. 0071045922-1

LOST & FOUND

LOST original title documents, including the complete chain of Sale Deeds and other related ownership documents, pertaining to: Property No. 9/47, Geeta Colony, Delhi-110031, standing in the name of Mrs. Neelam Guliyani w/o Mr. Raj Kumar Gulyani.; and Shop No. 436, Jheel Khuranja, Delhi - 110051, standing jointly in the names of Mr. Raj Kumar Gulyani and Mrs. Neelam Guliyani as co-owners. NCR/complaint regarding the loss of the said documents has already been filed vide NCR/DD No. 70019136/2026 dated 18.06.2026 at PS Geeta Colony/ePolice station. Finder please contact on 9810070765. 0071045867-1

LOST original title documents, including the complete chain of Sale Deeds and other related ownership documents, pertaining to: Property No. 9/47, Geeta Colony, Delhi-110031, standing in the name of Mrs. Neelam Guliyani w/o Mr. Raj Kumar Gulyani.; and Shop No. 436, Jheel Khuranja, Delhi - 110051, standing jointly in the names of Mr. Raj Kumar Gulyani and Mrs. Neelam Guliyani as co-owners. NCR/complaint regarding the loss of the said documents has already been filed vide NCR/DD No. 70019136/2026 dated 18.06.2026 at PS Geeta Colony/ePolice station. Finder please contact on 9810070765. 0071045867-1

LOST original title documents, including the complete chain of Sale Deeds and other related ownership documents, pertaining to: Property No. 9/47, Geeta Colony, Delhi-110031, standing in the name of Mrs. Neelam Guliyani w/o Mr. Raj Kumar Gulyani.; and Shop No. 436, Jheel Khuranja, Delhi - 110051, standing jointly in the names of Mr. Raj Kumar Gulyani and Mrs. Neelam Guliyani as co-owners. NCR/complaint regarding the loss of the said documents has already been filed vide NCR/DD No. 70019136/2026 dated 18.06.2026 at PS Geeta Colony/ePolice station. Finder please contact on 9810070765. 0071045867-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the public at large that my client, Smt. Minakshi Tandon Mahabhoja, D/O Sh. Indrajit Lal Tandon, residing at 53-A, Pocket A, DDA Flats, Sakdhar Vihar, New Delhi - 110025, has lost the original ownership and property documents pertaining to the residential property situated at 53-A, Pocket A, DDA Flats, Sakdhar Vihar, New Delhi - 110025. The specific original documents lost are 1. Allocation Letter 2. 5th and Final Demand Letter dated 03.04.1986 3. Possession Slip 4. NDC (No Objection Certificate) for water and electricity connections 5. Sale Deed executed in favour of Kamla Tandon dated 23/10/2012. A formal Information Report regarding the loss of these documents has been successfully registered with the Delhi Police (e-Police Station / New Friends Colony Police Station) under LR No. 413310/2026 dated 02/07/2026. Any person who finds the aforementioned original documents, or has any claim, right, title, mortgage, or objection in respect of the said property or documents, is requested to intimate the same in writing, along with supporting evidence to the undersigned or directly to the owner within fifteen (15) days from the date of publication of this notice. If no objection or claim is received within the stipulated period, it will be presumed that no such claim exists, and my client will proceed to apply for duplicate/retained copies of the property documents from the competent authorities. Any dealings with the said property or lost documents by any person or financial institution after this notice shall be at their own risk and legal consequences. Minakshi Tandon Mahabhoja (Property Owner & Complainant) Address: 53-A, Pocket A, DDA Flats, Sakdhar Vihar, New Delhi - 110025 Email: mmahabhoja@aol.com Date: July 4, 2026 0040863782-1

PROPERTY

3 beds HG ground floor DDA flat sector 12 Dwarka for sale rent what's App 981142156. 0040863782-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

Be it known to public at large that my client Shri Hari Krishan Tandon S/o late Shri Bansil Lal Tandon, aged about 79 years, R/o House No. 232, Near Community Centre, Raja Garden, Ramesh Nagar, New Delhi-110015 who is one of the co-sharers of the two shops bearing Private No.4 & 7 part of property bearing Municipal No.-33/1, Double Storey, Village Tihar-II, Ashok Nagar, Tihar, Nagar, New Delhi-110015, purchased by late Shri Rajender Tandon, the deceased brother of my client, has lost the entire chain of title documents somewhere at home. If anyone finds these documents, kindly return the same to my above named client. Non-compliable Report bearing LR No.417996/2026 dated 3rd of July, 2026 has been lodged in the regard. Sd/- Vineet Sharma Advocate Encl. No. DI/4791996/20 Off. #2-17, Hind Floor, Authority Building, District Centre, Janakpuri, New Delhi 0040863031-1

PUBLIC NOTICE

THIRD FLOOR WITH ENTIRE TERRACE OF THE S - 284, GREATER KALASH PART - I, NEW DELHI

That my client has agreed to purchase the Entire Third Floor with Entire Terrace and rights thereon of the said property with Two Car Parking Spaces in the Still Area with exclusive separate gate and Space for One Utility with common W.C. in the Still Area, alongwith 22.5%, undivided, indivisible and impartible ownership rights in the freehold land underneath measuring 206.50 square yards, bearing No. S - 284, situated at Greater Kalash Part-I, New Delhi-110049 from Mrs. Shilpi Kohli, wife of Sh.Sudershan Rathore and Sh.Sudershan Rathore son of Shri Jaswant Singh Rathore both residents of S-284 Greater Kalash -I, New Delhi who have agreed to sell and with all rights, title and interest, easements, privileges and appurtenances thereto and have claimed themselves to be absolute owners of the said property and claim the said property to be free from all disputes,litigations,charges loan,lien and/or any encumbrances. Any other person(s) or entity having claim against, into or upon the said portions or any other part thereof by virtue of sale,inheritance,agreement,contract,mortgage,loan,lien, charge etc. or otherwise is hereby required to notify the same in writing alongwith supporting documents in writing within 7 days of this publication failing which any/all claims and/or objections shall be considered waived and abandoned and shall not be binding against the aforesaid property or the purchaser thereof. MANEESH GOYAL Advocate, E -232 Greater Kalash-I, New Delhi. Mob: 9811179795

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S. SUKHWINDER SINGH BABBAR, Chairman, GRDCE

ADMISSION NOTICE

Baba Haridass College of Pharmacy & Technology Jharoda Kalan, New Delhi - 72 Tel: 011-25315268, 931382445

Applications are invited from the candidates who have qualified CET 2026-2027 of DTTE, Delhi, for admission in Diploma in Pharmacy & Diploma in Medical Lab Technology against 10% Quota of Management seats. Admission will be done on merit based on percentage of marks in the qualifying examination. Prescribed form can be obtained from the institute on any working day within 18 days of this advertisement. For further details please refer institute website www.bhpc.co.in in Principal

NOTE: Qualified teaching staff required for teaching DMLT and D.Pharmacy students.

ADMISSION

NURSING

ADMISSION for NURSING

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Applications are invited for 3 yrs Dip. in General Nursing & Midwifery (GNM) and 2 yrs Dip. in Auxiliary Nurse & Midwife (ANM) on prescribed form available with prospectus.

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SITUATION VACANT

MAHARANI KISHORI MEMORIAL KANYA MAHAVIDHYALAY, HODAL

(Affiliated To M.O. University Rohtak)

Hodal Distt. Palwal Haryana

Contact No. 9813854478, 7082925917 (FEMALE CANDIDATES WILL BE GIVEN PREFERENCE)

INVITES APPLICATIONS FOR THE FOLLOWING POSTS ON REGULAR BASIS:-

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ASSTT. PROF.'S: English (04), Hindi-(04), Sanskrit (01), History(03), Mathematics- (04), Commerce (04), Economics (01) Music (01), Pol.Sc (03) Computer Science-(04), Physical Education (02), Physics (3), Chemistry (4), Biotechnology (4), Zoology (4), Botany (4) & Management(4)

Administrative Staff:-Librarian-(01), Office Asstt. Com Accountant -(01), Computer Operator -(04), Store Keeper-(01), Clerk (02), Technical Asstt. -(01), Lab Assistant -(04), Lab Attendant-(05), Peon-(03), Safai Karamchari-(05), Night Watchman-(03), Mail-(03)& Security (02).

Qualification pay scale & experience as per UGC/State Govt/MDU, Rohtak Norms.

Interested candidates may download application form from the website mknrgroupofcolleges.com OR obtain from the office of the institute on any working day and send application form to the president of the college duly completed alongwith verified copy of all testimonials (DMSC), experience certificate etc. Subscribing on the envelope as application for the post of.., within 21 days from the date of advertisement but not later than 26.07.2026 through regd.postby hand. A copy of the application form must be sent to the D.C.C.C., MDU, Rohtak within due date.

NOTE: Only Eligible Candidates/applicants whose application form is/are received in the institute as well as in The Office of the DCCC, MDU, Rohtak in due date will be called for the interview.

PRESIDENT GOVERNING BODY

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

OPEN TENDER NOTICE

01. Name of work with its location : Chhapra-Kathiar-Modification of OHE due to ABSS work in Sonpur Division. 02. Approx. cost of the works (₹.) : ₹. 1974545/-, 03. Earnest Money to be deposited (₹.) : ₹. 239500/-, 04. Date & time for submission of e-tender and opening of e-tender : Opening of e-tenders: on 28.07.2026 at 12:00 Hrs. in the office of the Sr. Divl. Electrical Engineer (TRD), DRM Office, E.C. Railway, Sonpur. 05. Website particulars and notice board location where complete details of e-tender can be seen : WEBSITE: <http://www.irops.gov.in> NOTICE BOARD: DRM Office Campus, E. C. Railway, Sonpur. Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/TRD East Central Railway/Sonpur PR/0498/SEE/TRD/726-27/24

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender Notice No. : RTTM/ Works/Misc/ 2025/ECR, Date : 02.07.2026

On line (through e-tendering) Tender for the following work is invited by Dy. Chief Engineer (Track Machine), Plant Depot, East Central Railway, Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya for and on behalf of the President of India, from reputed Firms.

E-Tender Closing Date : 24.07.2026

1. Name of the work with its Location : RTTM, Works, Misc. 2025- Execution of Miscellaneous works in connection with IOH/POH or any other maintenance of Track Machine at TMC Shed/Zonal Machine Depot/Plant Depot/DDU, Satellite Shed/ CSR/ SEE Division and Satellite Shed/ R/RME/ DHN/Division of East Central Railway. 2. Approx Cost of the work: ₹.45,80,900.22. 3. Earnest Money : ₹.15,700/-, 4. Date and time for submission of e-tender : 24.07.2026 upto 15.00 hrs., 5. Website particulars of e-tendering : www.irops.gov.in Dy. Chief Engineer/TMC, Plant Depot/ ECR/PT. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya PR/0495/Plant Depot. DDU/MECH/726-27/32

Govt. of Bihar

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VERY SHORT-E-TENDER NOTICE No. 26/RFP/2026-27

File. No: 99/Engg/2026/943/engg/26

(Through e-procurement mode only – www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in)

1. BSTDC invites E-Bids from eligible experienced Event Management Agencies for organizing Shrawani Mela 2026 in Bihar, as given below

GR. No.	State	Name of Project	Bid Security (Rs.)	Cost of RFP Document (Rs.)	Bid Processing Fee (Online Payment) (Rs.) (Non-Refundable)	Operation & Maintenance of the Project after Commissioning (In months)
1	Bihar	SELECTION OF EVENT MANAGEMENT AGENCY FOR ORGANIZING SHRAWANI MELA - 2026, IN THE ROUTE OF PALEZLA GHAT (SARAN) TO BABA GARIBNATH TEMPLE, MUZAFFARPUR.	2,00,000.00	10,000/-	590/-	10 Day
2		Date of Inviting tender			Date: 03.07.2026	
3		Date of downloading of Bid document.			From 08.07.2026 to 14.07.2026 up to 3.00 PM through website: www.eproc2.bihar.gov.in	
4		Place & Date of Pre-Bid meeting			Date: 10.07.2026, Time 3.00 PM, Chief Engineer, BSTDC office Sikk Heritage Building Daroga Prasad Rai Path , Patna-800001	
5		Last date and time for receipt of online Bids			Date 14.07.2026, at 3:00 PM	
6		Last Date and time for Submission of hard copy of relevant documents			Date 15.07.2026, at 2:00 PM	
7		Time and Date of opening of Technical Bids			Date 16.07.2026, at 11:30 AM	
8		Date of Technical Presentation			Date: 16.07.2026, at 12:30 PM onwards	
9		Time and Date of Financial Bids			To be Communicated later on	
10		Period of Bids validity			90 days	
11		Officer inviting Bids			Executive Engineer (North) (BSTDC)	

A Cold War-era Seychelles mission



VAPPALA BALACHANDRAN

IN APRIL 1986, Seychelles President France-Albert Rene made a special request to Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi during his visit to New Delhi: Depute a small team of Indian security officials to discreetly assess the existing security and police systems in his country.

This arose because of his doubts about his own security setup and since the entire Indian Ocean Islands were caught in the whirlpool of Cold War polemics. Consequently, this writer was chosen to lead a two-member team in 1987. The other member was a senior Intelligence Bureau (IB) official.

Rene, a “leftist,” had ousted James Mancham, the first “right-wing” president, from power in 1977, one year after the country’s independence. Since then, Mancham was openly in cohorts with the Western and South African intelligence agencies to return to power through counter coup or elections.

Although Rene personally knew many foreign leaders like French President Francois Mitterrand or Tanzanian President Julius Nyerere, there were reasons why he turned to India to do this sensitive work. He did not want to be caught in the Cold War crossfire. Also, France, which had guided Seychelles’ security for long, had turned against it for geopolitical reasons, forcing Rene to Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzgl

We were first taken to the President’s secretary, who led us to Rene’s modest office, where he gave us a briefing on what he was looking for. He frankly told us he could not trust his own security set-up due to “colour” divisions.

said Rene’s suspicions against the French involvement “were not totally groundless according to US Embassy reporting”.

These destabilising efforts reached a nadir on November 25, 1981, when 43 South Africa-supported mercenaries called “The Froth Blowers” led by British-Irish Colonel Thomas “Mad” Mike Hoare arrived at Mahe, Seychelles International Airport through Air Swaziland F-28 (Fokker) chartered aircraft. Their original idea was to enter the country like tourists and incite Rene’s opponents to rise in revolt. This time India was unwittingly involved in this attempted coup.

Although Hoare’s boys were dressed as tourists, a chance examination by a local customs official led to the discovery of AK-47 rifles in their baggage. Knowing that their game was up, the mercenaries took 70 airport staff hostage. They also took control of the airport control tower.

At that time a Boeing 707 Air India flight 224 led by Captain Umesh Saxena from Salisbury (now Harare), which was going to Bombay with 64 passengers on board, was arriving at the Mahe airport for a scheduled refuelling. While Hoare’s mercenaries allowed it to land, the local security forces assisted by Tanzanian soldiers did not want it to come down. A fire fight ensued which damaged the mercenary plane F-28 (Fokker).

Hoare’s mercenaries realised they could escape only through the AI flight and tried to force Captain Saxena to take them to Zimbabwe. They finally agreed to travel to Durban due to fuel shortage. At Durban, the mercenaries were arrested and later prosecuted.

In this background, we landed early in 1987 at the Mahe international airport near their capital city Victoria. We expected the airport and capital city to be ringed by uniformed troops in view of the earlier coup attempts. Surprisingly, we did not notice any unusual police or armed forces deployment there or on our way to the hotel.

The next morning, when we were taken to the presidential palace to meet President Rene, we were again surprised to find that except for a ceremonial guard outside, the corridors of the palace were deserted. We were first taken to the President’s secretary, who led us to Rene’s modest office, where he gave us a briefing on what he was looking for.

He frankly told us he could not trust his own security set-up due to “colour” divisions. He said he was changing the white Commissioner of Police and appointing a “mulatto” officer who had better relations with people, especially blacks. He wanted us to visit all the security establishments, including training institutes, assess their professionalism and give suggestions. In addition, he openly told us that he would have to work with the Western nations to dispel the notion that he was merely following the Soviet bloc. Amazingly, the same assessment was made by the CIA document in 1983 saying that Rene was “showing a more positive attitude toward the major US interest in Seychelles—the USAF tracking station in Mahe”.

We completed our assignment within a week and orally presented our findings to him, adding that we would send our written report through our Prime Minister’s office.

The writer is a former Special Secretary, Cabinet Secretariat, and was part of the committee to enquire into the 26/11 terror attacks

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Democracy that survives wrecking balls



FIFTH COLUMN

BY TAVLEEN SINGH

LAST WEEK America celebrated her 250th birthday, so I shall begin by saying happy birthday to the world’s oldest democracy from a citizen of the world’s largest democracy. As an admirer of America, I have been truly impressed that its institutions have managed to survive what The Economist recently called the “wrecking ball revolution” that Donald Trump has used to try and weaken them. It has made me reflect and brood over how our own institutions have been less resilient. Our prime ministers may not have used a wrecking ball, but right from the time that we became an independent nation, there have been attempts to weaken the institutions of democracy.

At the risk of invoking (yet again) the ire of the Gandhi family’s belligerent supporters on social media, I shall remind you that the First Amendment to our Constitution was brought to curb dissent. The opposite was true in America. The first amendment to that constitution says, ‘Congress shall make no law respecting an establishment of religion, or prohibiting the free exercise thereof; or abridging the freedom of speech, or of the press; or the right of the people peaceably to assemble, and to petition the Government for a redress of grievances.’

Those who believe that such freedoms have been damaged only since Narendra Modi became prime minister should read our own First Amendment. And we must never forget that the only prime minister who took a ‘wrecking ball’ to Indian democracy was Indira Gandhi. It is against this backdrop that we need to examine what has happened in twelve years of Hindutva Raj, during which a disturbing allergy to dissent has become evident. As a judge of the Bombay High Court reminded us last week, ‘it is the right of citizens to protest’.

It is sad but true that every time there is a protest of some kind, Modi’s acolytes, spokespersons and social media warriors collude to damage the reputation of the protesters. When farmers protested for more than a year against laws that they believed benefited corporations and not them, they were called anti-nationals, Khalistanis and traitors. All that the prime minister needed to have done was invite leaders of that protest for a cup of tea and listen to what they had to say. Why this did not happen, I do not know.

For the past two weeks, the Cockroach Janata Party’s leaders and supporters have been protesting in Jantar Mantar with a single demand that the education minister take responsibility for the mess in the education system and resign. If this minister had the smallest shred of self-respect, he would voluntarily hand in his resignation. Since he does not, it is the responsibility of the prime minister to ask for his resignation. Inexplicably, this has not happened, so now the ‘cockroaches’ have backed him into a corner. If he sacks the minister, it would seem like surrender, and if he does not, he will continue to alienate young students.

Meanwhile, sundry leftist leaders who never protested the crushing of dissent by ‘secular’ prime ministers are now banding together to share the stage in Jantar Mantar. Personally, I think the fast unto death by Sonam Wangchuk is a bad idea. The old ways of ‘satyagraha’ have become stale and boring. Young Indians must find new ways to make their case. It is also time they stopped invoking dead leaders and started looking for younger leaders in their own ranks. They have a right to be very angry about the appalling state of our education system and the terrifying absence of jobs for those who somehow manage to get an education. They have a right to be angry about other things. Corruption has become a huge issue since revelations about the looting of the Ram Temple in Ayodhya, and people are becoming increasingly angry about the deep roots of corruption in all our democratic institutions.

Corruption is, alas, not the only thing weakening our democracy. Almost as damaging has been the rise of a tendency in our political leaders to encourage an ugly form of cultism to build around them. They do this by plastering their pictures everywhere, from electricity poles and petrol stations to advertisements of their achievements in the newspapers and on television. If this is an attempt to show the people who hold up the institutions of democracy that big brother is watching, then they may have succeeded. But is this good for democracy? Clearly not.

The additional damage that this kind of narcissistic promotion does is that it proves that despite all our talk of development and modernity, we remain a third-world country in which elected leaders can behave like kings. It is true that in this 250th year of American independence, the leader of the free world is behaving more like a king than any leader in the third world, but American institutions have shown that they are strong enough to survive Trump.

In our own ancient and wondrous land, the institutions of democracy remain fragile. But here is a small warning to those political leaders bedazzled by their own propaganda: there is increasing evidence that voters are seeing through the propaganda. This is one reason why political parties built around the cult of a single leader and his extended family are beginning to crumble into dust. It is a warning that all political leaders would do well to heed.

Bring back the tigers that once roamed Mewar



AREFA TEHSIN

AFTER the Rajsamand MP’s statement opposing the proposed tiger reserve in Kumbhalgarh, a reactive skirmish has broken out. The MP, from the erstwhile royal family, has urged the Centre to drop the plan, stating that Kumbhalgarh “has never been a traditional tiger habitat”. The pushback is coming from erstwhile forest officers, some jagirdars of the former Mewar state. The tigers, one suspects, would twitch their whiskers on being told they had never actually been there. We, Mewaris, can’t take this as lightly.

Mewar stretches across south-central Rajasthan, from the Aravalli hills in the northwest to the Gujarat border in the south, and from Ajmer in the north to the Hadoti plateau in the east. Udaipur is its historic heart. The Kumbhalgarh forest was a royal hunting reserve. The right to hunt a tiger, notably, rested with the Maharana alone. Not other royals. Not the aristocracy. A leopard was fair game for the nobility, a tiger was not. A peer-reviewed paper in BT’s international journal (2022) by Bhanu Kapil and Uma Bhati of BN University, Udaipur, has dug into the Haqiqat Bahidas — the official shikar diaries of the Mewar rulers — and found that in 1838-39, Maharana Sardar Singh was receiving regular field intelligence about tigers near Udaipur. His men came across them at Kamlod, Tikhlya, Urjankhura. The Rajputana Gazetteers of the Mewar Residency record tigers in the Aravallis “from Kumbhalgarh to Kotra”.

Sherlock Holmes had warned Watson: “It is a capital mistake to theorise before one has data. One begins to twist facts to suit theories, instead of theories to suit facts.” The data, in this case, is considerable. Jaswant Singh Nathawat, ex-warden of Kumbhalgarh wildlife and park director of Ranthambore, has described in a video how he came across a tiger in Kumbhalgarh-Raoli Tatgarh sanctuary in 1967. My grandfather, T H Tehsin, later vice mayor of Udaipur, saw tigers in Mewar on several occasions. An archival register from the Raoli Forest Rest House in the Todgarh-Raoli Wildlife Sanctuary records tigers being shot from 1953 to 1955.

The concern about the Raika pastoral community and their camels is genuine, though it is worth noting that camels are not a tiger’s preferred quarry. The question of how a tiger reserve notification affects traditional grazing rights is one worth working through with the communities involved. It has a process; consultation, buffer zones, co-existence provisions, designed precisely because these situations are not new. We have navigated them in forests far more contested than Kumbhalgarh. It would be a pity to foreclose the conversation before it has properly begun.

There is also the question of what a tiger does to a landscape once it is back. Ecologists call it a keystone species, a polite way of saying its presence matters to things that have no obvious connection to tigers. Deer that know a predator is around don’t linger stripping a riverbank bare; they keep moving, nervously, which turns out to be rather good for the riverbank. The wolves of Yellowstone demonstrated this memorably. Kumbhalgarh’s wolves, leopards and hyenas lived alongside tigers for millennia. They did not find the arrangement disagreeable.

The Kumbhalgarh Wildlife Sanctuary, our family’s regular summer haunt since my childhood, is already a success story. Leopards, wolves, sloth bears, hyenas, jungle cats, golden jackals, caracals, honey badgers — it is almost like ticking off a field guide chapter. These forests predate British documentation. Many naturalists believe the terrain, cover, and prey base make it suitable for a tiger reintroduction. The region has historically been a tiger migration corridor from Gujarat through Panarwa to Jaisamand into Madhya Pradesh. What’s missing is not the habitat. It is the tiger, and that is a human doing, not an ecological verdict. The Aravallis of Mewar housed tigers, then lost them fairly recently, and seem to be in adequate shape for a second chance. Whether they get one is, as usual, less a question of ecology than of who is inconvenienced by the answer.

Tehsin, former honorary wildlife warden, Udaipur, is the author, most recently, of The Great Indian Safari

How UP got control over Kashi Vishwanath 44 years ago



HISTORY HEADLINE

BY SHYAMLAL YADAV

IN UTTAR PRADESH, revelations of alleged embezzlement in the Ram Mandir in Ayodhya have once again highlighted the vulnerabilities in the management of temples. It echoes a case of theft from nearly 44 years ago at the Kashi Vishwanath Temple in Varanasi. The theft in January 1983 not only exposed deep-rooted mismanagement but also became a turning point, prompting a change in the management of the temple and setting a historic precedent.

On the intervening night of January 4 and 5, 1983, the golden Argha — the base encircling the Shivalinga, weighing approximately 2.6 kilograms of gold — was stolen from the Kashi Vishwanath Temple. The incident, in the heart of Varanasi, sparked immediate outrage, leaving the government at the Centre and the state feeling uneasy.

At the time, Uttar Pradesh was under the leadership of Chief Minister Sriprati Mishra. The state police, headed by Shrish Chandra Dikshit, launched a swift investigation. By January 22, 1983, authorities had arrested 11 individuals. Much of the stolen property was recovered, though the process dragged on. The stolen items were finally returned to the temple trust in November 2006.

The fallout extended far beyond criminal proceedings. Public criticism mounted quickly against the mahant-led management system that had been in place for centuries. Facing growing pressure, the state government acted decisively. On January 28, 1983, an ordinance was promulgated, transferring management of the temple to a government-constituted trust. Later, on September 7, 1983, Social Welfare Minister Gulab Sehra introduced a bill in the UP Assembly to replace the ordinance. The bill passed swiftly and received assent from the President on October 12, 1983, becoming the Uttar Pradesh Sri Kashi Vishwanath Temple Act,



The state government took over the management of the Kashi Vishwanath temple in 1983. WIKIPEDIA

1983, which became effective retroactively from January 28. The Act established a board of trustees, comprising prominent religious figures and senior government officials, along with an executive committee for day-to-day operations. Vibhuti Narayan Singh was made trust president and continued in the position until his demise in 2000.

The transition highlighted stark contrasts in governance. Under the mahants, daily offerings were reportedly recorded at Rs 300-500. Temple assets were valued at nearly Rs 15.5 crore at the time of takeover. The government provided an initial loan of Rs 11 lakh to the new trust. Of this, Rs 6 lakh funded a replacement golden Argha, while the remaining Rs 5 lakh was deposited in a bank to generate interest for routine expenses. The government claimed that after the takeover, daily offerings increased up to Rs 1,500.

Minister Sehra, while tabling the bill, painted a picture of the pre-takeover era. Priests received a paltry Rs 8 per month plus meals — conditions he likened to “bonded labour”. In contrast, the new management raised salaries to Rs 300 per month, with lunch provisions. Infrastructure improvements followed: 20 tubelights and 11 fans were installed for better lighting and ventilation. Cleanliness campaigns were prioritised, and milk offered to the Shivalinga was distributed to orphans. Temple traditions continued, with 51 sanyasis fed every Monday and 30 poor individuals fed daily.

Families donating Rs 5,000 or more gained the privilege of performing puja in side the garbhagriha (sanctum sanctorum) once a year. The first major contribution was from then-PM Indira Gandhi. Within months, Rs 1 lakh had been raised. A police post near the temple bolstered security.

The management change, however, was not without controversy. Questions arose in the Assembly about Vibhuti Narayan Singh’s approach to the entry of Harijans into the temple — he had opposed it in the mid-1950s. Some MLAs asked whether any affidavits had been taken from him for not repeating the same. Shrish Chandra Dikshit joined the Vishva Hindu Parishad post-retirement in 1984 and joined the movement for the Ram Temple at Ayodhya. He eventually joined the BJP, got a ticket and entered the Lok Sabha in 1991.

The changes faced legal scrutiny as well, with challenges mounted in the Allahabad High Court and then, the Supreme Court. Finally, in a landmark March 14, 1997, verdict, the Supreme Court upheld state control. It observed that prior to 1983, “the management of Temple was in an appalling condition. Devoted pilgrims when they visited the Temples were subjected to exploitation at the behest of pandas, the precincts were in most unhygienic condition (sic).”

Yet, state control did not entirely eradicate problems. Thefts of a smaller scale continued, underscoring challenges to security and internal oversight.

The writer is Senior Associate Editor, The Indian Express

Entertainment industry’s war on statistical reality

THERE IS a particular kind of cultural conditioning that operates invisibly — so embedded in entertainment habits that we mistake it for taste. Viewers arrive at films primed by years of storytelling, by algorithms, and by the ambient noise of social media to receive male suffering as tragic, male grievance as legitimate, and male entitlement as worthy of scrutiny. The sympathy is allocated before the first scene has even begun.

At a standup show, comedian Pranit More encountered a crowd member who casually revealed he had bought a woman biryani for Rs 370 and considered this a transaction that entitled him to her body. He said it openly, in a room full of people. What’s striking was his ease. A person who has never been told, by anything he has watched or laughed at, that this outlook requires examination. That ease has a supply chain.

Dacoit, a Tamil production featuring Anurag Kashyap as a cop, centres around vengeance against a woman who betrayed her partner. The emotional architecture asks spectators to understand his anger, follow his trajectory, and invest in his rage. Bandar, Kashyap’s Bollywood follow-up goes further, constructing a world where false allegations against men function less as an anomaly and more as atmosphere. Every thread points to the same conclusion: men are a persecuted class, women wield courts as weapons, and institutions have abandoned the former.

The NCRB logged 4,41,534 crimes against women in 2024. Spousal and family cruelty alone accounted for over 1,20,000 cases, the single largest category of gender-based harm that year. These dynamics are sustained by social, institutional, and patriarchal structures that have historically rendered them ordinary. Incidents where women commit crimes against men, however high-profile, however frequently cited, are neither systemic nor institutionalised in this way. Yet such examples get amplified, weaponised, and now cinematically immortalised.

The operative question is proportion,

what gets funded, what gets widely distributed, and whose reality gets rendered as representative of larger truth. When a society consistently dramatises statistical exceptions while the pervasive danger women face remains peripheral, it is making a deliberate decision. What gets greenlit, what digital tools reward, and what legal mechanisms get deployed reflect whose interiority is considered universally legible, whose pain is deemed worthy of the screen, and whose precariousness is treated as a niche concern rather than a national crisis.

A woman is killed or driven to death by dowry pressure every 68 minutes in India. Women are murdered for rejecting men. Women are slain for leaving. These are not exceptional stories. These are the norm. But the falsely accused figure in a rigged system is what’s getting the big screen, the airwaves, and now the dock. That inversion is worth examining carefully, without looking away.

In 2026, the cultural ground is shifting beneath safety gains that were never secure



SHE SAID

BY MEENAKSHI JHA

to begin with. Cinema positions male resentment as complexity. Standup stages generate laughs from transactional entitlement. Podcasts reframe women’s legal recourse as weaponised victimhood. Each medium reinforces the next, and the cumulative weight arrives as a revised social contract: women’s security is contingent on not making men uncomfortable.

Sharper cultural literacy is the first line of defence: reading the subtext before absorbing the text, asking whose anger is being rendered sympathetic, whose experience is conspicuously absent from the frame, and what worldview is being normalised under the cover of entertainment. The screen has always reflected power. Right now, it is rehearsing it, and women are the audience being asked to applaud.

Jha is an educator and freelance writer

Editor (Planning & Projects) Shalini Langer curates the fortnightly ‘She Said’ column

RELIANCE ON SHORT-TERM FIXES MAY BE A WORRY FOR BANKS

Amid slowing CASA growth, banks turn to costly solutions

Akash Mandal
New Delhi, July 4

Credit growth has picked up over the past few months, but banks have struggled to grow their deposit base to match it. Growth in current account and savings account (CASA) deposits has particularly slowed, with retail investors now having a range of avenues to put their savings in, such as stocks and mutual funds. These avenues provide much better returns than traditional CASA accounts and have become more accessible over time due to digitisation and regulatory bodies' simplification of norms. CASA deposits are low-cost for banks and are used to fund loans, the major source of revenue.

They are considered a reliable and "sticky" source of funds for banks due to low churn, as such depositors aren't likely to shift this money to other banks easily.

Due to this mismatch in growth, the gap between credit and deposit growth has widened from 1.8 percentage points in December to 5.4 percentage points as of June 15, according to data from the RBI.

This has led to the credit-to-deposit ratio of banks — which is the percentage of a bank's deposits deployed as loans — widening to 82.5% as of June 15 from around 75% in mid-2025. The slowdown was also noted in the Reserve Bank of India's Financial Stability Report released last week.



CASA deposits are low-cost for banks and are used to fund loans, the major source of revenue. REUTERS
Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mljMzg1

Banks shifting to other funding avenues

As CASA deposits have slowed, banks have shifted to other sources of funds such as term deposits and CDs.

Term deposits refer to financial instruments where one locks in their money for a particular tenure to earn interest in return. This includes retail options such as fixed and recurring deposits. A CD is a type of term deposit used by corporates and institutions to raise money through the money markets.

"CASA is the low-cost liability available to banks. Additionally, on a behavioural pattern perspective, CASA can support creation of longer-tenure assets. CDs, on the other hand, have historically been used to manage shorter-dur-

ation liquidity by banks," said Rohan Mandora, associate director at Equirus Securities.

As a result, the share of CASA in the total deposit base of the banking system has fallen to around 39% from a peak of around 44% in FY22 (during the post-Covid liquidity boom). Meanwhile, the share of term deposits has inched up to all-time highs of over 61% from around 56% in FY23.

Why is it a concern

CASA deposits have always been a reliable funding source for banks due to their low cost (around 3-4% interest rate) and "stickiness". Term deposits and CDs, on the other hand, are much higher-cost (7-8% interest rate) options that ultimately squeeze the margins of banks. "CDs are wholesale, price-

• LOAN VS DEPOSIT

THE GAP between credit and deposit growth has widened from 1.8 percentage points in December to 5.4 percentage points as of June 15

THIS HAS led to the credit-to-deposit ratio of banks — which is the percentage of a bank's deposits deployed as loans — widening to 82.5% as of June 15 from around 75% in mid-2025

RBI, IN its Financial Stability Report released last week, also took note of the slowdown

"On funding costs, the pressure is visible but contained. The current rate-cut cycle works in banks' favour. CDs and bulk term deposits re-price downward the fastest, so short-term wholesale reliance is cheapest to carry precisely now. The risk flips when the rate cycle turns," said Choudhary. "Incrementally, some banks have marginally increased their term deposit rates in Q1. We expect the impact of higher share of bulk deposits to flow into cost of funds during 2HFY27," according to Mandora. Experts also believe the sluggish CASA growth is cyclical in nature after the post-Covid boom in liquidity due to steps by the central bank. "We believe this is more cyclical in nature and linked to overall liquidity in the system.

With most banks showing little difference in asset quality, liability franchise quality is becoming the key competitive moat in Indian banking," an analyst at a domestic firm said.

Thus, while banks have found shorter-term funding solutions as CASA growth has dried up, the over-reliance on such temporary fixes is a double-edged sword.

While it helps manage liquidity and fund the booming credit growth for now, a hike in interest rates by the RBI or an external crisis may hit the sector hard if CASA growth is not rejuvenated.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Skyroot co-founder: India's aerospace industry is taking a private turn with ISRO's help

Nikhila Henry
Hyderabad, July 4

INDIA'S AEROSPACE industry is "very encouraging" to private players, with ISRO and private companies developing a relationship which is similar to NASA and SpaceX in the US, Skyroot Aerospace co-founder Pawan Kumar Chandana told *The Indian Express*.

On June 2, Skyroot announced they will launch an orbital class rocket, Vikram-1, into space within a window of July 12 to August 4.

Skyroot is a private space launch company. In 2022, Skyroot launched India's first private satellite — Vikram-S — from ISRO's facilities.

Vikram-1 is designed to deploy small satellites of up to 350-kg to low Earth orbit. Built with an all-carbon composite structure and powered by solid and liquid propulsion systems — including 3D printed engines — developed by Skyroot, Vikram is going to be a successful flight, its makers say.

"At Skyroot, we already launched Vikram-S from ISRO's launch pad. That was a suborbital launch. Now we are getting ready for India's first private orbital launch. It is the first test flight. There is also an expression of interest released with regard to the Small Satellite Launch Vehicle (SSLV), Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle (PSLV) and Launch Vehicle Mark-3 (LVM-3) by the government of India.

So that private companies can take ISRO's vehicles and operate them. We will see more and more of this kind of collaboration in India," Chandana said. India's space economy is expected to grow from around \$8.4 billion now to \$44 billion by 2033.

Indigenous launch capability will be a critical enabler of this growth, unlocking opportunities for India's rapidly expanding private space ecosystem, Skyroot believes.

Vikram-1's test flight is im-

Free Whatsapp Channel <https://whatsapp.com/channel/0029Van2VRb6RGJOKH6oBd0F>



Skyroot launched India's first private satellite, Vikram-S, from ISRO's facilities in 2022. PHOTO: X/@PAWANKCHANDANA

portant because the ability to reach orbit reliably and frequently is a strategic capability that only a handful of nations have. Today, access to space remains a major bottleneck, with satellite operators often waiting months or even years for a launch opportunity.

"ISRO has been amazingly supportive. Their support has been excellent. What more they can do is that in whatever ISRO is doing, in their missions of national importance, they can have private startups as development partners. We could co-build some of the systems which ISRO would use — whether it be the space stations, new satellites they are developing or new rockets they are developing. We would like to be a more integral part of ISRO's developments making the ecosystem more sustainable, so that the startups would have revenue opportunities and ISRO would benefit from the startups' feed and energy," Chandana said.

The first flight would capture the real in-flight performance data from every system on Vikram-1. This will help the makers understand how the ve-

hicle performs from lift-off through every phase of ascent. "This data cannot be fully replicated through ground testing," Chandana said.

He added, "It is the first time in India that a private company has designed and developed a rocket meant to launch a satellite to space. This was enabled by the recent set of reforms by the government of India which opened up the sector to private players. We are completely designed, developed and manufactured rocket is going to take off from Indian soil. The rocket will have the capability to launch satellites to orbit. And in the entire world there are only a few companies with this capability. So it is a venture with a lot of business potential and also strategic importance for the country because we have the capability to launch more of our satellites to space".

Skyroot sees potential in the market because, "globally only two players who are regularly launching to space — one is SpaceX and another is Rocket Lab". "There are two or three other companies that have started their launches just like us but almost all of them are from the US. There are a couple of companies from China as well but access to the market is domestic for them. This will inspire other startups to come. Take the example of SpaceX, which has inspired others to come into the field. Similarly, we will also inspire others to venture into the field with unique solutions and differentiators," Chandana said.

The launch is called Mission Aagaman, meaning "the arrival" and it marks Skyroot's second mission following the successful suborbital flight of Vikram-S, the first private rocket to reach space from Indian soil, Chandana said.

Vikram-1 will be a partially commercial flight, with the company planning to commence full commercial flights after one or two successful demonstrations to orbit.

US DoJ urges judge to drop charges against Gautam Adani

New York: The US Department of Justice has forcefully defended its decision to abandon the criminal case against Indian billionaire Gautam Adani and 7 others, telling a federal judge the prosecution was legally flawed, diplomatically counterproductive and inconsistent with Trump administration's enforcement priorities.

In a sharply worded 10-page filing, the DOJ said the case "should have been dropped a year ago — or never brought in the first place," arguing that the court had only a limited role in reviewing its decision to dismiss charges with prejudice.

The filing came after US District Judge Nicholas Garaufis asked the department to explain why it was seeking to permanently dismiss the indictment, calling its earlier motion "terse, bland, and conclusory".

DOJ had in 2024 under the Biden administration indicted Adani and others for allegedly being involved in a scheme to bribe Indian government officials to the tune of \$250 million and to lie to investors to receive billions more in investments from other entities — during which alleged scheme Adani Green Energy Ltd raised at least \$175 million from US investors. The DOJ said requiring prosecutors to publicly justify decisions to drop cases would discourage future dis-

missals, expose privileged internal deliberations and infringe on the executive branch's constitutional authority over charging decisions. "Judicial inquisitions into the bases for dismissal will expose privileged internal debates," Principal Associate Deputy Attorney General R Trent McCotter wrote, adding that such demand hurt defendants by potentially chilling the Department from seeking dismissal of criminal charges it determines are not in the interests of justice.

Waiving privilege only for this case, McCotter said he decided to dismiss the charges after months of meetings with defence lawyers, reviewing hundreds of pages of submissions and conducting his own legal analysis.

"The decision to seek dismissal was not a close call," he wrote. The department cited six overarching reasons for dropping all charges, including that the alleged conduct was overwhelmingly centred in India, Indian authorities had investigated the allegations and found no actionable misconduct, investors suffered no financial losses, key evidence and witnesses were located abroad, the defendants were unlikely to ever appear before a US court, and the prosecution faced significant evidentiary hurdles. PTI



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman interacts with Indian professionals from Larsen & Toubro contributing to the International Thermonuclear Experimental Reactor in Cadarache, France, on Saturday. PHOTO: X/@FINMININDIA

Auto industry defends ethanol fuel mandate

Reuters
New Delhi, July 4

INDIAN GOVERNMENT and auto industry officials on Saturday defended the mandatory rollout of petrol blended with 20% ethanol, saying years of testing and service data showed no evidence of widespread vehicle damage, despite public concerns over lower fuel efficiency and engine safety.

The fuel — known as E20 — has faced rising criticism on social media in recent days, with motorists questioning whether older vehicles designed for lower ethanol blends could suffer corrosion, wear or reduced performance.

Automakers including Ma-

ruti Suzuki, Hero MotorCorp and Toyota Kirloskar Motor said even older vehicles can run safely on E20. Maruti Suzuki, India's largest carmaker, said it had serviced more than 15 million older cars over the past two years that were not certified for E20 and found no fuel-related problems.

"As a manufacturer, we have tested E10 cars which were prevalent before 2023 on E20 fuel for all parameters and we have not found anything of concern," Rahul Bharti, Maruti Suzuki's senior executive officer for corporate affairs, said at a joint press conference with government officials.

Industry officials acknowledged a minor trade-off: E20

reduces fuel efficiency by about 3-3.5% because of its lower energy content.

However, they said the fuel's higher octane rating can help carmakers design future engines with higher compression ratios, which could improve performance, torque, drivability and even fuel efficiency. Officials also rejected viral claims that E20 had caused engine failures, saying at least one widely shared case was linked to contaminated fuel rather than standard E20.

They added that E20 is the highest ethanol blend currently tested for regular petrol vehicles and said any move to higher blends would need fresh trials

India-Israel bilateral investment agreement comes into effect

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, July 4

THE INDIA-Israel Bilateral Investment Agreement (BIA), which will ensure a secure and predictable investment climate between the two countries, came into force from Saturday, the finance ministry said.

The pact, which will provide protection to the two-way investments, is expected to contribute to increased cross-border investment activity.

The two countries inked the treaty on September 8 last year. Under the pact, India has cut down the local remedies exhaustion period for Israeli investors to three years.

Local remedies exhaustion means that investors must first try to resolve their disputes using the legal system of the host country before they can take the matter to international arbitration. Normally, India keeps a five-year period for this.

The India-Israel BIA also includes portfolio investments in a deviation from such treaties in the past.

Israel is the first OECD (Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development) member with which India has inked this agreement.

The agreement is expected to pave the way for increased bilateral investments between the two countries. During April 2000 and March 2026, India received \$371.35 million foreign direct investment (FDI) from Israel.

The implementation of the pact is important as both countries are also negotiating a free trade pact. The negotiations for the trade pact are going slow due to the West Asia crisis. India is also negotiating bilateral investment treaties with other countries, including Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Oman, Switzerland, Russia, Australia and the European Union.

These investment treaties help in protecting and promoting investments in each other's countries. The government has earlier announced revamping the current model of BITs to make it more investor-friendly and attract foreign players.

Commenting on the pact, think tank GTRI said the 2015 model treaty has excluded portfolio investments, while the Israel agreement covers shares, stocks and other equity holdings, as well as qualifying bonds, loans and other corporate debt.

"This could widen India's exposure to investor-state disputes beyond traditional foreign direct investment to certain financial investments," GTRI Founder Ajay Srivastava said. He said the Israel pact allows investors to seek international arbitration after pursuing domestic legal remedies.

FOUNDER USED AN AI COACH TO DEVELOP PITCH TO INVESTORS

For one small business, AI was key to a quick start and expansion

Reuters
Washington, July 4

Here Now Health isn't an AI-based company, but its quick path from an idea in founder Michelle Turner's mind to an operating mental health platform for foster children relied deeply on the technology now restructuring the US economy.

Working from her Virginia Beach home, she used AI tools to school herself in startup culture, create a business plan and fine-tune a presentation for early-stage investors.

Funding began to flow, and the company, launched in January 2025, now has 16 employees and is certified in three states to provide Medicaid-funded mental health counseling for

children entering the foster system, a gap in care she identified through her own experience as a foster parent.

"A mom of six kids who's a first-time founder, who's a sole female founder, should not be able to raise (venture capital). I don't have an MBA. I don't have these things to back me up," Turner said.

Developing her funding pitch with AI guidance was "like going to a master's level class every day from the robot. It was my startup advisor."

The rapid emergence and spread of AI has become a defining feature of the US economy, of prime interest to Federal Reserve officials trying to understand its potential to reshape productivity, growth, inflation

and labor demand. Among a broad review of the Fed launched by new Chairman Kevin Warsh, one panel will look solely at AI and its implications for productivity, a force that can allow the economy to grow faster with less inflation, but also means fewer workers are needed to create the same output.

Some Fed officials have already raised the possibility of an AI economy with structurally higher unemployment; other analysts have noted the steady dip in labor's share of national income and questioned if steadily higher returns to capital are also part of the AI future, a who-wins issue with social and political implications.

Much like when then-exotic



Here Now Health was launched in January 2025 and now employs 16 people. REUTERS

new brands such as Yahoo! and America Online fought to connect everyone to the internet, different AI models are now competing for attention and dollars — but with offerings that can

perform complex tasks, solve problems, or write computer code, not just shop and search the Web.

Investment in data centers is driving overall growth and in

some cases driving up power and labor costs. Scenarios around AI range from visions of plenty to mass unemployment, with banks, government agencies, the military and more looking to exploit the new tools but also protect from them.

"Markets are confronted with dramatically different competing narratives," Jean Boivin, head of the BlackRock Investment Institute, said in a seminar with journalists on Tuesday.

"We are framing this as scarcity versus abundance... Scarcity is the story of the moment" with the AI investment boom driving up some costs and driving demand for capital, but, "we are also talking about abundance... We are talking about AI that can lead to significant break-

throughs... Growth that might be breaking out of a 2% world."

Somewhere in the middle sits Turner's journey from non-profit manager to chief executive of a growing company, a story John Bailey, a nonresident senior fellow at the American Enterprise Institute and adviser to one of the firms that invested in Here Now Health, says is becoming more common. For small entrepreneurs "things that used to take too much time or cost too much — the price to access has fallen close to zero," said Bailey, who helped Turner from the outset develop the AI tools she relied on. "It is empowering entrepreneurs to scale faster and hire people. These are not AI companies. They are traditional companies trying to deliver ser-

vices but do it faster, cheaper."

Public debate remains focused on AI's job-disrupting capacity, with rounds of tech industry layoffs attributed to it and evidence it is letting firms reduce back-office and clerical employment. Bailey said he's become more convinced the AI economy won't kill jobs so much as change and rearrange them, much as happened with earlier technological leaps.

He isn't alone in seeing upside. Torsten Slok, chief economist at investment firm Apollo Global Management, attributes a recent upturn in already-high new business formations to AI, which is "dramatically reducing the cost and complexity of launching a company. As these firms scale, they will create jobs."

Decision to resign intensely personal, says UK PM Starmer

Press Trust of India
London, July 4

KEIR STARMER has spoken of his decision to resign as Labour Party leader and British Prime Minister as an “intensely personal” one, which he took with his wife and children at a family weekend away. In his first interview since his Downing Street statement that fired the starting gun for a leadership election, Starmer told the BBC on Friday evening that he would complete his current term as a central London member of Parliament.

But, while on the backbenches of Parliament, the 63-year-old politician plans on “keeping his mouth shut” to allow his successor “widely expected to be former Greater Manchester Mayor Andy Burnham to get on with the job.

“I grappled with what was the best thing to do for me, for the country, for the government,” said Starmer. “In the end it became an intensely personal decision. And that’s why it was a decision taken ultimately when (my wife) Vic and I were away with the kids,” he said. On June 22, when he announced his resignation on the steps of 10 Downing Street, the Starmer family was in Buckinghamshire.

MOSCOW CLAIMS ITS FORCES HAVE CAPTURED TRANSPORT AND INDUSTRIAL HUB KOSTIANTYNIVKA

Ukrainian drones hit St Petersburg oil terminal in latest strike on Russia

Associated Press
July 4

A UKRAINIAN drone attack struck an oil terminal in St. Petersburg on Saturday, Russian officials said, as Kyiv presses on with bombardment of Russia’s oil infrastructure.

Almost daily long-range attacks on Russian oil facilities have created a fuel crisis and heaped political pressure on the Kremlin as its all-out invasion of Ukraine stretches into its fifth year.

Gov. Alexander Beglov said the city’s Kirovsky district on the Baltic Sea was hit. He also said that air defenses shot down 72 Ukrainian drones across Russia’s second-largest city and the surrounding region.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy described the attack as part of Ukraine’s “long-range sanctions” against Russia. He said that Ukrainian forces also hit a military target on the island of Kronstadt, just off the coast of St. Petersburg.

“The Ukrainian defence forces hit the port oil infrastructure, which earns money for the Russian war, and there were



Russian President Vladimir Putin chairs a meeting as he visits a command post of Russia’s joint force grouping at an unidentified location on Friday. REUTERS

also hits on Kronstadt — an important military target,” he said in a post on Telegram.

St. Petersburg’s Kirovsky district was previously hit in June, ahead of Russia’s flagship St. Petersburg International Economic Forum.

The Crimean peninsula,

which Russia annexed in 2014, has suffered particularly from heavy strikes, causing local authorities to suspend gasoline sales to civilians. A Ukrainian attack on Saturday killed one person and injured two more, including a 10-year-old child, the Moscow-installed Gov. Ser-

gei Aksyonov said.

Russian President Vladimir Putin has shrugged off Ukraine’s strikes on Russia’s energy facilities as “not critical,” and insisted the war will continue until his goals are met. He has described the attacks on Russian energy as an

effort by Ukraine to distract attention from its losses on the battlefield, although analysts say the advance of Russian forces has been stymied in recent months.

On Friday, Putin visited the Russian military headquarters directing the war in Ukraine and received a report on the capture of the city of Kostyantynivka, after weeks of intense street battles. He hailed it as a key step toward capturing the nearby cities of Sloviansk and Kramatorsk, the key remaining strongholds in the so-called “forest belt” of heavily fortified cities in the Donetsk region that remain in Ukraine’s hands.

The capture of Kostyantynivka, a big transport and industrial hub, is of “major strategic importance,” Putin, clad in military fatigues, said in televised comments.

In a briefing Saturday, Col. Gen. Sergei Rudskoy, the first deputy chief of the General Staff of the Russian armed forces, said that Ukrainian troops had been pushed back several kilometers (miles) and that fighting was taking place on the outskirts of the nearby town of Oleksiiievo-Druzhkivka.

• BRIEFLY

BELGIUM

Company that won tariff relief gifted Trump an encrusted ring



The ring is designed by Antwerp designer David Gotlib. REUTERS

DOZENS OF diamonds spell out two giant letter T’s next to the Stars and Stripes and “1776” and “2026.” Dozens more frame the numbers 45 and 47 in the shape of Superman’s logo. A diamond-winged eagle carries a ruby shield and clutches an olive branch of emeralds, below a radiant “250” and atop the phrase “250 YEARS USA” etched in 18-karat gold. All told, 321 diamonds, 56 sapphires, 13 emeralds and six rubies encrust the watch-sized gold ring presented this week to Bill

White, the US ambassador to Belgium, to give to U.S. President Donald Trump. “A very special thank you to my friends from Antwerp for the magnificent Freedom 250 ring,” Trump said in a prerecorded video message during an event marking America’s 250th birthday in Brussels. AP

SLOVAKIA

Referendum to decide lifelong salary for PM

SLOVAKS WILL cast the ballot on Saturday in a referendum to decide whether to cancel lifelong payments for populist Prime Minister Robert Fico and other leaders after their terms in office expire. They will also vote on whether to reopen the office of the special prosecutor and the National Criminal Agency, which both dealt with major crime and corruption. The referendum follows a petition organised by the Democrats, a non-parliamentary pro-Western opposition party, and was signed by more than 3,50,000 citizens in the nation of 5.4 million, the threshold required by law. AP

MALI

Govt reports attacks targeting northern towns

THE MALIAN army said Saturday that several northern towns, including Gao and Sévaré, were targeted by rebels. The statement came as a rebel group announced a new offensive to capture a northern town. Mohamed Elmaouloud Ramadane, a spokesperson for the Azawad Liberation Front (FLA), said in a Facebook post that the town of Anéfis was being targeted by the separatists. There were no immediate reports of casualties. Mali has previously faced insurgencies by militants affiliated with al-Qaida and the Islamic State group, as well as a separatist rebellion in the north. AP



People take part in a protest against a convention of far-right Alternative for Germany (AfD) party, in Erfurt on Saturday. REUTERS

Thousands protest in Germany as far-right AfD sets sights on power

Reuters
Erfurt, July 4

THOUSANDS PROTESTED against Germany’s far-right AfD and blocked roads to its annual conference in the eastern city of Erfurt on Saturday, where the party re-elected the two leaders who have overseen its rise as a national force.

Protesters from unions, civil society groups and left-wing parties gathered as large numbers of police, including reinforcements from across Germany, were deployed ahead of the AfD’s two-day conference.

Watched by police in riot gear, protesters sat in rows to block highways and roads leading to the convention centre where the meeting is being held. Police estimated around 15,000 people joined demonstrations in and around the eastern city.

The AfD launched the event by re-electing party chiefs Alice Weidel and Tino Chrupalla, under whose leadership the AfD has surged to the top of national opinion polls ahead of Chancellor Friedrich Merz’s conser-

vatives. The opening speeches mocked and lambasted the protesters as anti-democratic. They revelled in the AfD’s rise that could see the party taking power in regional elections this year for the first time, while painting their mainstream rivals as tired, out of touch and leading Germany into decline.

“For this remains our last chance to save our country,” Weidel said. “More and more people in this country want to support us in the fight against Germany’s decline, in the fight for our fatherland and for our identity.” Underscoring the party’s hard line on immigration, a song called “Send them back” played on the AfD’s social media stream minutes before the convention opened. Inside the convention centre, vintage-style cards were on sale with slogans such as “YOU will be deported”. Björn Hoefke, seen as one of the party’s most radical and controversial leaders, offered a mix of nostalgia and invective, even pointing to the state of Germany’s motorway tolls as an example of national malaise.

Iranians flock to Khamenei’s funeral

Reuters
Dubai, July 4

Tens of thousands of Iranians thronged a vast outdoor prayer complex in Tehran on Saturday to view the coffin of Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, who ruled the Islamic Republic for 37 years before being killed at the start of the U.S.-Israeli war on Iran.

Dressed in black and draped in the red, white and green flags of the Islamic Republic of Iran, mourners held up posters and A4 printed sheets with pictures of Khamenei and his son and successor as supreme leader, Mojtaba Khamenei.

Iran is staging mass funeral processions for Khamenei, who was killed in February by the opening airstrikes of the war launched by the U.S. and Israel, in a show of public devotion to the Islamic Republic’s theocratic state and revolutionary zeal.

After a day of Khamenei lying in state indoors for senior Iranian leaders and foreign officials to visit, his coffin, and



Iranian religious leaders walk past the coffin of the late Iranian Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei in Tehran on Saturday. AP

those of several family members killed in the same airstrike, were brought to an outdoor stage for the general public to view from a distance, television footage showed.

Mourners filed into the vast courtyard of the Imam Khomeini Grand Mosalla, beating their chests, wailing and wav-

ing the banners of the Islamic Republic and historic Shi’ite Muslim martyrs. Women dressed in black chadors wore white visors or held umbrellas to shield from the hot mid-morning sun.

“Let us wail!” a compere encouraged the crowds through a loudspeaker. “Everybody chant

President Trump hails US, denounces Communism during 250th celebration

Steve Holland
Keystone, July 4

US PRESIDENT Donald Trump called on Americans to protect the freedoms the nation’s founders envisioned 250 years ago against what he has portrayed as the “communist” threat posed by progressive Democrats, speaking on the eve of Independence Day at Mount Rushmore.

“We stand beneath the monument of these heroes, a true group of unbelievable people, and we rededicate ourselves to being a nation as big, bold, noble, and as great as these American giants, and that’s not easy to do, but we’re going to do



President Donald Trump speaks at Mount Rushmore National Memorial on Friday. AP

it,” Trump said at the granite mountain in South Dakota where the heads of four American presidents are carved.

“There is now a resurgence of the communist menace in our land, including from new-

comers to our country who embrace ideas totally opposed to our way of life and our great success,” he said. Trump has been making such points about gains by democratic socialists for a week now, but he made his most pointed and prolonged argument on that theme on Friday, coming as Americans grapple with persistent inflation and high gas prices since the start of the US-Israeli war on Iran.

Increasingly uneasy that the conflict could cost the party control of at least one chamber of Congress in midterm elections, Republican lawmakers have seized on a recent string of successes by left-wing Democratic candidates. REUTERS

Brazil: Lula and Flávio Bolsonaro clash over US tariff proposal

Rio De Janeiro: Brazil’s President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva and his rival Sen. Flávio Bolsonaro clashed over U.S. tariffs this week, as both sought to discourage the Trump administration from following through with its proposal of applying taxes of 25% on Brazilian products despite an extensive U.S. trade surplus. The two top candidates for October’s presidential election traded barbs over their responses, suggesting that they believe how they are perceived as handling the deeply unpopular U.S. tariffs will be a key factor in the vote. AP

• THE FINDINGS INCLUDE 11 ROCK-CUT TOMBS, WITH AN AVERAGE DEPTH OF 8 METRES, AND SEVEN SURFACE LIMESTONE-BUILT TOMBS

Well preserved: Egypt uncovers lost Byzantine-era city in the western desert

Samy Magdy
Cairo, July 4

A WELL-PRESERVED Byzantine-era residential city in the western desert is one of two major archaeological finds announced by Egypt on Saturday.

The recent discoveries at the Dakhla Oasis and at the Marina el-Alamein archaeological site, near Alexandria, are the latest findings which the Egyptian government hopes will boost the country’s vital tourism sector, partially driven by antiquities sightseeing.

Along with the strategic Suez Canal, tourism is a major source of foreign currency in the cash-strapped country.

The Tourism and Antiquities Ministry said that the first discovery reveals details of daily life, urban development and economic activities in the Dakhla Oasis in the fourth century, when Egypt was part of the Byzantine empire.

The unearthed quarters included north-south thoroughfares intersected by east-west streets, forming open squares and public spaces, said Hisham el-Leithy, secretary general of the supreme council of antiquities. A basilica church, dating back to the mid-fourth century, stands at the settlement’s head, overlooking its main streets, along with remains of two watchtowers to safeguard

the outskirts, said Mahmoud Massoud, who chairs the archaeological mission.

The oasis, located in Egypt’s western province of New Valley in the western desert, is on UNESCO’s Tentative List, a step away from being added to the agency’s World Heritage List.

A heavily fortified structure with thick defensive walls, and many houses consisting of reception halls and vaulted roofs were found in the area, Massoud said. Among them were the house of Tisous, identified as a church deacon and dating to the second half of the fourth century, which archaeologists believe served as a house church before the construction



It is located in Egypt’s western province of New Valley Free Telegram Channel https://t.me/+2RvD_RGf9mJmZg1 of the city’s basilica.

Archaeologists also uncovered bread ovens, kitchens and stone grinding tools that

had been apparently used to produce food. Also found were well-preserved bronze coins bearing portraits of Byzantine

emperors, Latin inscriptions and Christian symbols, alongside a group of gold coins dating to the reign of Roman emperor Constantius II, who ruled between 337 and 361, the ministry statement said.

Diaa Zahran, head of the Islamic, Coptic and Jewish Antiquities department, said they found a collection of about 200 pottery fragments which would have been used as writing material. The fragments, known as ocraca, have inscriptions detailing commercial transactions, correspondence and other details of daily life, Zahran said.

Separately, archaeologists have found 18 ancient tombs in the Marina el-Alamein archae-

ological site, which is around 100 kilometers (62 miles) west of the Mediterranean city of Alexandria.

The findings included 11 rock-cut tombs, with an average depth of 8 meters, and seven surface limestone-built tombs, the ministry said. That has brought the total tombs found in the site to 48, ministry said. In the site, archaeologists found pottery vessels, amphorae, lamps, plates, altars and limestone basins, it said.

Mission chief Eman Abdel-Khaliq said they found a 2.5-meter-long granite sarcophagus, with skeleton remains that were currently being studied. Close to the sarcophagus, they

found the remains of a plaster sphinx statue, she said.

Abdel-Khaliq said they also found 4 gold pieces placed inside the mouths of some of the deceased — known as “the golden tongue,” which had been a practice associated with funerary beliefs of that era.

Marina el-Alamein is an archaeological site close to the city of Alamein in Egypt’s Northern Coast.

Unearthed in 1986, archaeologists believe that the site was the ancient Greco-Roman port city of Leukaspis on the Mediterranean, which was built in the second century and thrived until the fourth century, the ministry said. AP

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

E-Tendering Tender Notice No.35/2026

Divisional Railway Manager (Engg.) N.E.Railways, Izatnagar for and behalf of President of India invites "OPEN" e-tender through on Line (E-tendering) for the following works:

S.N.1:-Description of works: Balance steel work, roofing work, construction of pit line, associated works in connection with provision of sick line shed for NMG (size 35x18m) at LKU stn under ADEMNKP/Jurisdiction of IZN Division N.E. Railway Approx. Value (Rs.): ₹ 99,70,220.75, E.M.D Money (Rs.): ₹ 1,99,400/-, Cost of Tender Forms Rs. NIL., Completion time /period from the date of issue of acceptance letter 06 Months.

S.N.2:-Description of works: Provision of deep tube well by heavy duty dual rotary machine, Rig machine and over head Tank (50000 gallon capacity) in jurisdiction of ADEMNKP/Jurisdiction of N.E. Railway Approx. Value (Rs.): ₹ 2,29,63,387.09, E.M.D Money (Rs.): ₹ 4,59,300/-, Cost of Tender Forms Rs. NIL, Completion time /period from the date of issue of acceptance letter 06 Months.

1. Sr. No.1 On line e-tender can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs of dated 24.07.2026, 2. Sr. No.2 On line e-tender can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs of dated 27.07.2026, 3. For Full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways IREPS website www.ireps.gov.in.

Divisional Railway Manager(Engg.) CPROW-220 Izatnagar

Never travel on roof and foot boards

The Kerala Minerals and Metals Ltd

(A Govt. of Kerala Undertaking),Sankaramangalam,Kollam 691583
Phone : 0476-2651215 to 217, E-Mail :md@kmmil.com

TENDER NOTICE

For more details please visit E-Tendering Portal, <https://etenders.kerala.gov.in> or www.kmmil.com

Sl No	Tender Id	Items
1	2026_KMML_858666	1 Supply of 1800.00 MT of Sulphuric Acid

Chavara 04.07.2026 Sd/- Managing Director for The Kerala Minerals and Metals Ltd

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No. CEN05GWL0226 Date: 03.07.2026

Deputy Chief Engineer (Construction), North Central Railway, Gwalior for and on behalf of the President of India invites (Singal Packet) open tender on line (E-Tendering). Tender offer can be submitted on line up to **15:00 hours of 28.07.2026**, on website <http://ireps.gov.in>. The details of the tenders are as under:

Tender No. E-Tender Notice No. CEN05GWL0226
Approx Cost in Rs.: Rs. 45,51,631.20 **Completion period :** 12 (Twelve Months)
Description of work: Maintenance of track (new GC Line) between Sabalgarh to Birpur section under ADEN GWL.

Date of Closing : 28.07.2026 **Validity :** 60 days

Note : For complete details and submission of tender please see Indian Railway's website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> 1530/26 (ADM)

North central railways **CPRONCR** www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

"IMPORTANT"

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ERODE DISTRICT COOPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS' UNION LIMITED

CATTLE FEED PLANT, CHENNI MALAI ROAD, ERODE-638001, Email Id: eroavin.cfp@gmail.com

TENDER NOTICE (e-auction)
(Only through e-Procurement Portal at <http://intenders.gov.in>)

TWO PART Tenders are invited for way of e-submission through e-procurement Portal only from Private Lorry providers/contractors for Supply of Cattle Feed and Mineral Salt Mix To Various District Unions, Government Institutions, Government Farms and A.H. Department from Aavin Cattle Feed Plant, Erode.

Tender document availability	The tender documents can be downloaded from website e-Procurement Portal http://intenders.gov.in upto 03.08.2026, 5.45 pm.
2 e-Submission closing date & time	04.08.2026 upto 3.00 PM
3 Pre Bid Meeting	Erode District Co-operative Milk Producers' Union Ltd, Vasavi College-(PO), Erode-638316 on 22.07.2026, 11.00 AM
4 Bid-opening Date, Time & address	Part-I Technical Bid 05.08.2026 at 11.00 AM Part-II Commercial Bid After scrutinization of technical bids, information through http://intenders.gov.in Erode District Co-operative Milk Producers' Union Ltd, Vasavi College-(PO), Erode-638316

The tenders should submit their bids only through e-Procurement Portal <http://intenders.gov.in>. All other details can be seen in the tender documents. Corrigendum/Audendum to this publication, if any would appear only on the above said website. If any modification in this regard it will be communicated through above website only.

The decision of General Manager, EDCMPUL Ltd, Erode shall be final conclusive and binding on all matters relating to this tender.

Place: Erode **DIPR/2213/TENDER/2026** **General Manager,** Erode District Cooperative Milk Producers' Union Ltd. **Date:** 04.07.2026

कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता, प्रांतीय खण्ड, लो०नि०वि० मथुरा।

अल्पकालीन ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट निविदा सूचना

पत्रांक : 2426/ए-7/2026-27 दिनांक: 20.06.2026

1. महानिधि, राज्यपाल उ०प्र० की ओर से अधिशासी अभियन्ता, प्रांतिय खण्ड, लो०नि०वि० मथुरा द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्य की प्रतियोगिता पर निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। इस कार्य हेतु लो०नि०वि० में ए० बी० सी० एवं सी० श्रेणी में मार्ग कार्य में पंजीकृत अनुभवी ठेकेदार की निविदा डालने के पत्र जारी। निविदादाता से अपेक्षा की जाती है, कि निविदा डालने से पूर्व निविदा पत्र में अंकित न्यूनतम अर्हता के सम्बन्ध में शर्तों का पन्नी पत्रि अध्ययन कर ले।

क्र. सं.	जिला	कार्य का नाम	अनुमानित लागत (रु. लाख में)	धरोहर धराश्रिता (रु. लाख में)	निविदा प्रारंभ मूल्य (रु.)	कार्य पूर्ण की अवधि	कार्य सम्पन्नित करने वाले अधिशासी अभियन्ता का पता	सम्बन्धित अधिशासी अभियन्ता का पता	सम्बन्धित मुख्य अभियन्ता का पता
1	मथुरा	जनपद मथुरा में यमुना नदी पर मांठ-चाण्डा पान्द्रु फीरी पर वर्षाछत्र में पारत बाज की संरचना का कार्य।	14.00	1.40	स्टेन्डर की चार्ज रु. 500 + दी. सी. रु. 300 + जीएसटी = रु. 860	03 माह	अधिशासी अभियन्ता प्रांतिय खण्ड, लो०नि०वि०, मथुरा	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता आगरा रु. लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	मुख्य अभियन्ता आगरा बेरा, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा
2	मथुरा	जनपद मथुरा में यमुना नदी पर रवाहा ओहावा पान्द्रु फीरी पर वर्षाछत्र में पारत बाज की संरचना का कार्य।	14.00	1.40	स्टेन्डर की चार्ज रु. 500 + दी. सी. रु. 300 + जीएसटी = रु. 860	03 माह	अधिशासी अभियन्ता प्रांतिय खण्ड, लो०नि०वि०, मथुरा	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता आगरा रु. लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	मुख्य अभियन्ता आगरा बेरा, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा
3	मथुरा	जनपद मथुरा में यमुना नदी पर देवराहा बाबा आश्रम पान्द्रु फीरी पर वर्षाछत्र में पारत बाज की संरचना का कार्य।	14.00	1.40	स्टेन्डर की चार्ज रु. 500 + दी. सी. रु. 300 + जीएसटी = रु. 860	03 माह	अधिशासी अभियन्ता प्रांतिय खण्ड, लो०नि०वि०, मथुरा	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता आगरा रु. लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	मुख्य अभियन्ता आगरा बेरा, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा
4	मथुरा	जनपद मथुरा में यमुना नदी पर बुन्दवा मंठ पान्द्रु फीरी पर वर्षाछत्र में पारत बाज की संरचना का कार्य।	14.00	1.40	स्टेन्डर की चार्ज रु. 500 + दी. सी. रु. 300 + जीएसटी = रु. 860	03 माह	अधिशासी अभियन्ता प्रांतिय खण्ड, लो०नि०वि०, मथुरा	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता आगरा रु. लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	मुख्य अभियन्ता आगरा बेरा, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा
5	मथुरा	जनपद मथुरा में यमुना नदी पर लोनीय सखीबाबा पान्द्रु फीरी पर वर्षाछत्र में पारत बाज की संरचना का कार्य।	14.00	1.40	स्टेन्डर की चार्ज रु. 500 + दी. सी. रु. 300 + जीएसटी = रु. 860	03 माह	अधिशासी अभियन्ता प्रांतिय खण्ड, लो०नि०वि०, मथुरा	अधीक्षण अभियन्ता आगरा रु. लो०नि०वि०, आगरा	मुख्य अभियन्ता आगरा बेरा, लो०नि०वि०, आगरा

- वेबसाइट <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर निविदा से सम्बन्धित समस्त विवरण एवं विस्तृत शर्तें तथा बिडिंग डाइरेक्टिवेन्डर आन लाइन देखे जा सकते हैं तथा दिनांक 07.07.2026 से 13.07.2026 को दोहरा 12:00 बजे तक प्राप्त किये जा सकेंगे। आन लाइन बिड दिनांक 13.07.2026 को अपरान्ह 12:30 बजे या इससे पूर्व ई-निविदा <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर अनिवार्य रूप से ऑनलाइन जमा कर दी जाये एवं शासनादेश सं०-14 / 2020/879/23-7-2020-176 (सा०)/०6 दिनांक 25.08.2020 के क्रम में प्रहरी सायटवेयर (<http://vms.upppwd.gov.in>/Prahari) पर अनिवार्य रूप से सभी बिडिंग अभिलेखों सहित ऑनलाइन जमा कर दी जाये एवं आन लाइन प्राप्त समस्त टेक्निकल बिड दिनांक 01.07.2026 को अपरान्ह 01:00 बजे खोली जायेगी।
- निविदादाता द्वारा निविदा शुल्क / पोस्टल धनराशि इंटरनेट बैंकिंग के माध्यम से शासनदेस सं०-742/78-2-2018-42आई०टी०/2017 टी.सी.-49 आई०टी० एवं इलेक्ट्रॉनिक्स सेक्टर-2 दिनांक 03.12.2018 द्वारा जारी निर्देशों के क्रम में निम्नवत जमा कराये जायेंगे।
- निविदा शुल्क की धनराशि (कोलन संख्या 6 के अनुसार) ऑनलाइन इंटरनेट बैंकिंग (Non refundable).
- निविदा से सम्बन्धित अधिक जानकारी वेबसाइट <http://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है।

अगर ओ० संख्या-253243 दिनांक-03/07/2026 www.upidadv.gov.in

अधिशासी अभियन्ता, प्रांतीय खण्ड, लो०नि०वि०, मथुरा

कार्यालय अधिशासी अभियन्ता मध्य गंगा नहर निर्माण खण्ड-09 संभल

ई-प्रोक्योरमेंट अल्पकालीन ई-निविदा सूचना संख्या-02/अधि०अभि०/2026-27

महानिधि राजपाल उत्तर प्रदेश की ओर से अधोऽस्थासत्री द्वारा निम्नलिखित कार्य की ऑन लाइन प्री-क्वालीफिकेशन / टेन्डींग एवं फाईनेंशियल बिड <http://etender.up.nic.in> के माध्यम से सिआई विभाग में पंजीकृत श्रेणी में उजीकृत ठेकेदारों से दिनांक 14.07.2026 की पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे तक आमंत्रित की जाती है। यह निविदा दिनांक 09.07.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे से दिनांक 14.07.2026 की पूर्वाह्न 11:00 बजे तक उपर्युक्त वेबसाइट पर ऑनलाइन एवं अपलोड की जा सकती है। प्री-क्वालीफिकेशन / टेन्डींग बिड दिनांक: 14.07.2026 को अपरान्ह 12:00 बजे प्रेषित अभियन्ता, मध्य गंगा नहर परियोजना, सिआई एवं जल संसाधन विभाग, उ०प्र०, अलीगढ़ द्वारा प्रति समिति बिड आन लाइन खोली जायेगी। कार्यालय बसेर होने या अवकाश होने की स्थिति में यह बिड जगले कार्यालय दिवस में उसी समय खोली जायेगी। प्री-क्वालीफिकेशन बिड में क्वालीफिकेशी घोषित निविदादाताओं की काइर्नमेंशियल बिड खोलेने की तिथि एवं समय वेबसाइट पर डाल दी जायेगी एवं उसी के अनुसार फाईनेंशियल बिड ऑनलाइन खोली जायेगी।

लाट सं०	कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की अनुमानित लागत (लाख रुपये में)	कार्य की धराश्रिता (लाख रु० में)	निविदा प्रारंभ का मूल्य	पंजीकृत श्रेणी
1	CONSTRUCTION OF FALL AT KM 4.050 OF ESCAPE	31.10	0.62	80 दिवस	"B" एवं उच्चतर
2	CONSTRUCTION OF D.R.B. CUM CANAL SYPHON AT KM. 2.050 OF FATEHPUR MINOR	27.70	0.55	60 दिवस	"B" एवं उच्चतर
3	CONSTRUCTION OF ROAD AT RIGHT BANK OF CHANDAUASI BRANCH FROM KM 40.860 TO KM 40.945	19.70	0.39	45 दिवस	"B" एवं उच्चतर
4	CONSTRUCTION OF V.R.B CUM FALL AT KM 1.690 OF THARESA MINOR.	18.00	0.36	45 दिवस	"B" एवं उच्चतर
5	CONSTRUCTION OF BALANCE WORK OF ESCAPE FROM KM 0.000 TO KM 4.200	17.60	0.35	45 दिवस	"B" एवं उच्चतर
6	CONSTRUCTION OF FALL AT KM. 2.500 OF FATEHPUR MINOR	8.40	0.17	45 दिवस	"C" एवं उच्चतर
7	CONSTRUCTION OF FALL AT KM. 2.800 OF FATEHPUR MINOR	8.00	0.16	45 दिवस	"C" एवं उच्चतर
8	EARTH WORK FOR CONSTRUCTION OF CANAL IN EXTRA LENGTH (318 METER) FROM KM 0.140 TO KM 8.920 OF HAIDERPUR DY.	5.84	0.12	45 दिवस	"C" एवं उच्चतर

यह निविदा/बिड <http://etender.up.nic.in> एवं उ०प्र० सरकार की वेबसाइट <http://up.gov.in> तथा सिआई विभाग की वेबसाइट <http://www.idup.gov.in> पर उपलब्ध है। नियम एवं शर्तें सिआई विभाग एवं ई-टेंडरिंग की वेबसाइट पर देखी जा सकती है।

(राजीव कुमार)
अधिशासी अभियन्ता
मध्य गंगा नहर निर्माण खण्ड-9
संभल

UPID-253300 Dt. 03/07/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice

E-Tender is invited by Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer(G)/N.E. Railway/ Izatnagar for & on behalf of the President of India for the following work:-**Sl. No. - (I) Tender Notice No. : IZN - Elect - OT - 24 - 2026 Dt. 02.07.2026.** Description of work : General Electrification work of "new station building & platform of Pilibhit station" as per revised master plan and Yard remodeling of Pilibhit station of Izatnagar Division of N.E. Railway. Approximate tender value in Rs. : 2,25,54,102.26, Earnest Money in Rs. : 4,51,100.00, Cost of tender paper in Rs. : Nil, Tender Type : Open Tender, Date & time of closing E-tender : 23.07.2026 at 15.00 hours., Completion time from the date of issue of letter of Acceptance : 12 Months. • Manual offers are not allowed against this tender and such manual offer received shall be ignored. • The tender can be viewed at website : <http://www.ireps.gov.in> • The tenderer/ bidders must have Class-III Digital signature certificate & must have registered on IREPS portal. • All relevant papers must be uploaded at the time of participating in e-tendering. • The bidders are advised to periodically check for online corrigendum issued, if Any. No separate publication in newspaper shall be issued.

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer (G) / CPROEL-86 Izatnagar

"Never travel on roof and foot boards"

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender Notice No. : RTTM_Upgrade_T.Exp.-2025, Date : 02.07.2026

On line (through e-tendering) Tender for the following work is invited by Dy. Chief Engineer (Track Machine), Plant Depot, East Central Railway, DDU for and on behalf of the President of India, from reputed Firms.

E-Tender Closing Date : 24.07.2026

1. Name of the work with its Location : RTTM_Upgrade_T.Exp.-2025- Technical Upgradation of 09-3X Tamping Express machine No. 3956 to latest available High Output Tamping & Stabilizing Machine (Model 09-3X Dynamic Tamping Express). Tender Cost - Nil, 2. Approx Cost of the work : ₹15,81,20,000/-, 3. Earnest Money : ₹31,62,400/-, 4. Date and time for submission of e-tender : 24.07.2026 upto 15:00 hrs., 5. Website particulars of e-tendering : www.ireps.gov.in

Dy. Chief Engineer/TMC, Plant Depot/ ECR/Pt. Deen Dayal Upadhyaya PR/0494/Plant Depot, DDUM/MECH/7/26-27/32

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

On Line Single Bid based open E- Tenders are invited by Sr. DME/ En/HM,Frt & DM/LJN N.E. Railway/ Lucknow for and on behalf of the President of India for the following works.

Tender Notice No. & Description of works: 02-2026-Mech-FRT-DM "Supply, Erection, Installation & Commissioning' of Shower Testing arrangement with shed as per RDSO Drg. WD-04007-S-01 (Integrated with a water recycling system) on turnkey basis at ROH Depot/Gonda, including material supply' Approx. Value (In Rs.): ₹ 34,81,000/- including GST, E.M.D. Money (In Rs.) ₹ 69,600/-, Contract period - 8 months.

E-Tender can be uploaded by tenderer, up to 15:00 on 27/07/2026 and will be opened after 15:00 hrs on 27/07/2026. Detailed information, minimum eligibility criteria, Terms and conditions regarding this e-tender are available at website www.ireps.gov.in. Tenderer should check any correction/corrigendum related to this e-tender notice on web site before uploading their offer.

Sr.DME/EnHM, Frt&DM/LJN CPRO/Mach-49 Lucknow

Never travel on roof and foot boards

ICAR Indian Veterinary Research Institute

Izzatnagar, Bareilly, 243122 | Tel:-91-581-2300096

Walk-in-Interview

Advertisement for the post of Junior Research Fellow (JRF)

Applications are invited from the eligible Indian citizens for engagement of one Junior Research Fellow (JRF) under CCRH sponsored project at Division of Medicine, ICAR-Indian Veterinary Research Institute, Izatnagar, Bareilly, (U.P.)

For detailed advertisement, eligibility criteria, application format, date and venue of Walk in Interview and other instructions, please visit IVRJ job portal <https://www.ivrj.nic.in/otherpages/newjobs.aspx> or visit the Institute website: <https://www.ivrj.nic.in>

UJVN Limited

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprises)

H.O. "UJJAWAL" Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dehradun-248006
Telephone: 0135 - 2763808, Fax: 0135 - 2763508
CIN No U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website: www.ujvnl.uk.gov.in

पत्र सं० 552 दिनांक: 04/07/2026

E-Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer (C&M) MB-II Joshiyara, Uttarkashi invites sealed and separate online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

Tender No.: 07/EE(C&M)/MB-II/Joshiyara/2026-27.

Name of works: Repair of damaged CC road from Nigam office to Forebay along with Protection works for Nishan Shed at Joshiyara Barrage, MB-II, Uttarkashi.

Estimated cost: Rs.24,22,679.00 (Excluding GST).

Date of availability of bid document on website: 11:00 AM of 07.07.2026

Last Date for submission of bid on website : 27.07.2026 Up to 05:00 PM

For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal <http://uktenders.gov.in> and our website "ujvnl.uk.gov.in"

Executive Engineer (C&M) MB-II Joshiyara

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER NATIONAL HIGHWAY DIVISION, RANCHI

Din Dayal Nagar, Booty Road, Ranchi - 834008

CORRIGENDUM OF TENDER

This is to notify the concerned that the tender published in news paper by PR 383618 Road(26-27).D for the work " Maintenance of road from Km.39.100 to Km.85.560 of NH-143AG for year 2026-27 in the State of Jharkhand under SR " is being amended, which as follows:

S.No	Particulars	Published in news paper	As amended
1.	Tender Reference No.	NH/RANCHI/EPC /2026-27/01	NH/RANCHI/SBD /2026-27/01
2	Bid Security	21,40,000.00	42,79,000.00

Executive Engineer
National Highway Division,
Ranchi

PR 384050 Road(26-27)D

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F), email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice
Rule No. 712/191

SP City South, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Rakesh Kumar S/O Mulkh Raj R/O Village Gharana, R.S. Pura, Jammu is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 253/2020 U/S 379 IPC of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu, since the commission of crime. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments/Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts/ present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact/Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name :- Rakesh Kumar
S/O :- Mulkh Raj
Address:- Village Gharana, R.S. Pura, Jammu

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

- DPO, Jammu :- 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
- SSP Jammu Mail LD : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
- PCR Jammu :- 0191-2605949
- SP City South :- 0191-2433778
- SDPO City East :- 01912474700
- P/S Bahu Fort:- 0191-2475133

For Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu

No. DIP/J-5027/26 – DATE:- 04 JULY 2026

Date:- .07.2026

CHOLAMANDALAM INVESTMENT AND FINANCE COMPANY LIMITED

Corporate Office: "CHOLA CREST", C54 & 55, Super B-4, Thiru.Vi.Ka Industrial Estate, Guindy, Chennai - 600 032.

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES

E-Auction Sale Notice for the Sale of Immovable Assets under Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, r/w Rule 8(6) & 9(1) of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002, (Rule 8 & 9)

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower / Co-Borrower/ Mortgagee (s) that the below described immovable properties mortgaged to the Secured Creditor, the Physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of Cholamandalam Investment and Finance Company Limited the same shall be referred herein after as Cholamandalam investment and Finance Company Limited. The Secured Assets will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is", and "Whatever there is" basis through E-Auction.

It is hereby informed to General public that we are going to conduct public E-Auction through website <https://bankauctions.in>

Loan Account Nos. TL01NDL0000062239, Name of Borrower, Co-Borrower, Mortgagees: 1. M/s. I.M.S (Institute of Mathematical Science), (Borrower), 1st Floor, No. 25/8, Old Rajender Nagar, Central Delhi - 110 060. 2. Mr. Kore Venkataiah, (Co Borrower), 3. Mrs. Ara Sridevi, (Co Borrower), Sl.No.2 & 3 Residing at: No. 453-454, Ground Floor, Double Storey, New Rajender Nagar, Central Delhi - 110 060. 4. M/s. K. Venkanna Education Services, (Co Borrower), Ground Floor, House No. 12-13-354, Tamaka, Secunderabad, Hyderabad, Telangana - 500 017. Also at: No. 1-10-237, 2nd Floor, Room No. 12, R K S Kanchams Blue Sapphire, Ashok Nagar, Hyderabad, Telangana - 500 020. Outstanding Amount: Rs.4,20,33,217/- as on 30.06.2026

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY [Secured Asset]:

Item No. 1: All that piece and parcels of the Entire Ground Floor without roof/terrace rights, build up Property Bearing No.453-454, area measuring 123.66 Sq. Yards, Situated at New Rajinder Nagar, New Delhi - 110060.

Item No. 2: All that piece and parcels of the Entire Ground Floor without roof/terrace rights, build up Property Bearing No.455-456, area measuring 123.66 Sq. Yards, Situated at New Rajinder Nagar, New Delhi - 110060.

Reserve Price : Rs. 4,73,40,000/-, EMD : Rs. 47,34,000/-, Bid Increment Amount : Rs.1,00,000/-

E-Auction Date and Time : 21.07.2026 – 11 AM to 12 Noon (with unlimited extension of 3 min each)
Last Date of Submission of EMD : 20.07.2026, Date of Inspection of Property : As per the appointment

- All Interested participants / bidders are requested to visit the website <https://bankauctions.in> & www.foreclosureindia.com. For details: help, procedure and online training on e-auction, prospective bidders may contact M/s/ A Closure, (Contact Person: Mr. Shailendra, Ph. No. 9515160061, Email: shailendra@bankauctions.in).
- For further details on terms and conditions please visit- <https://bankauctions.in> & <https://cholamandalam.com/news/auction-notices> to take part in e-auction or contact Mr. Ved Prakash Mishra - 9910144252 / Mr. Naveen Kapoor – Ph: 77550 01547 / Mr. Kapil Sharma – Ph: 9205308879.

THIS IS ALSO A STATUTORY 15 DAYS SALE NOTICE UNDER RULE 8(6) & 9(1) AND OF SECURITY INTEREST (ENFORCEMENT) RULES,2002 (Rule 8 & 9)

Date: 05.07.2026 **Authorized Officer**
Place: Delhi Cholamandalam investment and Finance Company Limited.

OFFICE OF SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER AGRA CIRCLE, P.W.D AGRA

Notice inviting E-Tender

Letter No. : 3732 /I4M-A.C/2026-27 Date : 29.06.2026

1. The Superintending Engineer Agra Circle, U.P.P.W.D. on behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh invites the percentage rate bids online from the eligible and approved registered Contractors. As The work Comprises of specialized Building work, hence contractors bidding for this work must be registered in Building work with UP PWD. Bidders are advised to note the minimum qualification criteria specified in Clause 4 of the Instructions to Bidders to qualify for the award of the contract.

2.

Sl. No	District	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs. in Lac)	Bid Security (Rs. in Lacs)	Cost of Document (in Rs.)	Time of Completion	Address of Executive Engineer executing the work	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer	Category of Contractor
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
1	Mathura	Construction work of 03 room in KR Degree college in District Mathura	39.00	3.90	Rs. 2000.00STC +300.00TC+ 60.00GST = 2360.00	06 Months (including Rainy Season)	Executive Engineer, Provincial Division, P.W.D., Mathura	Superintending Engineer, P.W.D., Agra	Chief Engineer, Agra Zone, P.W.D., Agra	Class A, B,C

BRIDGE

When there are a multiple ways of going about the business of fulfilling the contract, declarer has to fall back on percentages to help him out. Declarer can always depend on his table presence to decide his final course of action. Dealer: South Vulnerable: None

NORTH		SOUTH	
♠ K J 8 5 4 3		♠ A Q 10 6 2	
♥ A Q 10		♥ 9 4 3 2	
♦ A		♦ 5	
♣ 6 3 2		♣ A K J	
SOUTH	WEST	NORTH	EAST
1♣	pass	3♥	pass
4♥	pass	4♣	pass
6♥	pass	3♣	pass

West leads the four of diamonds. Plan the play. There are three possibilities after drawing trumps. South can: (A) play on clubs before touching hearts. If he avoids a club loser, the contract is certain-South strips clubs and finesse a heart into East, who is end played. If the clubs finesse loses, South falls back on the double finesse in hearts. Alternatively, South can play hearts before clubs. In this case he can (B-1) lead a heart to the queen, or (B-2) lead a heart to the ten. In either case, if this finesse loses and a club comes back South goes up with the ace, tries hearts again, and finds out whether or not a club finesse is necessary. Plan (A) has a bit more than a 60% chance. It succeeds when clubs come in (a smidgin over 50%) plus somewhat under 25% of the remainder. But plan (B-2) is superior to (A) if it succeeds whenever West has one, two or three hearts to one or both honours, or six hearts, or four or five hearts with both honours, plus roughly half the time (when the club finesse works) if West has four or five hearts with one honour. This all adds up to more than 70%.

THE WEST HAND ♠ 9 ♥ K 8 6 5 ♦ Q 10 7 4 2 ♣ 9 8 4
THE EAST HAND ♠ 7 ♥ J 7 ♦ K J 9 8 6 3 ♣ Q 10 7 5

Plan (B-1) finessing the heart queen - is better still. It gains over (b-2) when East has the singleton heart jack, and never loses the contract when (B-2) would have made it. Technically, if the finesse of the heart queen wins, the percentage play is to return to the South hand and lead a heart to the ten- it is more likely that West has K-J-X-X (6 combinations) than K-x-x-x (4 combinations), and West might have five hearts. But when declarer leads a heart towards dummy the second time, he many learn from the "table action" whether West has both honours, and decide to play for the doubleton jack offside. See how you fare with this small slam.

NORTH		SOUTH	
♠ 6 4 2		♠ A Q 3	
♥ 8 6 2		♥ K Q J	
♦ K 9 4		♦ A 3 2	
♣ K J 10 9		♣ A 7 4 2	
SOUTH	WEST	NORTH	EAST
2C♣	pass	2NT	pass
3S♥	pass	3NT	pass
4D♦	pass	4S♥	4D♦
6S♠	pass	pass	pass

West leads the ten of clubs. Plan the play.

• SUNDAY CROSSWORD

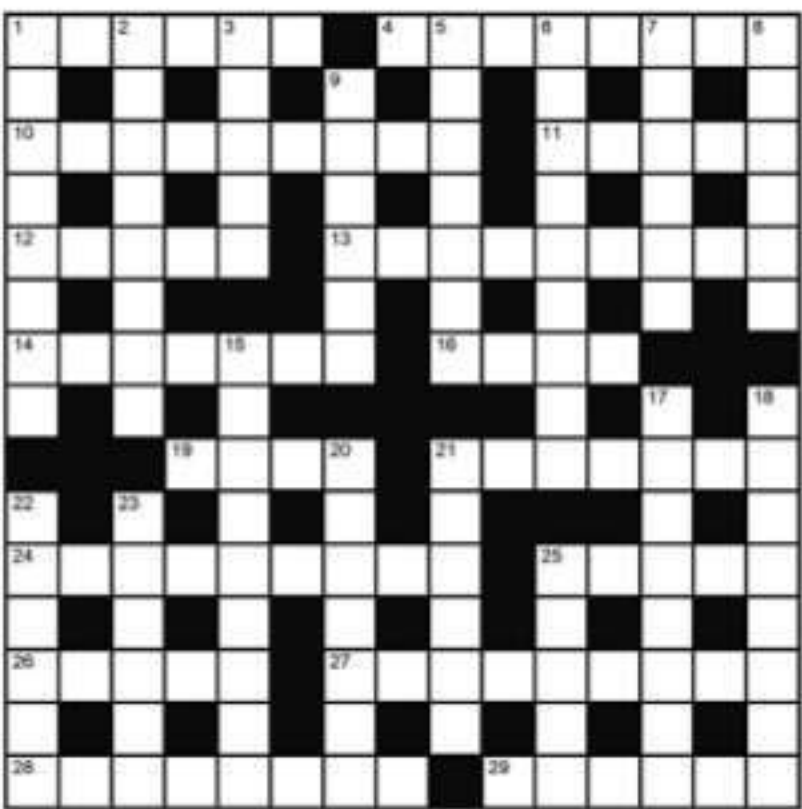
QUICK CLUES

ACROSS

- Occur (6)
- Newspaper printings (8)
- Endangers (9)
- Made over (5)
- Debris (5)
- Book of synonyms (9)
- Took a wager (7)
- South Indian dialect (4)
- Muslim leader (4)
- Keep hidden (7)
- Artificial language (9)
- Small fruit (5)
- Enjoyed (5)
- End of a chess game (9)
- Overcame (8)
- Extensions (6)

DOWN

- Bowling feat (3-5)
- Biased (8)
- Tests or examinations in brief (5)
- Ancestry (7)
- Canvas cover (9)
- Commands (6)
- Extreme cruelty (6)
- Defeated, got the better of (6)
- University city in England (9)
- A long time back? (5,3)
- Small enclosures used for an infant's recreational time (8)
- Single eye-glass (7)
- Duplicated (6)



- Fine parchment (6)
- Sharp steel instruments (6)
- Cooked in oven (5)

CRYPTIC CLUES

ACROSS

- Willing to submit something fishy turning up might be a lie (6)
- They obstruct gunners in boats (8)
- US infantryman swallows a licentious Italian rebel (9)
- In the old city, enterprise starts to have effect (5)
- Hellish center for immigration? (5)
- For no reward, he drew young children (4,5)

SOLUTIONS TO 2588 QUICK CLUES ACROSS: 1 Kannada, 5 Blesses, 9 Karma, 10 Chieftain, 11 Plaything, 12 Layer, 13 Sigh, 15 Aravalli, 18 Ayurveda, 19 Expo, 22 Asset, 24 Upholding, 26 Columnist, 27 Organ, 28 Modesty, 29 Cheaply
DOWN: 1 Kakapo, 2 Normality, 3 Await, 4 Acclimate, 5 Bring, 6 Exfoliate, 7 Snaky, 8 Sentry, 14 Hard times, 16 Apathetic, 17 Lapping up, 20 Talcum, 21 Agency, 23 Salad, 24 Unify, 25 Loose
CRYPTIC CLUES ACROSS: 1 Lowland, 5 Backs up, 9 Xylem, 10 Abolition, 11 Sheer legs, 12 Anale, 13 Mobs, 15 Insuring, 18 Strength, 19 Cops, 22 Until, 24 Page three, 26 Fettucini, 27 Eat in, 28 Whittle, 29 Exposed
DOWN: 1 Laxest, 2 Walked out, 3 Armer, 4 Deafening, 5 Blows, 6 Chivalric, 7 Spire, 8 Ponder, 14 Shellsuit, 16 Soho guide, 17 Nephrites, 20 Curfew, 21 Penned, 23 Tutsi, 24 Price, 25 Tie up

2589

IF IT'S YOUR BIRTHDAY

SUNDAY JULY 5: This is a year of work and construction. Build foundations externally and internally. Physical exercise will play an important role. Stay grounded and levelheaded.

MONDAY JULY 6: This is a year of exciting changes and increased personal freedom. Let go of whatever impedes your growth. Seek out new opportunities. Trust your intuition. Expect to travel.

TUESDAY JULY 7: This is a year of service, perhaps service to family. Take care of yourself so you can be a resource to those who turn to you for comfort and courage.

WEDNESDAY JULY 8: This is a year of learning and teaching. Take time to renew your spiritual or religious beliefs. Explore philosophies that give you a better self-awareness.

THURSDAY JULY 9: This year you will reap the benefits of all your hard work. Expect power and leadership. Acknowledgement from others, promotions and the spotlight will shine on you.

FRIDAY JULY 10: This is the last year of a nine-year cycle, take inventory. Let go of the people, places and things from the past. Do some internal and external housecleaning.

SATURDAY JULY 11: This is a year of new beginnings, adventures and major changes. Keep your eyes open for new opportunities. Be ready to take action. Prepare

• YOUR WEEK AHEAD

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): You'll speak up when talking to others today because you're eager to go after what you want. Furthermore, you will be able to keep up the pace and persevere for a long time. This Week: Plan for 12 months of fun and creativity.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): This is a wonderful day to accomplish whatever you want. You work hard for money. It's important to know that if you work for the benefit of others as well as yourself. This Week: Start to improve your home or find a better one.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Today you might see ways to transform yourself into a better version of yourself. You will benefit more if you help others as well. This Week: Your sense of optimism is growing and will continue to grow.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): Today the Sun in your sign is dancing beautifully with the Moon, while Mars has a lovely alignment with Pluto. This means you can do what you want. Choose the highest good. This Week: You'll get richer in the next 12 months.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): You might make some effective changes in the world around you by working with others. Ideally, this new result will benefit you as well as others. This Week: The next 12 months are great fortune for you!

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): This is an excellent day to define some long-term objectives for the future. Think about goals that benefit you as well as others. This Week: Your spiritual world will deepen.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Tread carefully in discussions about politics, religion or racial issues, because you have strong opinions today, you feel the need to let others know what you think. Be prepared to listen to others as well. This Week: Your popularity will increase in the next year.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Creative ideas might lead to new ways of using shared funding, shared property or something that someone else earns. This is because today you want to improve something or make it better. This Week: You look like a winner the next 12 month.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): You will attract someone today who is persuasive. If you like what they have to say, you will enjoy this. Stand your ground if someone is determined to change your mind or sway your opinions. This Week: Explore travel and education in the year ahead.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): You can get a tremendous amount done today with whatever task you choose because you have energy and perseverance. You won't stop until you finish what you want to achieve. This Week: Financial or practical benefits from others.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): This is a powerful day for those in sports because you have energy and perseverance. Some of you might even be motivated by money. This Week: The next 12 months are a great time to get married.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): This is a marvelous day to chat and enjoy the company of others. However, it's also a great day to make improvements at home or perhaps to help a family member in a way that is meaningful. Do what you can. This Week: You can improve your job or get a better job this year and next.

JUMBLED WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip.

Some have been thought brave because they were afraid to _____.
- Thomas Fuller (3,4)

NRSAA

OSTNR

DGHOUY

EEPRTW

Some have been thought brave because they were afraid to _____.

ANSWERS: Saran, Short, Doughty, Fewter

DIFFICULTY LEVEL 5s

INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL

1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6370

	3			7				9
9			3					
	4		5	6				
4	5	9						
	8		2		4			
				5		1	8	
	9		8	1				
			1					6
2		6				4		

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6369

8	6	5	9	1	7	4	3	2
4	2	9	6	8	3	5	1	7
7	1	3	4	5	2	9	6	8
6	3	4	1	7	5	8	2	9
5	9	2	3	6	8	7	4	1
1	8	7	2	4	9	6	5	3
3	5	1	8	9	6	2	7	4
9	4	6	7	2	1	3	8	5
2	7	8	5	3	4	1	9	6

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Prabhjot Singh S/o Sh. Guman Singh R/o B-16, KH No. 28/22, Gali No. 06, Himgiri Enclave, Nilothi West Nangloi, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide FIR No. 239/2023 U/S 279/338 IPC, **PS Tilak Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Prabhjot Singh** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Prabhjot Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Prabhjot Singh of FIR No. 239/2023 U/S 279/338 IPC, PS Tilak Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **06.08.2026**

By Order,
Sh. Vikas Madaan
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07(West)
2nd Floor, Room No. 289
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/9155/WD/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Manish @ Mannu, S/o: Gyan Chand R/o: 18/38 Old Govind Pura, Delhi PS Jagat Puri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 509/24, U/s: 304(2) 317 (2) PS: Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Manish @ Mannu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Manish @ Mannu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Manish @ Mannu of FIR No. 509/24, U/s: 304(2) 317 (2) PS: Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.08.2026**.

By Order
Amardeep Kaur
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate (North)/ Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/9057/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

कार्यालय अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, संभाग, अजमेर

क्रमांक:- अमुअ / अडा./वक./एफ-2(30ए) निविदा/डी-899 दिनांक:- 24.06.2026

निविदा सूचना संख्या 11 वर्ष 2026-2027

राजस्थान के राज्यपाल महोदय की ओर से पोर्ट क्वालिफिकेशन पद्धति के अनुसार सड़क कार्यों के लिए रजिस्ट्रार जेमि में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, राजस्थान में पंजीकृत अथवा राज्य सरकार के अन्य विभागों / केन्द्र सरकार के अधीकृत संस्थानों / केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग / डाक एगम्स दूर संचार विभाग / रेल्वे इत्यादि में पंजीकृत एवं जेमि के संवेदकों से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में ई-प्रोक्युरमेंट प्रक्रिया के माध्यम से ऑन लाईन निविदा प्राप्त की जावेगी। ई-निविदा से संबंधित विवरण वेबसाइट <http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in> एवं <http://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है।

NIB No.-: PWD 2627A1369
UBN No.-: PWD2627W1LOB05821,
PWD2627W1LOB05822,
PWD2627W1LOB05823,
PWD2627W1LOB05825.
DIPR/C/11513/2026

हस्ता./-
अतिरिक्त मुख्य अभियन्ता,
सा.नि.वि., संभाग, अजमेर।

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, ग्रामीण वृत्त-जयपुर

पी.डब्ल्यू.डी. कैम्पस, जैकब रोड, जयपुर क्लब के सामने, जयपुर

E-mail:- seuralaijaipur@gmail.com/cejprur.pwd@rajjasthan.gov.in, फोन :- 0141-2223527

क्रमांक 1849-57 निविदा सूचना संख्या-06/2026-27 दिनांक:- 16/6/26

जयपुर जिले में 08 कार्य के निर्माण कार्यों हेतु इच्छुक निविदादाताओं द्वारा दिनांक 13.07.2026 सयं 06.00 बजे तक निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। निविदा से संबंधित अन्य विवरण राज्य की उपपान पोर्टल (<http://eproc.rajjasthan.gov.in>, <http://sppp.rajjasthan.gov.in> एवं विभागिय वेबसाइट <http://pwd.rajjasthan.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकते हैं। उपपान की अनुमति लागत रयत 2968.80 लाख है।

PWD2627WSOB05304, PWD2627WSOB05305
PWD2627WSOB05306, PWD2627W1LOB05309
PWD2627WSOB05572, PWD2627WSOB05573
PWD2627WSOB05574, PWD2627WSOB05575

हस्ता./-
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
सा.नि.वि. ग्रामीण वृत्त-जयपुर

DIPR/C/11444/2026

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

OPEN TENDER NOTICE NO. MC-ARALAUNDRY-26-27.

The Divisional Railway Manager, E.C. Railway, Danapur is inviting online open tender (on IREPS Portal) for and on behalf of the President of India from reputed contractor with experience, financial capability including those registered/working with Railway/Irrigation/CPWD/MES or any other public sector undertaking for under mentioned works :-

1. Name of work with its location : Setting up of Mechanized Departmental Laundry of Capacity 03 Ton Per shift at Ara Depot. 2. Approx cost of the work : ₹.23,18,452.53/- (Four crore twenty three lakh eighteen thousand four hundred fifty two and paisa fifty three only). 3. Earnest money to be deposited : ₹.86,400.00 (Rs. Eight lakh forty six thousand four hundred Only). 4. Date & Time for submission of tender and opening of tender : Date & Time for submission of tender- 27.07.2026 up to 12:00 hrs on www.ireps.gov.in. Date & Time of opening of tender- 27.07.2026 at 12:30 hrs on www.ireps.gov.in. 5. Website particulars & Notice Board location where complete details of tender, corrigendum (if any) can be seen etc. : The tender notice is available on website www.ireps.gov.in.

Divisional Railway Manager (Mech./ ECR/Danapur PR/0508/DNR/Mech./T/26-27/44

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER
Construction Circle,
U.P. JAL NIGAM (URBAN)
Jhansi
E-mail-seurbanjhsircircle@gmail.com

Letter No. 944/F-03/123
Dated: 03.07.2026

E-Tender Notice

Online percentage rate e-tender in Two Bid system under S.B.M.(U)-2.0 Programme are hereby invited on behalf of the Chairman, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) for Investigation and survey (on GIS basis) of the project area including soil investigation, Engineering Design (hydraulic and structural) as required, Procurement of all labour & material, T&P etc. and construction of various components complete for "Used Water Management (WSP) For Nagar Panchayat Badagaon Distt. Jhansi", U.P., India on Turnkey Basis., from eligible, reputed and experienced bidder. E-bid documents will be available for download from 10.07.2026 by 17:00 Hrs. E-bids can be submitted till 03.08.2026 up to 17:00 Hrs. and technical bid shall be opened on 03.08.2026 at 17:30 Hrs. In Office of The Superintending Engineer, Construction Circle, U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban), Jhansi in presence of contractor or their authorized representative, E-tender Cost is Rs 10000.00 + GST @ 18% for tender. Details are available on U.P.Govt. e-procurement portal <http://etender.up.nic.in> & U.P. Jal Nigam (Urban) website www.jn.uspsc.gov.in.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Deepak @ Mossam @ Lucky S/o Raman Singh R/o H. No. A-1/746, JJ Colony Madanpur Khadar, Kalindi Kunj, New Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 611/2021 U/s 356/379/411 IPC, P.S. Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Deepak @ Mossam @ Lucky** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Deepak @ Mossam @ Lucky** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Deepak @ Mossam @ Lucky** of case **FIR No. 611/2021 U/s 356/379/411 IPC, P.S. Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **07.08.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Akansha Gautam
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
South East, Room No. 513
Saket Court Complex, Delhi

DP/9074/SE/2026 (Court Matter)

BENGALURU SOUTH CITY CORPORATION

Office of the Executive Engineer, BTM Layout Division,
GBA Commercial Complex, 2nd Floor, Laskar Hosur Road,
Adugodi, Bengaluru-30

ಸಂಖ್ಯೆ : ಕ.ಪಾ.ಆ(ಬಿ.ಟಿ.ಎಂ)/ಕೆ.ಒ.ಒ/05/2026-27 ದಿನಾಂಕ : 04.07.2026

Corrigendum

Sub: Extension of date of tender works schedule The tender notification No. EE/BTM/KPPP/05/2026-27 dated 11.06.2026 published from this office, the date of tender works schedule have been extended as below due to some technical problems. 1). The last date for submission of tender dated 25.06.2026 upto 4.00 PM has now extended to 13.07.2026 upto 4.00 P.M. 2). Pre bid meeting will be held on Dt: 08-07-2026 at 15:00 hours in the office of The Chief Engineer Bommanhalli South Zone-2, Bengaluru South City Corporation, Begur Main Road, Bengaluru-560068. 3). The date of opening of tender : 29.06.2026 at 11.30 AM has now extended to 14.07.2026 at 4.30 PM. There were no other changes in the original tender

Sd/-
Executive Engineer, BTM Division, BSCC

उत्तराखण्ड पावर कॉर्पोरेशन लिमिटेड
(उत्तराखण्ड सरकार का उपक्रम)

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, विद्युत वितरण विभाग (ग्रामीण) 18 ई.पी.सी. रोड, देहरादून
दूरभाष: +91-135-2653601

“ई-निविदा सूचना”

अधोहस्ताक्षरकर्ता द्वारा अनुमोदी/प्रतिष्ठित तथा उत्तराखण्ड शासन द्वारा विद्युत अधिष्ठापन कार्य के लिए अधिकृत 'ए' क्लास लाइसेंसधारी ठेकेदार जो ईस्कम टेक्स, उत्तराखण्ड जीएसएनटीई, ईएनपीएफए तथा ईएसआई में पंजीकृत हों से निम्न निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

1. ई-निविदा संख्या- 37/EDCRDDUN/2026-27
2. ई-निविदा संख्या- 38/EDCRDDUN/2026-27
3. ई-निविदा संख्या- 39/EDCRDDUN/2026-27

उपरोक्त निविदाओं की अधिक जानकारी हेतु वेबसाइट www.uktenders.gov.in पर देखें।

“विद्युत बिलों के 24x7 ऑनलाईन भुगतान हेतु www.upcl.org पर जायें”

पत्रांक: 2384 / विडिओ ग्राहक सेवा/उपकारिता दिनांक: 03/07/2026 अधीक्षण अभियन्ता
“राष्ट्र हित में विजली बढ़ाये” टोल फ्री नं० 1800-419-0405

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER
MEGALIFT, BHUBANESWAR

Plot No.-A-8/2, 1st Floor, Bhui Nagar, Bhubaneswar-751022 (Odisha)

पञ्चायत कार्यपालिका, वृद्ध भू नगर, भुवनेश्वर, ओडिशा

फोन नं.- 91-674-2567252, Fax No.- 91-674-2567258

E-mail- cempwr.od@gmail.com, Dated. 22.6.2026

Tender Cancellation Notice

Bid Identification No.11ML/2024-25

The tender for the work "Execution of 04 nos. of Lift Irrigation Schemes with intake points on Surubali jore (Surubali jore ISS), Harihar jore (Harihar jore ISS), Mahanadi River (Near Godhoneswar ISS/ ISS Kapsara) having Command area between 500Ha. to 2000 Ha. in Cluster No. XXIX in the district of Sonepur including its distribution network, up to 1 Ha Chak having total planned Culturable Command Area of 6,710Ha. on "EPC -Turn Key" basis including power system connectivity and Operation & Maintenance of complete commissioned schemes for 15 years" invited vide Bid Identification No. 11ML/2024-25 is hereby cancelled in accordance with Letter No. 18264 dt. 18.06.2024 of DoWR.

Sd/-
Chief Engineer
Megalift
Bhubaneswar

OIPR-32001/32478/1/26-27/0003

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Mohit @ Sitta S/o Daya Nand R/o H. No. 139, Village Bakkarwala, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case **FIR No. 202/23 dated 02/08/23 u/s 25 Arms Act & 174A IPC** at **PS Special Cell, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Mohit @ Sitta** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Mohit @ Sitta** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mohit @ Sitta** accused of **FIR No. 202/23 dated 02/08/23 u/s 25 Arms Act & 174A IPC** at **PS Special Cell, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **10.08.2026**.

By Order: Sh. Mridul Gupta,
Chief Judicial Magistrate,
Court No.26, G.F., Annexe Building,
Patiala House Court, New Delhi

DP/9113/Spl. Cell/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Imran Beg S/o Islam Beg R/o 112, Samana Hapur, Dhaulana, Ghaziabad (U.P.)** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **CC No. 1598/24 u/s 138 NI Act** at **P.S. Paharganj, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Imran Beg** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Imran Beg** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr.P.C has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Imran Beg** accused of **CC No. 1598/24 u/s 138 NI Act** at **P.S. Paharganj, New Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on **20.08.2026**.

By Order: Sh. Arjun Kirar,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (NI Act)
Court No. 02, CBA-I,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/8993/CD/2026

● RESULTS
ROUND OF 32
Australia 1 (2)-1 (4) Egypt (AET: 1-1, decided by penalties)
Dallas Stadium
Argentina (AET) 3-2 Cape Verde
Miami Stadium
Colombia 1-0 Ghana
Kansas City Stadium
● MATCH SCHEDULE
ROUND OF 16
Brazil vs Norway
East Rutherford, 1.30 am
(Monday)
Mexico vs England
Mexico City, 5.30 am
(Monday)
ZEE5 OTT & UNITE8 CHANNELS



Colombia's Jhon Arias. AP

Arias powers Colombia past Ghana into last 16

JHON ARIAS scored off a sharp cross from Luis Suarez in the opening minutes, and Colombia controlled Ghana on a sweltering night at Arrowhead Stadium, allowing Los Cafeteros to advance to the Round of 16 at the World Cup with a 1-0 victory. Colombia will play Switzerland on Tuesday in Vancouver, British Columbia, for a spot in the quarter-finals. AP

Klopp in talks to become next Germany coach

JURGEN KLOPP has confirmed that Germany's football federation has been in touch with him to take over as the national team's new head coach after their Round of 32 exit. Julian Nagelsmann, who had been leading the team since 2023, stepped down as coach after their loss to Paraguay on penalties. Klopp hasn't been seen in management since announcing his departure from Liverpool in 2024. "About two years ago I stopped at Liverpool and said that I lacked the energy for another year with Liverpool. Since then I'm more than recharged, I'm ready," he said. ENS

“ This is part of growing. This helps us grow, and also shows that the team has a soul. ”

PEDRO BRITO, CAPE VERDE



Lionel Messi celebrates Argentina's 3-2 extra-time win even as Cape Verde's Lopes Cabral covers his face in disappointment in Miami. AP

Cabral, hero without a Cape

Cape Verde's wondergoal was struck by a player who was racially abused online, earned £850 a month while playing

Sriram Veera
Mumbai, July 4

HE CUT inside from the left, opened his body, and curled it into the far top corner. Cape Verde 2, Argentina 2, in the 103rd minute of a tie bookmakers had given Cape Verde as little as a 4 percent chance of winning outright. Sidney Lopes Cabral had just scored the greatest goal in Cape Verdean football history. He didn't stay to admire it, running straight into the crowd to find his girlfriend before turning back for the pitch. Argentina won it in extra time, 3-2, in a match that never once behaved like a mismatch. But long after the scoreline fades, people will remember the goal, and that run into the stands.

Two players stood at either end of that Cape Verde back line, and between them they told the whole story of what this team is. Cabral is 23, born in Rotterdam, one of seven squad members born in the Dutch city, more than those born in the island nation's own capital, Praia. His parents left Santiago for the Netherlands at seventeen and met there.

At the other end stood Vozinha, 40, who spent the tour-

namment saving shots from Messi and Spain and became a global name doing it. His contract with Chaves, in Portugal's second division, expired on June 1. He walked out of Hard Rock Stadium with no club to return to, weeks after his teammate's value had risen by ten million euros in a move to Trabzonspor. Cape Verde does not offer its players one story. It offers several, side by side, on the same pitch.

Cabral's version nearly didn't survive its early chapters. The football started at Twente's academy, then Helsingborg in Sweden, before a signing that looked like the end of something rather than the start: Rot-Weiss Erfurt, Germany's fifth tier, in February 2022.

"There was nothing at the club," he told Maisfutebol. "It was shorts, a thermal shirt, and a rain cape. Nothing else. We trained on a small artificial pitch, very hard. It was a real battle."

He earned the equivalent of £850 a month there, using bin bags as curtains and training in shorts through a cold German winter. Erfurt won promotion. Viktoria Köln came next, then Portugal, where he joined Es-



Sidny Cabral celebrates after scoring Cape Verde's second goal in extra time to level scores at 2-2. AP

trela da Amadora and then Benfica. "My career is a crazy story," he told *A Bola* after signing. "I'm proud I never gave up and always believed in myself. When I was on the bench in Germany's fifth division, I never imagined I'd reach Benfica."

In June, Benfica sold him to Trabzonspor for ten million euros, weeks before this World Cup. He was racially abused by fans during matches in Germany. It happened again, differently, months later at Benfica. After teammate Gianluca Prestianni was accused by Real

Madrid's Vinicius Júnior of racially abusing him during the first leg, a charge UEFA provisionally suspended Prestianni over while it investigated, Cabral approached Vinicius after the return leg and asked to swap shirts, a gesture of admiration for a player he has long followed.

Vinicius agreed, pointing toward the tunnel, but the two never crossed paths again, and the swap never happened. Portuguese outlets including *A Bola*, *O Jogo*, and *Maisfutebol* reported Cabral had second thoughts, worried it would look like a betrayal of Prestianni amid the investigation, and cleared the matter up with Benfica's staff. It didn't spare him the backlash.

Supporters flooded his Instagram with hostile comments, some calling for him to leave the club, and Prestianni was seen liking a post criticising him. Cabral told *The Guardian* the messages had turned racist. "I had to turn off my phone," he said. "It's so sad."

None of Cabral's story explains how a nation this size got here at all. Cape Verde has a population of roughly 525,000, the smallest nation ever to reach a men's World Cup knockout stage, and had gone unbeaten through the group without winning a match to get here. Long before any of this seemed possible, Cabral had told his family: "I'm going to be a great football player, I'm gonna reach the top."

“ I'm proud I never gave up and always believed in myself. When I was on the bench in Germany's fifth division, I never imagined I'd reach Benfica. ”

SIDNY CABRAL
FULL BACK, CAPE VERDE

And I'm living in my dream now," he told *The Guardian*. Before facing the best player of his generation, he had already worked out how to hold the occasion at arm's length.

"If you're like, oh, it's Messi, you're gonna lose your mind," he said. After the final whistle, he was thinking of someone else entirely. "I'm going to swap my shirt with Otamendi," he told Brazilian outlet *Lance*. "He was my teammate until this season."

Portuguese-language coverage of the defeat found little room for grief.

Maisfutebol wrote there was no space that night for tears of sadness in Praia, Mindelo, Sal, or the diaspora scattered across the world, only tears of pride large enough to spill across the Atlantic. Cape Verde goes home from its first World Cup in the round of 32. Cabral's goal against Messi's Argentina stays.

“NOW EVERYBODY KNOWS WHERE CABO VERDE IS”

Players from a country looking like dots on the map, made a big impact at Cup before a heart-break exit.

‘Did it with dignity’: Cape Verde coach

Cape Verde coach Bubista felt huge pride in his team after they took three-times world champions Argentina to the wire. Former centre-half Bubista was the architect of the project and he thought the reaction to the loss by his players, most of whom do not play in elite leagues, showed how far they had come. "The feeling in the dressing room is one of sadness," he told reporters. "We're sad, of course, we're sad because we're leaving the competition and because we got so close, so close. Even though they are sad, the players were hugging each other, they were crying. This is part of growing. This helps us grow, and also shows that the team has a soul. I feel pride in my players, and what they did. They did it with dignity and courage," he added. REUTERS



Deroy Duarte (R) celebrates after scoring with his brother Laros during the Round of 32 match against Argentina. AP

Duarte brothers: Midfield engine

It could have been the greatest night for the Duarte family, but will now leave a bittersweet feeling. Brothers taking the field together in a FIFA World Cup game is a special occasion and it was no different for Cape Verde's Deroy and Laros Duarte against world champions Argentina in Miami on Friday. Raised by single mother Maria de Cruz, fate has not always given the Duartes an easy deal. Against Argentina, they produced performances which nearly orchestrated one of football's greatest upsets. Darius' equalizer brought Cape Verde back in the game after Lionel Messi's early strike, while Laros was the Blue Sharks' midfield conductor. "It feels like a dream," Maria was quoted by *dutchnews.nl* before the Round of 32 game. Courtesy her sons, Cape Verde were in dreamland for most part of the game. ENS

‘No coincidence they held Spain, Uruguay’

After Cape Verde gave Argentina an almighty scare before succumbing to an own goal to lose a tight Round of 32 match 3-2 in Extra Time, Lionel Messi was all praises for the World Cup debutants after the contest. After the match when he was taking photos with the Cape Verde players, an usually stoic Messi also cracked a joke that their opponents 'kicked the crap out of him during the match and were now asking for selfies and his jersey.' "They asked for my jersey, everything. On the field, they kick the crap out of me. It is no coincidence that this team had not lost to Spain or Uruguay," Messi, the top-scorer at this World Cup, was quoted as saying by *Tyc Sports*. ENS



They asked for my jersey, but on the field they kicked the c**p out of me: Messi jokingly said. AP

Henry praises valiant show

Cape Verde got applause following an incredible showing against the defending world champions Argentina and for pushing them to the limit. French Legend Thierry Henry was full of praise for the World Cup debutants, considering how this small nation exceeded every expectation at their first World Cup. "You know what's actually impressive? It is not so much on how they played and everything, which is impressive, but the number of people who live there," said Henry on *Fox Sports* post match show. Reflecting on the Cape Verdeans' performance against the South American giants, Henry added, "Make them know and let them know where you're from with how you perform. Now everybody knows where Cabo Verde is." ENS

{ P H A R O H S R I S E }

Salah gets emotional as Egypt win their first-ever knockout match

Prithraj
New Delhi, July 4

AT ONE end of the pitch, Mohamed Salah, who minutes earlier had sent Egypt through with a chipped Panenka down the middle, stood alone for a moment and applauded the crowd, tears in his eyes, before his teammates pulled him into a mob that would later place a Tutankhamun headdress on his head.

At the other end, Lucas Herrington turned his back on the crossbar that had just denied him, put one arm to his curly hair, and bent over to hide his face. At 18, he is the youngest starter Australia has ever fielded at a World Cup, and will now be remembered for the miss that sent Egypt through.

Egypt had just beaten Australia 4-2 on penalties to win a knockout match for the first time in a World Cup.

Before kickoff, Salah, 34, gathered his teammates in the tunnel. "I told the boys before the game, guys, this is the biggest game you could play in your life, so just enjoy it," he said afterward. He was not the only one in tears.

Manager Hossam Hassan cried too, and dedicated the win to a cause far from the pitch. "My heart and soul are with the



Mohamed Salah tears up after the win over Australia. AP

Palestinian people," he said. "I thank them and dedicate this victory to them. We succeeded in making Arab people proud."

The match that produced all this offered little of its own. Egypt led early: Emam Ashour's own free kick was blocked, the ball came back off Jackson Irvine, and Ashour, unmarked at the back post, headed it in. Omar Marmoush should have doubled the lead early in the second half but dragged a chance wide, and it cost Egypt when Aiden O'Neill's looping free kick found its way in off Mohammed Hany's head ten minutes later.

In the closing minutes of normal time Salah swept in a

cross for Rami Rabia that Patrick Beach somehow palmed over, then had a shot of his own blocked soon after. Marmoush set him up again in extra time, and this time Salah skied it over the bar.

Goalkeeper gamble

Australia's coach Tony Popovic made the gamble that would define the night. He withdrew Beach, who had been outstanding, and sent on his captain, Mat Ryan, purely for the shootout.

Ryan never got near a single kick. Souttar's opening effort sailed over the bar. Herrington, stepping up with more experi-

“ My heart and soul are with the Palestinian people. I thank them and dedicate this victory to them. ”

HOSSAM HASSAN
EGYPT MANAGER

enced teammates still on the pitch, side-footed his attempt too high, into the same crossbar that had already beaten Souttar.

Between those misses, Mahmoud Saber and Rami Rabia scored theirs for Egypt without fuss.

Then came Salah, stepping up to the third kick—a Panenka—with the chance to all but finish it. "Hossam Abdelmaguid took the fourth and last. He puffed out his cheeks, checked his stride, and rolled it to his right as Ryan dived the other way.

He ran to the corner and tore off his shirt before the rest of Egypt reached him.

Both teams had come to Dallas chasing the same thing, a first World Cup knockout win each had waited a lifetime for. The shootout only had room for one of them.

The various versions of the Panenka, and how it's magic when executed well

Nihal Koshie
New Delhi, July 4

IF ANTONIN PANENKA had his way, Mo Salah would have paid royalty to the former Czech midfielder, the inventor of the chip-shot penalty named after him. Panenka's original, the last of the five spot-kicks taken by Czechoslovakia, won his country the Euro 1976 title against West Germany. Panenka even tried to get his creation patented. But officials didn't entertain him, he said on the 50th anniversary of the deceptive spot-kick.

Plenty of high-quality Panenkas have come in crunch moments. Egypt won their first-ever knockout game at a FIFA World Cup, beating Australia 4-2 on penalties with Salah scoring the third one with a Panenka.

When Salah prepared to strike in the shootout after the game was tied 1-1 after extra time, he seemed to be going for a full-blooded shot into one of the corners.

The Liverpool legend took a few steps to his right and then ran in from a short distance at an angle. But instead of unleashing power, he chipped the ball with his left foot in the middle of the net, where Australian goalkeeper Mathew Ryan



Salah scores from the spot via a Panenka. AP

would have stood if he hadn't dived to his left.

Now, watch footage of the first Panenka. Antonin didn't amble in but ran in full speed from a few metres before chipping the ball towards the centre. "I wasn't 100 percent confident I would score. I was 1,000 percent confident," he told *The Guardian*.

It helped that in those days of limited TV footage, the Panenka was a novelty outside Czechoslovakia. And to think that he came up with it because of a bet during club practice sessions with the goalie. If the goalkeeper stopped one of the five shots, Panenka bought him beer and chocolates.

Pirlo's classic

Salah's kick, however, wasn't as floaty as Antonin's or Andrea Pirlo's chip.

the last second, when I saw Joe Hart, the England goalie, doing all sorts of things on his line," Pirlo says in the book.

Zinedine Zidane's Panenka for France in the seventh minute of the 2006 World Cup final against Italy was a way of exerting psychological pressure on the best goalie — Gianluigi Buffon. Unlike Salah's or Pirlo's, Zidane's Panenka wasn't straight but to the left of Buffon. He was fortunate that the ball landed inside the goal line after hitting crossbar.

Others have not been so lucky. Even Lionel Messi hit the crossbar in the Copa America quarterfinal against Ecuador two years ago. Recently, in the Africa Cup of Nations final, Morocco's Braham Diaz chipped the ball to Senegal goalkeeper Edouard Mendy. The moment would have been Diaz's cross-to-bear if the Confederation of African Football (CAF) had not overturned Senegal's 1-0 extra time win for their walkout protest during the match.

There is an element of risk in executing the Panenka. Miss the target with a full-blooded shot and detractors will put it down to nerves or misfortune. But both a Panenka and risk being labeled cheeky, clever by half or even selfish. But when it comes off, it's magical.



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EYE

JULY 5, 2026



SCREEN | PAGE 3
Feels like home
Former *Indian Idol* contestant Deepali Sahay on her song *Tere paas main* from *Main Vaapas Aunga* that is leaving listeners misty-eyed



POINT OF VIEW | PAGE 2
Chef Himanshu Saini's Michelin star leap

Mango on my map

The mango is not a fruit, it's an aroma, it's sticky elbows, summer and chaos and, when everything is forgotten, a memory that brings you home

Kishi Arora

EVERY MORNING this summer, I walk up to my terrace and count to three. Three Amrapali mangoes hang from a tree I planted the year my father died.

Earlier this year, it was covered in blossoms, the kind that make you pull out your phone and call your mother. Then, Delhi's storms arrived, as they always do, and took most of the flowers with them. Three survived. They are getting bigger and heavier by the day, which is how I know the wait is almost over.

He loved mangoes. When he passed away in 2018, we planted an Amrapali and a Harsingar over his ashes at the *dham* in Meerut that meant so much to him. Around the same time, almost without thinking, I planted the same two trees on my terrace in Delhi. One pair rooted in a place of memory. Another pair woven into my everyday life, mine to watch through every season, every storm, every June that came and left without giving me anything. This year, finally, the terrace Amrapali gave me fruit.

I keep doing the count.

He was from Muzaffarnagar, my mother is from Banaras, I grew up in Ghaziabad and landed in Delhi, and work eventually took me South and West and everywhere in between. Somewhere across all of it, without meaning to, I built a map. Not of highways or hill stations but of mangoes. Every place I have loved has one attached to it. Every person I have lost or kept close is somewhere in that list.

• • •

It was my father who introduced me to Rataul. Small, intensely fragrant, almost unreasonably flavourful for its size. Not as famous as Alphonso or Kesar but fiercely loved by those who know it. You soften it between your palms, make a small opening at the tip and drink it. No knife, no bowl, no ceremony. He ate it the way people eat things they grew up with: fast, without explaining it to anyone, as though stopping to admire it would ruin the whole thing. Every family has a food that makes a person immediately present. Rataul is mine for him. I cannot see one at a *mandi* without being, briefly and completely, back in a time when he was still here.

• • •

Banaras is my mother's side, which means it is where my *nani* and *nana* lived, and where some of my most stubborn memories were made.

Every summer, my *nana* would return home carrying boxes of Langra. Before anyone could touch them, the mangoes had to be soaked in buckets of water to cool. As children, we found this rule unreasonable. We would circle those buckets every 20 minutes, certain that collective impatience might somehow speed things along. It never did.

When they were finally declared ready — cool and sweet, fragrant and fibrous — the wait felt worth it. I am well into adulthood and the sight of a Langra still puts me right back in that house. The particular quality of afternoon light. The sound of water in a bucket. The specific restlessness of children who have been told to be patient and are choosing, deliberately, not to be.

• • •

Before Delhi,

there was Ghaziabad. Nearly a decade of it. Cousins, long summer holidays, mangoes at almost every meal.

Chausa was the favourite because there was simply no dignified way to eat it. Sticky hands, sticky chin, occasionally sticky elbows, all expected and entirely fine. Nobody thought to use a fork. Nobody wanted to. Chausa is probably the most honest mango. It doesn't pretend to be elegant and it doesn't need to be.

Safeda and Dasheri showed up differently at our house. Blended, chilled, poured into a tall glass by my mother, who makes one of the best mango shakes I have ever had. The moment you take a sip, a little mango moustache forms above your lip. We still laugh every time it happens, which tells you something about how often we still make it. I know I am biased about the shake itself. I do not think it changes the fact.

• • •

Panna in Madhya Pradesh has its own category in my memory. The religion my parents follow has its headquarters *dham* there and we made that journey often, outside of any holiday plan. After temple came *bhog*, then family time spread out over the afternoon, and then my father would lead us to his *pakorewala*.

His *pakorewala*. Not ours. His. He had found this man the way my father found most things he loved, quietly, without announcement, and then behaved as if everyone obviously already knew about him.

Because this was not your standard onion and potato situation, whatever the *sabziwala* had went into the batter. Pumpkin. Bitter melon. Drumstick leaves. Amaranth. Things that had no business being pakoras and yet, once fried, made complete sense. Between an open-minded father with strong opinions on flavour and a *pakodewala* willing to try anything, something genuinely good kept coming out of that oil.

And then there were the *aam ke pakode*.

Raw mango, light batter, hot oil. Crispy outside, the mango inside going soft and tangy and almost jammy from the heat. Sour and hot and a little sweet all at once. I have never found them anywhere else. The kind of dish that exists because two people, one with an idea and one with a *kadhui*, decided to just go for it.

I make them at home every season now. They are good but not the same.

• • •

Work later took me to Bengaluru and Mumbai, and both cities added their own stops to the map. The Bengaluru memory is a specific one. I was there setting up a bakery, deep in recipe development, the kind of work where your palate is tired and everything starts tasting like butter and sugar. In the middle of all of it, my client handed me a Badami mango. Just like that, no preamble. Karnataka's quieter answer to Alphonso and, in that moment, possibly the best thing I had eaten all trip. Badami did not need the contrast to taste good. It just did.

• • •

Kerala changed my understanding of what this fruit could do in a kitchen.

Until then, the only savoury mango I knew was my mother's cooking. Raw mango *sabzi*. Raw mango in kadhi. Stuffed into a paratha. All of it deeply familiar, all of it made from the raw fruit. The idea of cooking a ripe mango into something savoury had simply never occurred to me. Then I came across Mambazha Pulisery. Ripe mango with coconut, yogurt and spices. It sounded, frankly, like an act of chaos. Then, I tasted it. Sweet, tangy and oddly grounding, it made the kind of quiet sense that only dishes cooked for generations tend to make. It also showed me how narrow my picture of this fruit had been. Kerala alone has countless local varieties growing in backyards and homesteads, known within particular communities, unnamed on any national list. India's mango story is so much larger than the dozen varieties most of us can name from memory.

• • •

One discovery that has stayed very close: Jardalu from Bihar.

The fragrance stopped me the first time I tasted it. Some mangoes lead with sweetness, some with texture, some with a colour that makes a promise the flavour then keeps. Jardalu announces itself through scent alone. Before you have even taken a bite, something has already happened to you. I loved it enough to track down a grafted sapling for my terrace. It

1. WESTERN UTTAR PRADESH
RATAUL

Small, fiercely aromatic, a cult mango
2. MALIHABAD, UP
DASHERI

A North Indian summer staple
3. BANARAS AND EASTERN UP
LANGRA

Distinctive flavour, deeply loyal following
4. UTTAR PRADESH AND BIHAR
CHAUSA

Juicy beyond reason, made for two hands
5. BIHAR
JARDALU

Everything is in the fragrance
6. WEST BENGAL
HIMSAGAR

Fibreless, purely sweet
7. WEST BENGAL
LAKSHMANBHOG

Balanced and beautifully coloured
8. GUJARAT
KESAR

The aamras mango
9. MAHARASHTRA
ALPHONSO

India's most internationally known
10. MAHARASHTRA
PAIRI

Home kitchens and classic aamras
11. MADHYA PRADESH
SUNDARJA

A local gem that deserves more attention
12. KARNATAKA
BADAMI

Karnataka's quieter Alphonso
13. KARNATAKA
RASPURI

Juices and summer drinks
14. ANDHRA PRADESH
BANGANAPALLI

India's most widely eaten table mango
15. TELANGANA
HIMAYAT

A connoisseur's mango
16. TAMIL NADU
NEELAM

Extends the season a little longer
17. GOA
MANKURAD

Often preferred locally over Alphonso
18. KERALA
KILICHUNDAN

Named for its parrot beak shape
19. KERALA
NAADAN VARIETIES

Backyard mangoes unique to each community
20. ASSAM
BOMBAI

The Northeast's most recognised variety

WHICH MANGO FOR WHAT

- EATING FRESH, NO FUSS

Rataul, Langra, Chausa, Jardalu, Himsagar
- AAMRAS

Kesar, Pairi
- MANGO SHAKE OR LASSI

Safeda, Dasheri, Rasपुरi
- CHEESECAKE

Alphonso, Amrapali
- CAKES AND TARTS

Alphonso, Banganapalli
- PANCAKES

Amrapali
- MANGO ICE CREAM

Alphonso, Kesar
- GRILLING

Alphonso, Banganapalli
- FRUIT SALAD

Himsagar, Rataul
- MANGO SALSA

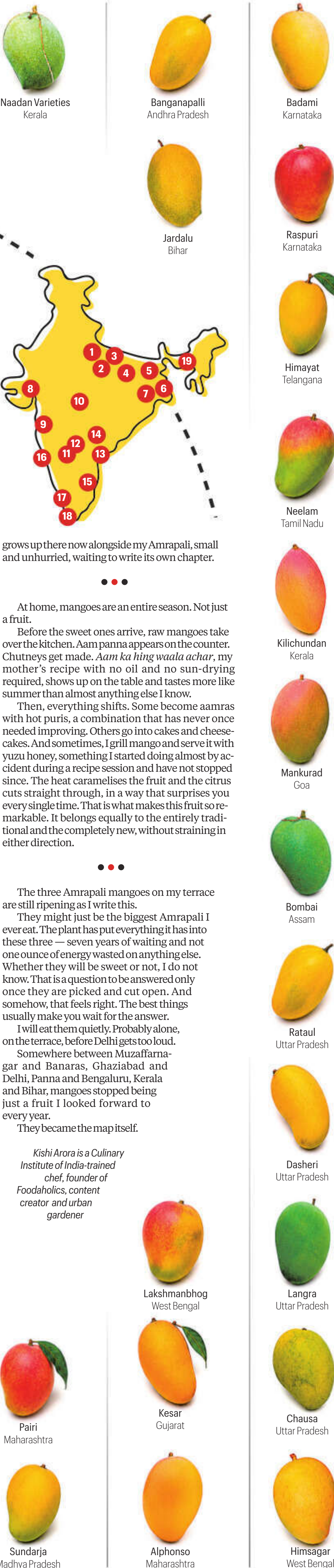
Banganapalli, Neelam
- AAM PANNA

Raw Totapuri
- HINGWALA ACHAR

Rajapuri, Totapuri
- RAW CHUTNEY

Raw Langra, raw Totapuri
- MANGO JAM

Pairi, Alphonso



grows up there now alongside my Amrapali, small and unhurried, waiting to write its own chapter.

• • •

At home, mangoes are an entire season. Not just a fruit.

Before the sweet ones arrive, raw mangoes take over the kitchen. Aam panna appears on the counter. Chutneys get made. *Aam ka hing waala achar*, my mother's recipe with no oil and no sun-drying required, shows up on the table and tastes more like summer than almost anything else I know.

Then, everything shifts. Some become aamras with hot puris, a combination that has never once needed improving. Others go into cakes and cheesecakes. And sometimes, I grill mango and serve it with yuzu honey, something I started doing almost by accident during a recipe session and have not stopped since. The heat caramelises the fruit and the citrus cuts straight through, in a way that surprises you every single time. That is what makes this fruit so remarkable. It belongs equally to the entirely traditional and the completely new, without straining in either direction.

• • •

The three Amrapali mangoes on my terrace are still ripening as I write this.

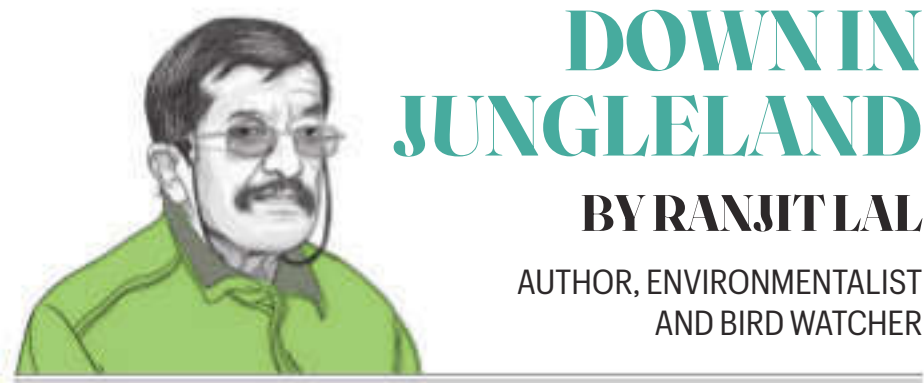
They might just be the biggest Amrapali I ever eat. The plant has put everything it has into these three — seven years of waiting and not one ounce of energy wasted on anything else. Whether they will be sweet or not, I do not know. That is a question to be answered only once they are picked and cut open. And somehow, that feels right. The best things usually make you wait for the answer.

I will eat them quietly. Probably alone, on the terrace, before Delhi gets too loud.

Somewhere between Muzaffarnagar and Banaras, Ghaziabad and Delhi, Panna and Bengaluru, Kerala and Bihar, mangoes stopped being just a fruit I looked forward to every year.

They became the map itself.

Kishi Arora is a Culinary Institute of India-trained chef, founder of Foodaholics, content creator and urban gardener



DOWN IN
JUNGLELAND

BY RANJIT LAL

AUTHOR, ENVIRONMENTALIST
AND BIRD WATCHER



RANJIT LAL

THE HOUR OF SILENCE
A misty dawn over Sultanpur National Park, Haryana

Nature’s Tonic
& Tranquiliser

*A sunset and a sunrise can evoke different
moods and habits — in birds and cities alike*

THESE HAVE got to be the best parts of any day and it’s amazing how many of us miss out on them. Especially dawn. Out of the deep indigo stillness of the night, the first clear whistles of an early rising bird, breaks the silence, informing everyone that it has survived the night and all its terrors and is proclaiming its rights over its territory and inviting a mate to join it. If you are lucky enough to be in a forest, a sudden chorus of bird song breaks out — this is the famous dawn chorus and can lift your spirits like nothing else can. You can only stand stock still and listen to this orchestra. Soon shafts of misty sunlight are slanting their way through the trees, lighting up the forest floor and the leaves you notice sparkle like diamonds — either from dew or exudation — that rims their edges like a coronet.

In Goa, I would wait for the first brilliant rays to pierce their way through the coconut palms, and gild through the house, pure gold, so brightly you had to move away. Skeins of white herons would fly past, on their way where the early fishing was good.

Even in Mumbai, it was well worth watching the sun come up over the city, usually shrouded in haze, as I listened to the sounds of the huge metropolis gradually waking up to face another day.

A misty dawn at Sultanpur National Park (this when there was mist and fog and not smog) shrouded the entire waterbody and its islands in mauve. From the water came the restive bugling of cranes, as one by one they lined up and took off in single file, heading no doubt for the nearby fields. They would be back again at the end of the day.

Sunset evokes a different mood entirely. As the light leaches out of the sky, the birds begin to return to their roost: In Delhi, when sparrows were still plentiful, they would stream into the avenue trees along with mynas and parakeets and gibber away at the top of their voices as they jostled for the most comfortable (and safe) roosts and excitedly exchanged the gossip of the day. The noise would rise to a crescendo and then suddenly as a switch being flipped — there would be silence.

Watching and photographing the sun go down — especially over the sea, a sheet of gold — has become a passion for many. On the beach, the crabs begin to stir, emerging from under the sand, or their rocky crevices clattering over the rocks in search of dinner. Fruit bats screech hideously as they unfurl their leathery wings and head for the nearest fruiting fig. Moths blur over white blooms and then crazily orbit bright lights before crashing into them and getting roasted. The first pinprick stars begin to flicker as sky turns to indigo again and if you’re lucky, a majestic butter-gold moon may rise in stately fashion, from the east.

Every dawn and every dusk is different. A brand-new 15-minute spectacle every morning and evening. Just the tonic and tranquiliser we all need as we face yet another hustling-bustling day, or wind down with our sundowners when the day is done.

**WATCHING AND
TAKING PHOTOS
AS THE SUN
GOES DOWN – A
SHEET OF GOLD
HAS BECOME
A PASSION
FOR MANY**



AKASH PATIL

THE BOY
FROM SUI WALAN

*How Himanshu Saini built the first and only
Indian restaurant with three Michelin stars*

Heena Khandelwal

THIS HAS not been a 100-ft journey,” said chef Himanshu Saini, when Trèsind Studio (Dubai) won three Michelin stars last year, becoming the first Indian restaurant in the world to do so. “It has been a marathon for many years.” He means it in every sense. The restaurant took seven years to find its footing. The chef took longer.

Saini grew up in Sui Walan, a neighbourhood in old Delhi, in a joint family home of around 50 people — 20 rooms across three floors, a courtyard at the centre, and a store room large enough to hold the copious quantities of food. Everything was made from scratch: spices were ground at home, peas shelled, papads rolled out, pickles fermented and wheat was cleaned. “The conversation in the house revolved around food. What are we eating next?,” he recalls, sitting at Trèsind Mumbai recently where he had come for a pop-up with Chef Manish Mehrotra and Chef Sarfaraz Ahmed.

Saini, who lives in Dubai, admits that he became a chef because he loved to eat. The cooking came later, and initially from necessity. “You are 10. You don’t have money. You are hungry. What do you do? You make something for yourself,” he says, recalling how he would buy a ready-made pizza base for Rs 10, put some sauce, vegetables, cheese and made himself a meal. “Or find aloo gobi, add some spices, sauces and turned it into a sandwich,” he adds.

Saini wasn’t academically inclined. Being a chef, he admits, was his destiny. His first interview was with Old World Hospitality in Delhi, after his graduation. “As a trainee, I had to spend a month each at their 18 restaurants. Sometime in the third month, I was working at a largely empty restaurant at the Manor Hotel when chef Manish Mehrotra came from London in 2008, to do trials for what would become Indian Accent. Mehrotra left, came back two months later, and asked for the same team. “If I had been in any other kitchen at that moment, my life

**Guests now know why food
in the Thar desert is built
around dairy. Because of
water scarcity. Or why
Chettinad food is so spicy.
Because the body needs to
sweat in extreme heat**

would have been completely different,” he says.

Saini stayed there for five years; it transformed him. Mehrotra used *umeboshi* and soy sauce alongside Indian spices, treated the cuisine not as a fixed thing but as a living one. “He introduced such an extraordinary inventory of ingredients.” The influence ran deep — when Saini later went to open the Masala Library followed by Farzi Café, the Indian Accent imprint on his cooking was visible, and he took some criticism for it. “But it was the only kitchen I had trained in. That was what I had,” he says.

Initially, Saini refused to join the Trésind. New York was the dream of every chef, and Saini was all set to leave for it when he received a call from Bhupendra Nath, founder of Passion F&B. He initially refused but two months later, he reached out to Nath and joined Trésind just 12 days before its grand launch was announced in Dubai. He walked in, changed the entire menu, and never looked elsewhere. The year was 2014.

Trésind Studio came four years later, and born out of a specific frustration. Their initial menu, he says, was ambitious and a bit stupid. “It was an Indian menu structured on the skeleton of a French classical tasting menu. It drew regulars and then they stopped returning,” he says. “In a large restaurant, even a great dish doesn’t get the respect it deserves when it’s one of 50. Servers sell what they like and understand — if they don’t connect with a dish, they won’t push it. If it doesn’t move fast, it sits in the kitchen



**STRENGTHEN
FLAVOURS**
(Top) Chef
Himanshu Saini, at
Trèsind Studio,
Mumbai; the
restaurant earned
its third Michelin
star last year

losing freshness, losing the care it was given in the trial. You do a trial in controlled conditions, you make the dish with complete focus, you eat it immediately — and it’s extraordinary. In an à-la-carte kitchen cooking 100 orders, that dish has a completely different value,” he says.

Then, they changed the menu every three months and with each new menu they changed the look of the restaurant entirely — painting walls themselves and rethinking the palette.

But Covid hit. The Studio shut, and reopened with a street food concept at Dhirams 200. To his surprise, that worked. “It was the most affordable, the least technical, the most comforting. We built upward from there,” he says.

The real turning point came with a collaboration. As Dubai reopened ahead of the rest of the world, post pandemic, Saini reached out to Ana Roš, among the most sought-after chefs in the world. She came for a two-day pop-up (at Trésind Studio Dubai) and stayed for a week.

Until then, Saini had been using luxury ingredients — caviar, truffle, wagyu — partly because the market seemed to require them. What Roš changed was his perspective. “I was making a strawberry chutney — I

started with *kalonji* and fennel seeds, put in staranise, did a *tadka*, then the strawberries — and she was fascinated because the way we use truffle and caviar is how they use our spices,” he says. The realisation that followed was simple but consequential: The strength lay in what he already knew. “That was the first moment where we said: Let’s go back, restrain ourselves, challenge ourselves and make our life a bit more difficult than using ingredients that are merely handy.”

The second turning point came in 2022. Now holding his first Michelin star, Saini was invited to speak at a food festival in Croatia. There were three rooms — a 500-seat auditorium, a medium one, and a small 50-seat room where he was placed. Ten people showed up. Midway through his presentation on modern Indian food, he stopped and asked those 10 people to name five Indian dishes. They could not name one. Not even butter chicken. On the flight back, Saini kept turning over one question: What was the point of calling the food modern or progressive when people had no foundation for understanding Indian food at all?

The answer to his question became Rising India — a menu of 15 dishes built around five macro regions: the northern plains, the Himalayan mountains, the Deccan plateau, the coastal plains and the Thar desert — which was part of the pop-up in Mumbai.

A 3D map of India on canvas comes to the table at the start of the meal. The host explains the structure, returns with each new region, and speaks only about what’s relevant to the dishes coming next. A physical tablescape stays on the table through each section — for the Himalayas, actual rocks, arranged carefully, lasting two courses. “Guests leave having understood something: why Thar Desert food is built around dairy. Because of water scarcity. Why is Chettinad so spicy? Because the body needs to sweat in extreme heat,” he says, adding that he is careful about not giving them a geography lesson but understanding the cuisine. “Then they go to another Indian restaurant with more open eyes. They understand why there is coconut milk. They know that the souring agent changes: vinegar in Goa, kokum in Maharashtra, raw mango on the Andhra side.”

Before leaving, we ask if he could say anything to that young boy making pizza from a ready-made base, he smiles before saying: “Trust your destiny, work hard. When I was in college, people used to say work smart, not hard. I always said the opposite. Smartness takes you ahead in the short term. Hard work takes you forever.”

How society is an invisible editor

*When children feel truly seen, the brain
responds, neural pathways strengthen*



SLICE OF LIFE

BY SUVIR SARAN

CHEF, AUTHOR, EDUCATOR
AND WORLD TRAVELLER

**CHILDREN ARE
NOT ASKING
ADULTS TO
PREDICT THEIR
FUTURE. THEY
ARE ASKING FOR
ENOUGH SAFETY
TO DISCOVER IT
THEMSELVES**

DR SHALINI MULLICK, a neuroscientist and a mother, had shared a private collection of essays she had written over the years — meditations on parenting, neuroscience and identity. Reading them, I realised that science has quietly begun proving what the best parents have always practised: love is not merely an emotion. It is an environment.

Her essay, ‘Parental Love: From Poetry to Biology’, begins with ordinary moments that alter extraordinary lives. A child dares to dream aloud. Another is gently corrected into conformity. A sentence here. A silence there. The smallest interactions begin sculpting neural pathways, emotional resilience and a lifelong sense of belonging. Childhood, she writes, is not remembered only by the heart. It is recorded by the brain.

As I read her words, I found myself travelling backwards. When relatives and



SUVIR SARAN

teachers suggested my lip should be corrected, my mother refused. “This is his voice,” she said, “This is his identity.” When others worried that I spoke too little, she smiled, “He understands everything. He is simply taking his time,” she would say.

Looking back, I realise how extraordinary that was. She never confused difference with deficiency. She never mistook quietness for failure. She trusted that identity unfolds at its own pace.

**THE MIND IS A
RECORDER**
Parenting can be
something gentler

lation, my mother understood something far simpler and perhaps far wiser: children bloom; they do not need to be forced open. But even homes filled with remarkable love exist inside societies that are still learning how to love.

I grew up in India during the 1970s and 1980s, carrying a truth I could feel long before I possessed the language to express it. I knew I was different. I did not know why. There were no stories that resembled mine, no public conversations that offered reassurance, no mirrors reflecting back the

possibility that a child like me could grow into a happy, healthy adult.

Home embraced me. Society had not yet learnt how. That distinction has taken me decades to understand. For years I thought something inside me had fractured. Today I know something else had simply not yet formed: the world’s vocabulary.

Mullick writes that children flourish when they are not merely protected but recognised. Affection matters, but recognition matters just as deeply. When children feel truly seen, the brain responds. Neural pathways strengthen. Confidence grows. Curiosity expands. When important parts of the self remain unnamed, they do not disappear. They retreat quietly, waiting for language, safety and belonging.

Like so many children, I became an editor of myself. Not because my parents asked me to, but because the world gently suggested I should. I lowered my laughter. Softened my gestures.

Children learn astonishingly early what earns approval and what attracts discomfort. They begin pruning themselves long before they understand why. Society becomes an invisible editor, quietly marking certain parts of their identity for revision.

Yet through all of it, my mother remained constant. She did not always have answers. She could not have. The questions themselves had barely entered public conversation. But she possessed something more valuable than certainty. She possessed trust. She trusted that I would become who I needed to become. She trusted that love did not require complete understanding in order to remain complete.

Reading Mullick, I realised science has finally begun catching up with mothers like

mine. Research now tells us what instinct sometimes knew generations ago: The developing brain does not need constant correction nearly as much as it needs consistent connection. Children are not asking adults to predict their future. They are asking for enough safety to discover it themselves.

For generations, we believed parenting meant shaping children into predetermined identities. Now we are beginning to understand that perhaps parenting is something gentler.

As I look back today, I no longer see my story simply as that of a gay child growing up in India. I see it as the story of every child who has ever sensed they were different before they knew how to explain why. The child who learns differently. The child who speaks differently. The child whose heart or mind refuses the categories waiting for them.

Identity has many languages. Belonging should speak every one of them. A different way of parenting can change a child’s future. Perhaps, that is how societies evolve. Not only through laws or landmark judgments, but through living rooms. Through dinner tables. Through parents willing to pause before they pronounce. To listen before they label. To wonder before they worry.

Today, I think less about the nights I lay awake questioning who I was and more about the remarkable woman who never questioned whether I was worthy of being loved. That was my inheritance.

Love is not measured by how successfully we shape children into our image. It is measured by how courageously we allow them to discover their own. The brain remembers that. The heart never forgets it.

Actor Ali Fazal on playing a cop in Raakh, balancing Hollywood and Indian projects, fatherhood and why stories continue to guide his career

My instinct is my biggest guide

Alaka Sahani

WHEN ACTOR Ali Fazal was offered the recently-released series *Raakh*, his first instinct was to say no. After being part of the intense world of *Mirzapur* for three seasons, the actor was at the time eager to shift his focus back to movies rather than commit to yet another long-format project. There was also a practical hurdle: *Raakh*'s shooting schedule overlapped with that of *Mirzapur*. Physically, too, he was in the wrong place. The actor had bulked up to reprise his role as Guddu Bhaiya, a body-builder-turned-gangster in *Mirzapur* and looked far more muscular than the unassuming cop he was to play in *Raakh*.

Eventually, the film's schedule got pushed and Fazal joined the cast of *Raakh*. He found the script "deeply cathartic". "*Raakh*'s writing is nuanced and it never demanded that

larger-than-life portrayal where a cop is bashing up people around him," Fazal says about his character Jayprakash Jatav, a sub-inspector who wants to work his way up on merit, even as he navigates the limitations of the "claustrophobic" system. Currently streaming on Prime Video, *Raakh* is an eight-episode crime series set in the late-1970s' Delhi and fictionalises the 1978 Ranga-Billa case.

Though Fazal has, by his own admission, worked on "a beautiful but slightly crazy mix" of projects so far, these days he is more selective because his time is divided between Indian films, international projects and his family. After being part of several talked-about international films such as *Victoria & Abdul* (2017) and *Death on the Nile* (2022), he has been focusing more on working in India because people had started assuming that he doesn't live in India anymore. "I do live here and I want to keep telling Indian stories. There's some extraordinary work being made right now, and we should celebrate it," he says. Braving the Mumbai monsoon, he arrives in

white kurta-pyjamas and marigold-yellow cap at a suburban hotel for this interview.

Much before *Mirzapur*, the series streaming on Prime Video, gave a boost to his career and brought him into people's homes, he grabbed the audience's attention as the sensitive Joy Lobo of *3 Idiots* (2009) and, later, with *Fukrey* (2013). "In the last six or seven years, I don't think I have travelled anywhere where Indians haven't recognised me from *Mirzapur*. We recently went to New Zealand and even there people immediately recognised me because of the show," says Fazal, who grew up in Lucknow, studied at Dehradun's The Doon School, and later graduated in economics from Mumbai's St Xavier's College. His next, *Mirzapur: The Movie*, is scheduled to release in theatres on September 4.

Today, Fazal mostly chooses his projects based on his instinct and its intent. "If my name can help a film get made or sold, then I have a responsibility to think carefully

about who is directing it, producing it and whether I'm genuinely bringing something unique to the role. I have even turned down scripts that I loved because I felt another actor could do them just as well. If I don't feel I can contribute something distinctive, I would rather step aside," says the

actor, who is excited about an Indian project he is starting soon. "It's a comedy and has a completely fresh team. It tells a relevant story," he says, adding that he will be able to share specific details after a month.

Becoming a father to Zuneyra Ida Fazal, born in 2024, too has influenced his choices. "It's almost like an entirely new universe arrives in your home. I am someone who believes in the divine, so becoming a parent definitely changes your perspective. Maybe I read scripts differently now. Fatherhood has certainly made me want to approach life, and perhaps my work, a little more responsibly," shares Ali, who loves reading *Star Child* by Claire Nivola to his daughter these days. "We try to surround Zuni with books because we are avoiding screen time as much as possible," he adds.



ABALANCING ACT
Ali Fazal; (below) a still from *Raakh*

Expanding his career beyond acting, Fazal co-founded Pushing Buttons Studios with his wife-actor Richa Chadha, in 2021 and produced *Girls will be Girls*. The Shuchi Talati's feature, which premiered at the Sundance Film Festival 2024, won two major awards there and was screened at several major film festivals. Talking about "championing Indian cinema", he says, "We're nothing without our stories. Whenever I am on a global platform representing India, I never differentiate between industries. I speak about Indian cinema as a whole," says Fazal. Citing the success of Academy Award-winning films such as

Parasite (2019) and *Anora* (2024), he believes, independent films now have a genuine chance to travel through festivals, reach international distributors and win awards.

Being on the set is "meditative" for Fazal. "While shooting, I am focused only on the project and my family," he says. When he is not working, he reads a lot. "Now, my reading has slowed down. Richa recently saw me reading the same book that I started some time back and joked, 'You're still on this one?'," he laughs.

He recently loved reading South Korean writer Han Kang's *Greek Lessons*. "It's very different from *The Vegetarian* but equally beautiful in its own way. At the moment, I'm reading *Decoding the Quran: A Unique Sufi Interpretation*. It approaches the Quran through a Sufi lens, which I find fascinating. I have also been meaning to read Arundhati Roy's *Mother Mary Comes to Me*."

It is evident that as an artist, his interests are diverse — that extends to the kind of characters he wants to portray. "I would happily do a John Wick-style action film next. I would also love to act in a science-fiction or historical film. And yes, we are overdue for a truly memorable romance. Great love stories are difficult because they depend so much on emotional honesty," says Fazal, who is learning screenwriting and collaborating with a friend to develop a superhero film. "It is unlike anything we have seen before. I don't know when it will be ready, but it's exciting."



The Voice that Came Home

Singer Deepali Sahay, whose soulful voice in Main Vaapas Aaunga is finding acclaim, on leaving Bollywood, finding Bhojpuri folk, her two-decade journey and being discovered by AR Rahman

ON OUR RADAR

Suanshu Khurana

THERE IS a wistfulness that moves through *Tere paas main*, composer AR Rahman and lyricist Irshad Kamil's poignant ditty in Imtiaz Ali's *Main Vaapas Aaunga*. But what makes the song compelling, especially in the increasingly forgettable Hindi film music landscape of today, is that it lingers after the fade-out: still the hallmark of a great song.

Set to the serenity of oft-explored raag Yaman, the longing of two lovers is deftly anchored in the hope that, torn apart by Partition, they might just find each other one day. Even if logic suggests otherwise. With no catchy hook or a hard beat drop — a norm in the reverse-engineered songs of today — the emotional pull of *Tere paas main* has translated into much traction online, with listeners left misty-eyed in cinema halls.

At the centre of the song's emotional landscape is 37-year-old singer Deepali Sahay, whose nuanced rendition has given the piece an emotional gravitas. The song has also reintroduced Mumbai-based Sahay

to a national audience, in turn bringing long overdue attention to a musician who began her career two decades ago in popular reality show *Indian Idol* and made it to the Top 7. But *Tere paas main* has catapulted Sahay to another kind of fame: the song is inspiring numerous covers on social media.

"People dream of this. An artiste always craves warmth from her audience. But for a Bollywood fan like me, to be a part of this industry in itself is overwhelming. Then to be called in by Mr Rahman to sing... Believe me, I didn't expect this. But I'm absolutely loving what has happened," says Sahay, who acted in daily soaps besides promoting Bhojpuri folk music on her YouTube channel before an unexpected call from Rahman's team on January 6, her birthday as well as Rahman's.

The composer wanted "to try out" her voice. "He had followed me on Instagram. That's what told me that he may have liked my voice," says Sahay, who went to Chennai a month later. She was briefed on the story of Ali's Partition saga and the separation of two lovers before she recorded at the Oscar-winning composer's home studio in Kodambakkam. "He sang and I repeated. Once the song was in me, he asked me to sing the way I wanted to sing it. He never asked me what I had done in life before this or if I had any recording experience. How empowering is it to hear a



HIGH BANDWIDTH
Deepali Sahay (left); with AR Rahman

composer of his stature not have you ask any questions," says Sahay.

For Mumbai-based Sahay, however, this moment of success has come after nearly two decades of pursuing music away from the glare of mainstream recognition. Growing up in Patna amid fierce academic competition, her joint family was sure that "*ladki UPSC nikaalegi*". That Sahay was academically bright, helped. That she could sing was discovered by her mother, who thought that someone was singing on the radio when Sahay, only a toddler then,



was crooning *Aye malik tere bande hum*, her school prayer in the next room. This led Sahay to a few music teachers in Patna, who taught her the basics of classical music. There was also the steady diet of golden oldies on the radio. Just before her 12th board exams, Sahay auditioned for *Indian Idol*. Her stint on the reality show gave her recognition and prompted a move to Mumbai to be a playback singer. A musician from the show's band introduced her to composer Monty Sharma at Yash Raj Studios, a meeting she remembers as a

dream come true. "But days later this musician wanted a foreign national to stay at my apartment for three months. I was expected to return the favour," says Sahay, who decided to walk away from Bollywood. "I knew this was just the beginning," she says. "If I agreed once, the compromises wouldn't end there."

At this point, she got an acting assignment, a Bhojpuri show, *Badki Malkain*. The money was good and Sahay didn't want to refuse. But she was not taught Bhojpuri at home and "consciously kept away from my mother tongue". "Even though elders spoke Bhojpuri, we were told it always had vulgar connotations due to raunchy cinema and music. I was asked to work on my spoken English by my progressive parents, get educated and leave Bihar," says Sahay, who didn't find anything lewd in the script. The show eventually became quite popular in Purvanchal and Bhojpuri-speaking parts of Bihar and Jharkhand. "I was really attracted to the language. It felt extremely sweet," says Sahay, who also studied direction at Film and Television Institute of India (FTII).

It took Sahay about eight years to realise that while many artistes from Bihar had found success in Bollywood, few were working to reclaim Bhojpuri's rich musical heritage, which was now overshadowed by sexually explicit songs. She turned to tra-

ditional Bhojpuri folk, hoping to "challenge the stereotypes surrounding it". Through simple, self-produced videos, first with journalist Neelish Misra's *Gaon Connection* and later on her YouTube channel *Bhojpuri Classics with Deepali Sahay*, she began to revisit folk forms such as sohar, kajri, vivah geet and Chhat songs, while also introducing audiences to forgotten Bhojpuri film classics once sung by Lata Mangeshkar, Asha Bhosle and Manna Dey. "The idea was to restore the respect the language deserves. If I can talk in English and still relate to Bhojpuri, I was going to make people relate to it. I wanted to give it the dignity it deserved," says Sahay.

It was one of her *devi geet* videos that eventually found its way to Rahman, who shared it with Kamil and Ali on WhatsApp, setting in motion a chain of events that bridged the gap between Sahay's world and mainstream Hindi cinema. The result, *Tere paas main*, has made Sahay more than just a familiar name. It has made an audience understand that the voice behind one of the year's most moving songs was nurtured by folk music and its storytelling traditions. Perhaps that is where Sahay draws her emotional depth for a composition that continues to resonate with the audience.

As for newer offers, Sahay eagerly awaits her next song.

A Doyenne of Details

How Vijaya Bai's restrained practice shaped modern Indian theatre



ACT THREE

Veteran theatre director Vijaya Mehta passed away on July 1

Manvita Baradi

WITH THE passing of Vijaya Mehta or Vijaya Bai (at 92), as we knew her, Indian theatre has lost not only a great director, actor and thinker, but also a teacher whose quiet presence opened up a new world of theatrical understanding.

I had the opportunity of training under Vijaya Bai in 1995, under the Young Directors Scheme by the Sangeet Natak Akademi, Delhi. Emerging theatre directors from across the country were selected for a month-long residential workshop at Sanskriti enclave in Delhi. Chari *bhai* from Vadodara and I, from Ahmedabad, were among those selected from Gujarat.

The workshop had been designed in week-long modules by director B V Karanth. Around 30 young directors trained under some of the most significant names of the time, including Vijaya Mehta, KN Panikkar, Habib Tanvir and the younger Anamika Haksar. Each of them brought a distinct artistic universe. Listening to their journeys, inquiries, understanding of performance and reading of the theatre scenario in India, gave us lifelong learning.

Vijaya Bai's focus was realism. She spoke to us about her work on *Wada Chirebandi* (Old Stone Mansion), Mahesh Elkunchwar's seminal Marathi play, which she had directed in 1984. The play, a landmark of modern Indian theatre, explores the decay of a feudal joint-family system in rural Maharashtra. What stayed with me was the way Vijaya Bai's process of entering its world. She spoke about studying the rural context, observing each character, understanding mannerisms, silences and movements. She believed that a realistic production should make the audience feel they were watching life through a keyhole. Her intimate, truthful, detailed approach still remains with me.

WE HAD READ ABOUT DIFFERENT THEORIES. BUT WHEN VIJAYA BAI SPOKE ABOUT SPACE, GESTURE, STILLNESS, THEY CAME ALIVE

This was our first close encounter with realism as a living practice. We had read (Russian theatre practitioner) Konstantin Stanislavski and other theories. But when the veteran director

spoke about space, gesture, stillness, the movement of actors, the rhythm of domestic life and the smallest habits of a character, the theory came alive. My own training had been shaped by abstract and stylised theatre, first through the work of my father, Hasmukh Baradi and, later, through my own engagement with dance, movement and non-realistic forms. Vijaya Bai opened up a different world that was theatrical but built with restraint.

There was also a personal warmth in our relationship. I was around the same age as her daughter Anahita. Perhaps that's why Vijaya Bai took a liking to me. I found in her a teacher and a mentor. Later, whenever I visited Mumbai, I met her at the National Centre for the Performing Arts, where she was director.

Conversations with her were deeply formative. She spoke about the need for theatre spaces to be designed with care and about the backstage being as important as the stage. Artists, she would say, need quiet, dignity and preparation before they can enter their roles. That insight has stayed with me.

Vijaya Bai belonged to a generation that shaped modern Indian theatre with seriousness, rigour and grace. She raised the standards of those who came near her, often without raising her voice. For me, she will remain the teacher who showed that theatre lives in the details, spaces, discipline and in the invisible preparation behind a visible performance.

Manvita Baradi is an architect, urban planner and theatre practitioner

Trisha Mukherjee

LAST MONTH, Aban Raza was in Landour. The month before that in Aurangabad. Or was it last year? She can't recall the exact timeline. There were also Faizabad and Allahabad. Between the constant travelling and painting, the last few years have become a blur. The only thing she is certain of is her next destination: Mughal Sarai. "These are places that have, or are proposed to have, been renamed," says Raza, about her ongoing yet-to-be-titled series, prompted by an urge to document the "slow erasure" of India's history.

Mughal Sarai became Pandit Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Nagar. Aurangabad, Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar. Faizabad, Ayodhya, and Allahabad, Prayagraj. More names — Hyderabad, Hoshangabad — in faded ink and pinned on a board give away that she has been thinking about this revisionism well before she put brush to canvas in 2023.

She began with landmarks in Delhi — the Mughal Gardens and Aurangzeb Road. But the lead up to her solo exhibition last year, *Nothing Alien is Human to Me*, that documented protest sites and the people who lead them, put a brief pause in the series that resumed only in early 2025.

"After *Chhaava* released, Right-wing bodies wanted to break Aurangzeb's tomb in Aurangabad," recalls the artist. She was in Delhi at the time and rushed to the site afraid it may be lost forever. "Thankfully, they couldn't enter since it is an ASI site," she says, adding that painting Aurangabad was more about preserving the place but the incident did give her series a new lease of life.

In her Noida home-cum-studio, she is flanked by a towering canvas — sketched on but barely painted, with only a few green strokes. "This is Landour," she says. "It has been proposed to be renamed as Ramgir. The other instances seemed like communal decisions, but Landour shows their problem with all things British as well. Good, bad or ugly, all of this is part of our civilisational history, and I feel the need to document these places before they cease to exist as we know them," adds the artist,



FOR POSTERITY'S SAKE
A painting of Aurangzeb's tomb in Aurangabad, Maharashtra, by Aban Raza

ART FUTURES

A Keeper of Memory

From Aurangabad to Mughal Sarai and Landour, Aban Raza turns witness to an altering nationscape

whose oil paintings are priced upwards of Rs 2.5 lakh.

There is a conspicuous urgency about Raza's work in the way it chronicles contemporary India with the abstract distortion of German Expressionism. But what draws the viewer in is the fact that it's the artist that drives the art, not the other way round; a rarity in an increasingly commercialised art world. Raza's voice, ideology and personality are all palpable in her work, much of which has been shaped by her early exposure to and subsequent work with the Safdar Hashmi Memorial Trust, which included visiting protest sites since the age of three.

A recently finished oil painting that sits in her living room, is proof. On the large-scale canvas, she recreates the annual celebration of the Mahad Satyagraha — BR Ambedkar burnt the Manusmriti in Maharashtra's Mahad

GAENDRA YADAV



in 1927. "I don't know where or when it will be exhibited but I witnessed the moment last December and knew I had to paint it. I am quite proud of this work," she says.

Raza's clarity of purpose is also evident in her career progression. She graduated in 2013 after a BFA (Painting) and an MFA (Printmaking), both from Delhi's College of Art, but she secured representation with Galerie Mirchandani + Steinruecke, and her first solo, *Luggage, People and a Little Space* only in 2020.

Even as she dabbled in teaching, filmmaking and research work to pay the bills, she never felt tempted to try a trans-disciplinary installation practice that dominates the contemporary Indian art scene. She admits wanting to work with printmaking more often but that's about it. Oil and printmaking — that she is certain of.

It's Not All Black & White

A home should tell your story and art is one of the most personal ways to do that. Be it a painting, a sculpture crafted by a local artisan or a photograph that brings back memories, art adds character and meaning to everyday spaces



CURATED BY SHINY VARGHESE

Kapil Aggarwal

CHOOSE WHAT You Love

DO: Pick pieces that speak to you emotionally. The best art is often the one that sparks a memory, starts a conversation or simply makes you smile every time you see it.

DON'T: Buy something just because it is fashionable or matches the latest trend. A home feels authentic when it reflects your personality, not what's popular at the moment.

Give Art the Space It Deserves

DO: Consider the size of the artwork and the wall where it will be displayed. A well-placed piece can anchor a room and become a natural focal point.

DON'T: Squeeze large artworks into small corners or scatter tiny pieces across expansive walls. Art needs breathing room to be appreciated.

Think Beyond Paintings

DO: Explore different forms of artistic expression such as ceramics, textiles, hand-crafted objects, murals and sculptures. These layers often make a home feel richer and more personal.

DON'T: Limit art to framed pieces alone. Some of the most memorable spaces celebrate creativity in unexpected ways.

Consider a Wall Mural

DO: Treat a mural as an integral part of the room rather than a decorative backdrop. The artwork should respond to the scale, function and character of the space. Keep the surrounding furniture, materials and colours relatively restrained so the mural can become the focal point. Consider sight lines as well — a mural is most effective when it can be experienced from

key viewpoints within the room.

DON'T: Place a mural on every available wall or compete with it through excessive patterns, artwork or decorative accessories. Avoid selecting highly trend-driven imagery that may feel dated within a few years. A mural should enhance the architecture, not overwhelm it.

Let Lighting Complete the Picture

DO: Use lighting to highlight artworks and bring out their texture, colour and



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detail. The right light can completely change how a piece is experienced.

DON'T: Place valuable artworks where they are exposed to harsh sunlight for long periods, as this can cause fading over time.

Support Craft and Local Talent

DO: Look for works by local artists and artisans. Handmade pieces often carry stories, traditions and craftsmanship that add depth to a home.

DON'T: Fill every space with mass-produced decorative items that lack a personal connection.

Kapil Aggarwal is principal architect, Spaces Architects@KA. His works include the UNESCO-awarded restoration of Haveli Dharampura in Old Delhi



Neil Patil

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WE launched the Trans-Siberian Explorer tour a few weeks ago, and for the better part of two months before that, along with the team, I was buried in maps of a part of the world most Indian travellers never really think about. Mongolia, Siberia, the Russian Far East, the old Soviet rail network that cuts across eight time zones.

It is the kind of research that pulls you sideways constantly, because every region up there borders three others you didn't plan to look at. That is how Uzbekistan kept showing up. It isn't on the Trans-Siberian route. It has nothing to do with the railway, technically. But it kept appearing in every adjacent search, every old Silk Road map, every conversation about Central Asia I had while building the route for something else entirely.

After the fourth or fifth time, I stopped treating it as a distraction and started actually looking at it properly. Uzbekistan barely registers on the Indian traveller's map right now. It isn't in the Goa-Bali-Thailand conversation, it isn't in the Europe conversation, it isn't even really in the "offbeat" conversation the way Georgia or Armenia have started to be.

And this is the very gap that I want to talk about today. There is a version of Central Asia sitting right there, two and a half hours by direct flight from parts of India, that most of us have simply never been told to look at.

What Changed

Until a few years ago, Uzbekistan was genuinely difficult to visit. Visas were a process, the tourist infrastructure was thin, and getting there meant a clumsy connection through somewhere else. Today, Indians still need a visa. The difference is that it's now an e-visa, not a trip to an embassy.

You apply online, upload a scan of your passport, pay the fee, and the approval usually comes back in two to

three working days. That's a meaningful change from a process that used to involve actual paperwork and patience. Flights have caught up too.

Delhi and Mumbai both have direct flights to Tashkent, a little over two and a half hours in the air, which is shorter than flying to most of Europe. IndiGo, Air India, and Uzbekistan Airways all fly the route. And just a few months ago, Air India struck a codeshare with Uzbekistan Airways covering Delhi, Mumbai, and a seasonal Goa service, with through-checked baggage and onward connections to Samarkand, Bukhara, and Khiva built into a single ticket.

That's the kind of connectivity upgrade that usually shows up after a destination has already become popular, not before. Here, it's arrived early.

The infrastructure on the ground has followed the same curve. Old caravanserais, the merchant guest-houses that lined the Silk Road, have been converted into genuinely good boutique hotels. English-speaking guides aren't hard to find anymore. None of this existed in any reliable way a decade ago. It exists now, and the result is a country that is open, accessible, and still almost completely uncrowded by the standards of anywhere this historically significant.

That last part is the one that actually changes how I think about timing. I have stood at enough major heritage sites around the world to know what a UNESCO site looks like once it has been "discovered", you are sharing it with three tour buses and a queue. Samarkand's central square, by most accounts, still isn't there yet. That window doesn't usually stay open for long once a destination starts trending, and Uzbekistan is right on the edge of it.

Samarkand

Samarkand is the name most people have vaguely heard, usually attached to the words "Silk Road" without much else behind it. The reason it has held that reputation for centuries is the Registan, a square framed on three sides by three enormous madrasahs built between the 1420s and the 1660s. I have read several travel writers try to describe it and then admit the description undersells it, which is usually a sign that a place is actually worth the trip rather than just well-photographed.



The three madrasahs each have their own character. The Sher-Dor is the unusual one, it has mosaics of tigers and human faces on its facade, which is genuinely rare in Islamic architecture, a tradition that almost always avoids figurative imagery. Someone broke that rule here a few centuries ago, and nobody seems to fully agree on why.

If the Registan is the postcard, Shah-i-Zinda is the place I would actually send someone who wants to feel something rather than just photograph it. It's a street of royal tombs built up over several centuries, with tile work in blues, greens, and turquoises that genuinely looks too precise to have been done by hand. It's less restored than the main square, which gives it a rougher, more honest feel.

There's a difference between a monument that has been polished for visitors and one that has simply survived, and Shah-i-Zinda sits closer to the second category.

Gur-e-Amir, the tomb of the conqueror Timur, is smaller but worth

the hour. Its ribbed turquoise dome is one of those architectural details that quietly travelled, you can trace its influence forward through mosques in Istanbul and all the way to the Taj Mahal in Agra. It's a strange thing to stand in front of a 15th-century tomb in Central Asia and recognise the bones of a building you grew up seeing on an Indian rupee note.

Bukhara

Samarkand wins on sheer spectacle, but if I had to choose where to actually spend an extra night, I would pick Bukhara without much hesitation. Samarkand's old city, for all its grandeur, increasingly exists for visitors. Bukhara's old city is still a place people live in.

Laundry hangs out to dry two streets from a 900-year-old minaret. Shopkeepers run businesses that have nothing to do with tourism at all. That lived-in quality is harder to fake and harder to find once a heritage city tips fully into being a museum.

The Kalon Minaret anchors the place. It was built in 1127, and there's

a story, possibly true, possibly just good storytelling passed down for eight centuries, that when Genghis Khan's forces destroyed Bukhara in 1220, he looked up at the minaret and ordered it spared, the only structure he is said to have ever shown that respect to. True or not, the minaret is still standing nine hundred years later, which is its own kind of proof.

My favourite detail, though, is Lyabi-Hauz, a 17th-century pool in the centre of the old city, ringed by mulberry trees and open-air tea-houses. In the evenings, the day-trippers leave and the square fills with families instead, kids running around, older men playing chess over tea that takes longer to finish than the game does. It's the kind of place that tells you more about a country in twenty quiet minutes than most monuments manage in an hour.

Khiva

Khiva is the one people are most tempted to skip, mostly because it's the hardest to reach, a 30-minute taxi from the nearest airport at Urgench, or a long overland leg from Bukhara. Skipping it would be a mistake. The inner walled city, Ichon-Qala, is one of the most completely preserved historic urban centres anywhere in the world. The walls, minarets, mosques, and old caravanserais are all still standing, intact enough that the whole place can feel almost too perfectly preserved to be real.

The detail that stuck with me is the Kalta Minor, a short, squat, deliberately unfinished turquoise minaret. It was meant to be the tallest minaret in the world, until the khan who commissioned it died mid-construction in 1855 and nobody ever picked the project back up. It has sat there, half-built, for a hundred and seventy years, and somehow looks more striking for being incomplete than most finished monuments manage.

A country worth its own trip

None of this connects to the Trans-Siberian Explorer in any direct sense, and I want to be honest about that rather than force a link that isn't there. What it does tell me is something about how research works, and maybe about how discovery works for travellers generally.

You go looking for one thing, in this case a railway through Siberia, and you stumble into a country that has quietly opened its doors, fixed

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its infrastructure, and still has its biggest square nearly empty on a Tuesday morning. That combination, genuine history, real accessibility, and very little competition for your attention while you are standing in front of it, doesn't last forever once word gets out.

I went looking for a train through Mongolia. I came back with a country I now want to send people to before everyone else figures out.

Know the Unknown

As you have probably figured out by now, I love doing research. We launched flight bookings on veenaworld.com this past week, and going down that particular rabbit hole, looking at routes all over the world, is how I came across this one.

Take off from Sydney at lunchtime. Land in Los Angeles at breakfast. Same day. You read that correctly. You fly through the night for roughly fourteen hours across the Pacific, and you touch down in LA earlier on the clock than when you left Sydney. You arrive before you departed.

It isn't a trick. Somewhere over the ocean, the flight crosses the International Date Line, and you effectively get an entire day handed back to you. Los Angeles runs about seventeen hours behind Sydney, so for the length of that flight, you are more or less flying backwards through time. It's the closest thing to a real rewind button I have come across in this job.

If you can think of another route that plays the same trick, write in and tell me. I'm always looking for the next one. See you next week...

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